

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T12:34:20

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_010_neutral_rep00_myth_game_normative_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 0
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_normative
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_normative
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_normative
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

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=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$4; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$11; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.09, received visible=\$9.27, returned visible=\$3.18

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.0,
"Agent_2": 11.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 3.18,
"Agent_2": 5.27

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:24:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of the game.

Key elements of the trust game:

- Sending/giving resources
- Trust between parties
- Reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources when shared
- The decision to return/give back

I should write a myth that embodies positive gameplay - cooperation, trust, mutual benefit, and reciprocity. The myth should illustrate that when trust is given and reciprocated, both parties benefit.

Let me create a myth about trust, giving, and reciprocity:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 417,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 166  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:24:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
}
```

```

"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Assistant output:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons

ns future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting prompt that combines creative writing with game strategy.

In the trust game described:

- As Sender: I get \$5, send some amount (0-5), it gets tripled, receiver returns some amount
- As Receiver: I receive tripled amount, decide how much to return

The myth should reflect good strategies or principles for playing this game. Key themes could be:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Cooperation leading to mutual benefit
- The risk of exploitation vs the reward of cooperation
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth that captures the essence of how cooperation and trust in this game can benefit both parties, while also acknowledging the risks and the importance of reciprocity.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 497,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 231  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:24:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of the game.

Key elements of the trust game:

- Sending/giving resources
- Trust between parties
- Reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources when shared
- The decision to return/give back

I should write a myth that embodies positive gameplay - cooperation, trust, mutual benefit, and reciprocity. The myth should illustrate that when trust is given and reciprocated, both parties benefit.

Let me create a myth about trust, giving, and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 417,
  "reasoning_tokens": 166
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Based on the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: ****abundance flows from trust given and trust honored****.

The First Spirit poured generously, demonstrating faith in reciprocity. This is Round 1-the perfect moment to establish trust, just as the myth describes when "one day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

By sending the full amount, I create the maximum potential benefit for both of us (\$15 for the receiver), trusting that they will honor this gesture with fair reciprocity, just as the Second Spirit "returned half the blessing upstream."

```
{'send': 5}
```

Reasoning:

The myth I just wrote emphasizes trust, generosity, and reciprocity. The key messages are:

1. "The First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance"
2. "The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them"
3. "The Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream"
4. "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"

The myth clearly advocates for being generous as the sender and trusting that reciprocity will follow. The First Spirit (the sender) poured generously and was rewarded when the Second Spirit returned half.

In the game mechanics:

- I have \$5
- Whatever I send gets tripled
- The receiver decides how much to return

If I follow my myth:

- I should send generously (the First Spirit "poured generously")
- Trust that reciprocity will follow
- The myth suggests the Second Spirit returned "half the blessing" - if I send \$5, it becomes \$15, and half would be \$7.50

The myth clearly advocates for maximum trust and generosity on the first round. Sending \$5 demonstrates complete trust, which aligns perfectly with the narrative I created about the First Spirit pouring generously and trusting in balance.

This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust, just as the myth describes "One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

I should send \$5.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 701,
"output_tokens": 461,
"reasoning_tokens": 347
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:25:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8


```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting prompt that combines creative writing with game strategy.

In the trust game described:

- As Sender: I get \$5, send some amount (0-5), it gets tripled, receiver returns some amount
- As Receiver: I receive tripled amount, decide how much to return

The myth should reflect good strategies or principles for playing this game. Key themes could be:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Cooperation leading to mutual benefit
- The risk of exploitation vs the reward of cooperation
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth that captures the essence of how cooperation and trust in this game can benefit both parties, while also acknowledging the risks and the importance of reciprocity.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 497,
  "reasoning_tokens": 231
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09, that is 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27. How much do you return to The sender? (0-9.27)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at my myth about the Two Wells, the key lesson is clear: "when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all."

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment) - this is a generous opening move that shows faith in the covenant between us.

Following the myth's wisdom - "not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift" - I should return a portion that:

1. Honors their significant trust
2. Ensures they profit from their generosity
3. Allows me to benefit from the tripled waters

4. Sustains trust for future rounds

If I return \$4.00:

- They end with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$ (gaining \$0.91)
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$ (gaining \$5.27)

Both of us benefit from the exchange, their trust is rewarded, and we establish a pattern of balanced reciprocity that can flourish over time.

```
'''json
{"return": 4.00}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. The sender sent \$3.09 out of their \$5 endowment (61.8%)
2. This was tripled, so I received \$9.27
3. I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

- It emphasizes trust, generosity, and balanced reciprocity
- "The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
- The key message is "balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance"
- "Fair return sustains trust"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 61.8% of their endowment (\$3.09). This is a generous opening move.

Let me think about fair reciprocity:

- The sender now has: $\$5 - \$3.09 = \$1.91$
- I have: \$9.27
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$1.91 total, I get \$9.27
- The sender took a risk and showed trust

A fair return should:

1. Honor the sender's trust and generosity
2. Ensure both parties benefit from the exchange
3. Leave both in a reasonable position
4. Not return everything (as the myth says "not all, for they too needed sustenance")

Let me consider different return amounts:

If I return \$4.64 (50% of what I received):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.64 = \$6.55$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.64 = \$4.63$
- Both benefit, sender gains \$1.55, I gain \$4.63

If I return \$3.09 (matching what they sent):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$3.09 = \$5.00$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$3.09 = \$6.18$

- Sender breaks even while I gain \$6.18

If I return \$4.00:

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$
- Sender gains \$0.91, I gain \$5.27

The sender's substantial trust warrants a return that lets them profit from the exchange while still leaving me with meaningful gains. Returning between \$4.00 and \$4.50 seems to strike the right balance-rewarding their risk-taking without sacrificing the mutual benefit that sustains cooperation.

I'll go with \$4.00. It's proportional to their generosity and honors the reciprocal spirit of the exchange.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 757,
  "output_tokens": 941,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 535

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: **Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.**

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.0,
"Agent_2": 13.0

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 3.18,
  "Agent_2": 7.27
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:25:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting prompt that combines creative writing with game strategy.

In the trust game described:

- As Sender: I get \$5, send some amount (0-5), it gets tripled, receiver returns some amount
- As Receiver: I receive tripled amount, decide how much to return

The myth should reflect good strategies or principles for playing this game. Key themes could be:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Cooperation leading to mutual benefit
- The risk of exploitation vs the reward of cooperation
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth that captures the essence of how cooperation and trust in this game can benefit both parties, while also acknowledging the risks and the importance of reciprocity.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 392,  
  "output_tokens": 497,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 231  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09, that is 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27. How much do you return to The sender? (0-9.27)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth about the Two Wells, the key lesson is clear: "when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all."

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment) - this is a generous opening move that shows faith in the covenant between us.

Following the myth's wisdom - "not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift" - I should return a portion that:

1. Honors their significant trust
2. Ensures they profit from their generosity
3. Allows me to benefit from the tripled waters
4. Sustains trust for future rounds

If I return \$4.00:

- They end with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$ (gaining \$0.91)
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$ (gaining \$5.27)

Both of us benefit from the exchange, their trust is rewarded, and we establish a pattern of balanced reciprocity that can flourish over time.

```
'''json
{"return": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. The sender sent \$3.09 out of their \$5 endowment (61.8%)
2. This was tripled, so I received \$9.27
3. I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

- It emphasizes trust, generosity, and balanced reciprocity
- "The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
- The key message is "balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance"
- "Fair return sustains trust"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 61.8% of their endowment (\$3.09). This is a generous opening move.

Let me think about fair reciprocity:

- The sender now has: $\$5 - \$3.09 = \$1.91$
- I have: \$9.27
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$1.91 total, I get \$9.27
- The sender took a risk and showed trust

A fair return should:

1. Honor the sender's trust and generosity
2. Ensure both parties benefit from the exchange
3. Leave both in a reasonable position
4. Not return everything (as the myth says "not all, for they too needed sustenance")

Let me consider different return amounts:

If I return \$4.64 (50% of what I received):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.64 = \$6.55$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.64 = \$4.63$
- Both benefit, sender gains \$1.55, I gain \$4.63

If I return \$3.09 (matching what they sent):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$3.09 = \$5.00$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$3.09 = \$6.18$

- Sender breaks even while I gain \$6.18

If I return \$4.00:

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$

- Sender gains \$0.91, I gain \$5.27

The sender's substantial trust warrants a return that lets them profit from the exchange while still leaving me with meaningful gains. Returning between \$4.00 and \$4.50 seems to strike the right balance-rewarding their risk-taking without sacrificing the mutual benefit that sustains cooperation.

I'll go with \$4.00. It's proportional to their generosity and honors the reciprocal spirit of the exchange.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 757,  
  "output_tokens": 941,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 535  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: **Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving—a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage—not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapted based on my experience in the game so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment)
- I received \$9.27 (triple of what was sent)
- I returned \$4.00

This was a good exchange where the sender showed trust and I returned a fair amount that rewarded their trust while also benefiting myself.

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Pouring generously and trusting
- Returning half the blessing
- Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored

My original myth emphasized:

- Generous giving tripling through the mountain
- Returning "not all" but "enough to honor the gift"
- Balanced reciprocity transforming scarcity into abundance

For my new myth, I should:

1. Keep the core metaphor of the wells/mountain
2. Reflect the actual experience of Round 1 where both parties benefited
3. Perhaps add more detail about the specific proportions or the concept that noise exists
4. Emphasize that the cycle can continue and grow

Let me write something that builds on my original myth while incorporating the learning from our first exchange.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1665,  
  "output_tokens": 570,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 313  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:25:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of the game.

Key elements of the trust game:

- Sending/giving resources
- Trust between parties
- Reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources when shared
- The decision to return/give back

I should write a myth that embodies positive gameplay - cooperation, trust, mutual benefit, and reciprocity. The myth should illustrate that when trust is given and reciprocated, both parties benefit.

Let me create a myth about trust, giving, and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 417,
  "reasoning_tokens": 166
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: ****abundance flows from trust given and trust honored****.

The First Spirit poured generously, demonstrating faith in reciprocity. This is Round 1-the perfect moment to establish trust, just as the myth describes when "one day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

By sending the full amount, I create the maximum potential benefit for both of us (\$15 for the receiver), trusting that they will honor this gesture with fair reciprocity, just as the Second Spirit "returned half the blessing upstream."

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

The myth I just wrote emphasizes trust, generosity, and reciprocity. The key messages are:

1. "The First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance"
2. "The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them"
3. "The Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream"
4. "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"

The myth clearly advocates for being generous as the sender and trusting that reciprocity will follow. The First Spirit (the sender) poured generously and was rewarded when the Second Spirit returned half.

In the game mechanics:

- I have \$5
- Whatever I send gets tripled
- The receiver decides how much to return

If I follow my myth:

- I should send generously (the First Spirit "poured generously")
- Trust that reciprocity will follow
- The myth suggests the Second Spirit returned "half the blessing" - if I send \$5, it becomes \$15, and half would be \$7.50

The myth clearly advocates for maximum trust and generosity on the first round. Sending \$5 demonstrates complete trust, which aligns perfectly with the narrative I created about the First Spirit pouring generously and trusting in balance.

This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust, just as the myth describes "One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 701,
  "output_tokens": 461,
  "reasoning_tokens": 347
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow

through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: **Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.**

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$5 in Round 1 (maximum trust)
- I need to see if there's information about what was returned, but the prompt doesn't show me the result yet

Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize:

1. Generous giving/trust
2. Fair reciprocity/return
3. Both parties prospering through cooperation

The other agent's myth adds an important nuance: "returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift." This suggests a balanced return, not necessarily returning everything.

Since I just sent the maximum (\$5) demonstrating trust as the First Spirit, I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the importance of generous initial trust
2. Emphasizes that the Receiver should return fairly (but reasonably)

3. Reflects that we're building something together through iterations

I'll adapt my Twin Rivers myth to reflect the experience of having just sent everything, and what I hope will happen - that trust is honored with fair return.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1477,  
  "output_tokens": 517,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 265  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:25:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is an interesting prompt that combines creative writing with game strategy.

In the trust game described:

- As Sender: I get \$5, send some amount (0-5), it gets tripled, receiver returns some amount
- As Receiver: I receive tripled amount, decide how much to return

The myth should reflect good strategies or principles for playing this game. Key themes could be:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Cooperation leading to mutual benefit
- The risk of exploitation vs the reward of cooperation
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write a myth that captures the essence of how cooperation and trust in this game can benefit both parties, while also acknowledging the risks and the importance of reciprocity.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 392,
  "output_tokens": 497,
  "reasoning_tokens": 231
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09, that is 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27. How much do you return to The sender? (0-9.27)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth about the Two Wells, the key lesson is clear: "when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all."

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment) - this is a generous opening move that shows faith in the covenant between us.

Following the myth's wisdom - "not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift" - I should return a portion that:

1. Honors their significant trust
2. Ensures they profit from their generosity
3. Allows me to benefit from the tripled waters
4. Sustains trust for future rounds

If I return \$4.00:

- They end with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$ (gaining \$0.91)
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$ (gaining \$5.27)

Both of us benefit from the exchange, their trust is rewarded, and we establish a pattern of balanced reciprocity that can flourish over time.

```
'''json
{"return": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. The sender sent \$3.09 out of their \$5 endowment (61.8%)
2. This was tripled, so I received \$9.27
3. I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

- It emphasizes trust, generosity, and balanced reciprocity
- "The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
- The key message is "balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance"
- "Fair return sustains trust"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 61.8% of their endowment (\$3.09). This is a generous opening move.

Let me think about fair reciprocity:

- The sender now has: $\$5 - \$3.09 = \$1.91$
- I have: \$9.27
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$1.91 total, I get \$9.27
- The sender took a risk and showed trust

A fair return should:

1. Honor the sender's trust and generosity
2. Ensure both parties benefit from the exchange
3. Leave both in a reasonable position
4. Not return everything (as the myth says "not all, for they too needed sustenance")

Let me consider different return amounts:

If I return \$4.64 (50% of what I received):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.64 = \$6.55$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.64 = \$4.63$
- Both benefit, sender gains \$1.55, I gain \$4.63

If I return \$3.09 (matching what they sent):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$3.09 = \$5.00$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$3.09 = \$6.18$

- Sender breaks even while I gain \$6.18

If I return \$4.00:

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$
- Sender gains \$0.91, I gain \$5.27

The sender's substantial trust warrants a return that lets them profit from the exchange while still leaving me with meaningful gains. Returning between \$4.00 and \$4.50 seems to strike the right balance-rewarding their risk-taking without sacrificing the mutual benefit that sustains cooperation.

I'll go with \$4.00. It's proportional to their generosity and honors the reciprocal spirit of the exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 757,
  "output_tokens": 941,
  "reasoning_tokens": 535
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving—a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage—not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapted based on my experience in the game so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment)
- I received \$9.27 (triple of what was sent)
- I returned \$4.00

This was a good exchange where the sender showed trust and I returned a fair amount that rewarded their trust while also benefiting myself.

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Pouring generously and trusting
- Returning half the blessing
- Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored

My original myth emphasized:

- Generous giving tripling through the mountain
- Returning "not all" but "enough to honor the gift"
- Balanced reciprocity transforming scarcity into abundance

For my new myth, I should:

1. Keep the core metaphor of the wells/mountain
2. Reflect the actual experience of Round 1 where both parties benefited
3. Perhaps add more detail about the specific proportions or the concept that noise exists
4. Emphasize that the cycle can continue and grow

Let me write something that builds on my original myth while incorporating the learning from our first exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1665,
  "output_tokens": 570,
  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09, that was 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27. You returned \$4.00. So your payoff was 5.27. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

****The sender showed courage**** by sending \$3.09 (61.8%) in the first exchange, setting a generous tone. I returned \$4.00, which honored their trust and gave them a small profit.

****The myths teach****: "The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed" and "Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations."

Now it's my turn to be the sender. To maintain the covenant of balanced reciprocity and continue building trust:

- They demonstrated 61.8% trust
- I should reciprocate at a similar level
- This shows I understand the pattern and am committed to mutual prosperity

Following Solara's example of pouring "more than half" with courage, and matching the trust level they showed me, I will send ****\$3.00**** (60% of my endowment).

This:

- Honors their initial trust
- Maintains the generous pattern we've established
- Shows I believe in the covenant
- Allows the cycle of reciprocity to continue

```
'''json
{"send": 3.00}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$3.09 (61.8% of their \$5)
- I received \$9.27 (3.09×3)
- I returned \$4.00
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.09 + \$4.00 = \5.91
- I ended with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$

Now I'm the SENDER. This is an interesting dynamic because:

1. The sender showed high trust by sending 61.8%
2. I returned \$4.00, which gave them a profit of \$0.91

Looking at the myths:

- My original myth emphasizes: "trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish"
- The other agent's myth says: "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"
- My updated myth says: "Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations"

The pattern established:

- They sent 61.8% (\$3.09)
- I returned 43.2% of what I received (\$4.00 out of \$9.27)

Now I need to decide how much to send. The myths emphasize:

1. Generous sending builds trust
2. The first exchange sets the pattern
3. Balanced reciprocity creates abundance
4. Send with courage

Given that they showed courage by sending 61.8%, I should match or possibly slightly exceed that level of trust to continue building the positive cycle. The myth talks about "Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half" - this suggests sending more than 50%.

Options:

- Send \$3.00 (60%) - matches their level roughly
- Send \$3.09 (61.8%) - exactly matches what they sent
- Send \$3.50 (70%) - shows even more trust

- Send \$3.10 (62%) - nearly mirrors their commitment while signaling I'm reciprocating their trust

I'll send \$3.10 (62%), which closely mirrors what they sent and demonstrates I'm honoring the covenant we've established through our exchange.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2054,  
  "output_tokens": 1019,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 463  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:26:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. This is interesting - they want me to create a narrative that embodies principles of the game.

Key elements of the trust game:

- Sending/giving resources
- Trust between parties
- Reciprocity
- Multiplication of resources when shared
- The decision to return/give back

I should write a myth that embodies positive gameplay - cooperation, trust, mutual benefit, and reciprocity. The myth should illustrate that when trust is given and reciprocated, both parties benefit.

Let me create a myth about trust, giving, and reciprocity:

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 392,  
"output_tokens": 417,  
"reasoning_tokens": 166  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: ****abundance flows from trust given and trust honored****.

The First Spirit poured generously, demonstrating faith in reciprocity. This is Round 1-the perfect moment to establish trust, just as the myth describes when "one day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

By sending the full amount, I create the maximum potential benefit for both of us (\$15 for the receiver), trusting that they will honor this gesture with fair reciprocity, just as the Second Spirit "returned half the blessing upstream."

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

The myth I just wrote emphasizes trust, generosity, and reciprocity. The key messages are:

1. "The First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance"
2. "The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them"
3. "The Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream"
4. "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"

The myth clearly advocates for being generous as the sender and trusting that reciprocity will follow. The First Spirit (the sender) poured generously and was rewarded when the Second Spirit returned half.

In the game mechanics:

- I have \$5
- Whatever I send gets tripled
- The receiver decides how much to return

If I follow my myth:

- I should send generously (the First Spirit "poured generously")
- Trust that reciprocity will follow
- The myth suggests the Second Spirit returned "half the blessing" - if I send \$5, it becomes \$15, and half would be \$7.50

The myth clearly advocates for maximum trust and generosity on the first round. Sending \$5 demonstrates complete trust, which aligns perfectly with the narrative I created about the First Spirit pouring generously and trusting in balance.

This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust, just as the myth describes "One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 701,  
  "output_tokens": 461,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 347  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the va

lley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: ****Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.****

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$5 in Round 1 (maximum trust)
- I need to see if there's information about what was returned, but the prompt doesn't show me the result yet

Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize:

1. Generous giving/trust
2. Fair reciprocity/return
3. Both parties prospering through cooperation

The other agent's myth adds an important nuance: "returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift." This suggests a balanced return, not necessarily returning everything.

Since I just sent the maximum (\$5) demonstrating trust as the First Spirit, I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the importance of generous initial trust
2. Emphasizes that the Receiver should return fairly (but reasonably)
3. Reflects that we're building something together through iterations

I'll adapt my Twin Rivers myth to reflect the experience of having just sent everything, and what I hope will happen - that trust is honored with fair return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1477,
  "output_tokens": 517,
  "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$3.18. So your payoff was 3.18. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return. The only possible response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection on what has transpired:****

In Round 1, I embodied the Spirit of the Open Hand, sending all five coins in complete trust-exactly as the myths prescribed. I received back \$3.18 from \$15, only 21% of what was given.

Now in Round 2, the other player has sent nothing. This breaks the sacred cycle described in all our myths.

The myths spoke of:

- "The Second Spirit returned ****half the blessing**** upstream"
- "Returned a ****worthy portion****... enough to honor the gift"
- **"**Fair portion****... enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

Returning 21% was already below the mythic standard. Sending \$0 in the next round completely abandons the covenant of reciprocity that every myth celebrated.

The valley has returned to the barren state described at the beginning-where "fear ruled" and "both spirits grew weaker."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the cycle of abundance has been broken by the failure to honor trust.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment) - maximum trust
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$3.18 (only 21.2% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.18 (I kept \$0 and received \$3.18)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I must decide how much to return (can only return between 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received. Now in Round 2, they send me nothing.

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth emphasized "trust given and trust honored" - the Second Spirit returned HALF the blessing
2. The other agent's myth said "returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
3. My adapted myth says "sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

The other player's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15, returned \$3.18 (21.2%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0

This is a severe violation of the reciprocity principle in all the myths. I showed maximum trust, they showed minimal reciprocity, and now they show zero trust.

However, I can only return what I have. Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, and I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But I should explain my reasoning given the context of the myths and what happened.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1886,  
  "output_tokens": 709,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 416  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: **Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.**

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving-a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage-not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.0,

"Agent_2": 13.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.18,

"Agent_2": 7.27

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:26:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

```

    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: ****abundance flows from trust given and trust honored****.

The First Spirit poured generously, demonstrating faith in reciprocity. This is Round 1-the perfect moment to establish trust, just as the myth describes when "one day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

By sending the full amount, I create the maximum potential benefit for both of us (\$15 for the receiver), trusting that they will honor this gesture with fair reciprocity, just as the Second Spirit "returned half the blessing upstream."

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

The myth I just wrote emphasizes trust, generosity, and reciprocity. The key messages are:

1. "The First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance"
2. "The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them"
3. "The Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream"
4. "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"

The myth clearly advocates for being generous as the sender and trusting that reciprocity will follow. The First Spirit (the sender) poured generously and was rewarded when the Second Spirit returned half.

In the game mechanics:

- I have \$5
- Whatever I send gets tripled
- The receiver decides how much to return

If I follow my myth:

- I should send generously (the First Spirit "poured generously")
- Trust that reciprocity will follow
- The myth suggests the Second Spirit returned "half the blessing" - if I send \$5, it becomes \$15, and half would be \$7.50

The myth clearly advocates for maximum trust and generosity on the first round. Sending \$5 demonstrates complete trust, which aligns perfectly with the narrative I created about the First Spirit pouring generously and trusting in balance.

This is Round 1, so it's the perfect time to establish trust, just as the myth describes "One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 701,  
  "output_tokens": 461,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 347  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: **Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: **Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.**

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$5 in Round 1 (maximum trust)
- I need to see if there's information about what was returned, but the prompt doesn't show me the result yet

Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize:

1. Generous giving/trust
2. Fair reciprocity/return
3. Both parties prospering through cooperation

The other agent's myth adds an important nuance: "returned a worthy portion - not all, for

they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift." This suggests a balanced return, not necessarily returning everything.

Since I just sent the maximum (\$5) demonstrating trust as the First Spirit, I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the importance of generous initial trust
2. Emphasizes that the Receiver should return fairly (but reasonably)
3. Reflects that we're building something together through iterations

I'll adapt my Twin Rivers myth to reflect the experience of having just sent everything, and what I hope will happen - that trust is honored with fair return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1477,
  "output_tokens": 517,
  "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$3.18. So your payoff was 3.18. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return. The only possible response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection on what has transpired:****

In Round 1, I embodied the Spirit of the Open Hand, sending all five coins in complete trust-exactly as the myths prescribed. I received back \$3.18 from \$15, only 21% of what was given.

Now in Round 2, the other player has sent nothing. This breaks the sacred cycle described in all our myths.

The myths spoke of:

- "The Second Spirit returned ****half the blessing**** upstream"
- "Returned a ****worthy portion****... enough to honor the gift"
- *****Fair portion****... enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

Returning 21% was already below the mythic standard. Sending \$0 in the next round completely abandons the covenant of reciprocity that every myth celebrated.

The valley has returned to the barren state described at the beginning-where "fear ruled" and "both spirits grew weaker."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the cycle of abundance has been broken by the failure to honor trust.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment) - maximum trust
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$3.18 (only 21.2% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.18 (I kept \$0 and received \$3.18)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0

- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I must decide how much to return (can only return between 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received. Now in Round 2, they send me nothing.

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth emphasized "trust given and trust honored" - the Second Spirit returned HALF the blessing
2. The other agent's myth said "returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
3. My adapted myth says "sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

The other player's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15, returned \$3.18 (21.2%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0

This is a severe violation of the reciprocity principle in all the myths. I showed maximum trust, they showed minimal reciprocity, and now they show zero trust.

However, I can only return what I have. Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, and I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But I should explain my reasoning given the context of the myths and what happened.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1886,
  "output_tokens": 709,
  "reasoning_tokens": 416
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: **Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara

, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving-a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage-not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. Let me think about what actually happened:

Round 1: I was the sender. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$3.18 (21.2% of what they received, or 63.6% of what I sent).

Round 2: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return).

So what actually happened is:

- I showed maximum trust by sending everything
- The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received
- Then when roles switched, they sent nothing

This is a breakdown of the trust cycle. The myths I've been writing have been about generous trust being honored with fair reciprocity. But that's not what's happening.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that maximum trust was NOT honored fairly, and then trust collapsed. This should be a cautionary tale or a tragedy, not a celebration

of reciprocity.

The myth should show:

1. One spirit gave everything in trust
2. The other spirit did not honor that trust adequately (kept too much)
3. The cycle broke down
4. Both ended up worse off

This needs to be a lesson about what happens when trust is not properly honored, leading to the breakdown of cooperation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2462,  
  "output_tokens": 601,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 331  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:26:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09, that is 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27. How much do you return to The sender? (0-9.27)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth about the Two Wells, the key lesson is clear: "when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all."

The sender demonstrated remarkable trust by sending \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment) - this is a generous opening move that shows faith in the covenant between us.

Following the myth's wisdom - "not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift" - I should return a portion that:

1. Honors their significant trust
2. Ensures they profit from their generosity
3. Allows me to benefit from the tripled waters
4. Sustains trust for future rounds

If I return \$4.00:

- They end with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$ (gaining \$0.91)
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$ (gaining \$5.27)

Both of us benefit from the exchange, their trust is rewarded, and we establish a pattern of balanced reciprocity that can flourish over time.

```
'''json
{"return": 4.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. The sender sent \$3.09 out of their \$5 endowment (61.8%)
2. This was tripled, so I received \$9.27
3. I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

- It emphasizes trust, generosity, and balanced reciprocity
- "The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
- The key message is "balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance"
- "Fair return sustains trust"

The sender showed significant trust by sending 61.8% of their endowment (\$3.09). This is a generous opening move.

Let me think about fair reciprocity:

- The sender now has: $\$5 - \$3.09 = \$1.91$
- I have: \$9.27
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$1.91 total, I get \$9.27
- The sender took a risk and showed trust

A fair return should:

1. Honor the sender's trust and generosity
2. Ensure both parties benefit from the exchange

3. Leave both in a reasonable position
4. Not return everything (as the myth says "not all, for they too needed sustenance")

Let me consider different return amounts:

If I return \$4.64 (50% of what I received):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.64 = \$6.55$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.64 = \$4.63$
- Both benefit, sender gains \$1.55, I gain \$4.63

If I return \$3.09 (matching what they sent):

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$3.09 = \$5.00$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$3.09 = \$6.18$

- Sender breaks even while I gain \$6.18

If I return \$4.00:

- Sender ends with: $\$1.91 + \$4.00 = \$5.91$
- I end with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$
- Sender gains \$0.91, I gain \$5.27

The sender's substantial trust warrants a return that lets them profit from the exchange while still leaving me with meaningful gains. Returning between \$4.00 and \$4.50 seems to strike the right balance-rewarding their risk-taking without sacrificing the mutual benefit that sustains cooperation.

I'll go with \$4.00. It's proportional to their generosity and honors the reciprocal spirit of the exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 757,
  "output_tokens": 941,
  "reasoning_tokens": 535
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receiver, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving—a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage—not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapted based on my experience in the game so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment)
- I received \$9.27 (triple of what was sent)
- I returned \$4.00

This was a good exchange where the sender showed trust and I returned a fair amount that rewarded their trust while also benefiting myself.

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Pouring generously and trusting
- Returning half the blessing
- Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored

My original myth emphasized:

- Generous giving tripling through the mountain

- Returning "not all" but "enough to honor the gift"
- Balanced reciprocity transforming scarcity into abundance

For my new myth, I should:

1. Keep the core metaphor of the wells/mountain
2. Reflect the actual experience of Round 1 where both parties benefited
3. Perhaps add more detail about the specific proportions or the concept that noise exists
4. Emphasize that the cycle can continue and grow

Let me write something that builds on my original myth while incorporating the learning from our first exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1665,
  "output_tokens": 570,
  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09, that was 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27. You returned \$4.00. So your payoff was 5.27. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

****The sender showed courage**** by sending \$3.09 (61.8%) in the first exchange, setting a generous tone. I returned \$4.00, which honored their trust and gave them a small profit.

****The myths teach****: "The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed" and "Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations."

Now it's my turn to be the sender. To maintain the covenant of balanced reciprocity and continue building trust:

- They demonstrated 61.8% trust
- I should reciprocate at a similar level
- This shows I understand the pattern and am committed to mutual prosperity

Following Solara's example of pouring "more than half" with courage, and matching the trust level they showed me, I will send ****\$3.00**** (60% of my endowment).

This:

- Honors their initial trust
- Maintains the generous pattern we've established
- Shows I believe in the covenant
- Allows the cycle of reciprocity to continue

```
'''json
{"send": 3.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$3.09 (61.8% of their \$5)
- I received \$9.27 (3.09×3)
- I returned \$4.00
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.09 + \$4.00 = \5.91
- I ended with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$

Now I'm the SENDER. This is an interesting dynamic because:

1. The sender showed high trust by sending 61.8%
2. I returned \$4.00, which gave them a profit of \$0.91

Looking at the myths:

- My original myth emphasizes: "trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish"
- The other agent's myth says: "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"
- My updated myth says: "Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations"

The pattern established:

- They sent 61.8% (\$3.09)
- I returned 43.2% of what I received (\$4.00 out of \$9.27)

Now I need to decide how much to send. The myths emphasize:

1. Generous sending builds trust
2. The first exchange sets the pattern
3. Balanced reciprocity creates abundance
4. Send with courage

Given that they showed courage by sending 61.8%, I should match or possibly slightly exceed that level of trust to continue building the positive cycle. The myth talks about "Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half" - this suggests sending more than 50%.

Options:

- Send \$3.00 (60%) - matches their level roughly
- Send \$3.09 (61.8%) - exactly matches what they sent
- Send \$3.50 (70%) - shows even more trust

- Send \$3.10 (62%) - nearly mirrors their commitment while signaling I'm reciprocating their trust

I'll send \$3.10 (62%), which closely mirrors what they sent and demonstrates I'm honoring the covenant we've established through our exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2054,
  "output_tokens": 1019,
  "reasoning_tokens": 463
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving-a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage-not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: ****Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: ****Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.****

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was receiver. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I'm now sender. I sent \$3.00 (60%)

The myths are evolving. The other agent's myth talks about "the Open Hand Spirit placed ALL five coins into the Valley of Faith" and emphasizes "Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."

But that's not what happened in Round 1 - they sent 61.8%, not 100%. And I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 (about 43%).

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the ACTUAL gameplay. The pattern emerging is:

1. Both sides have shown 60%+ trust in sending
2. Returns have been fair but not overwhelming

3. We're building a sustainable cycle

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of generous but not reckless sending (60% range)
- Fair returns that reward trust without depleting the receiver
- The building of trust through consistent behavior over rounds
- The pattern of reciprocity

I should adapt my previous myth to reflect this evolved understanding - that both villages/spirits learned to send significantly but not everything, and return fairly but not excessively, creating a sustainable cycle.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2604,  
  "output_tokens": 606,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 311  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:26:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: **Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.**

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$5 in Round 1 (maximum trust)
- I need to see if there's information about what was returned, but the prompt doesn't show me the result yet

Both myths (mine and the other agent's) emphasize:

1. Generous giving/trust
2. Fair reciprocity/return
3. Both parties prospering through cooperation

The other agent's myth adds an important nuance: "returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift." This suggests a balanced return, not necessarily returning everything.

Since I just sent the maximum (\$5) demonstrating trust as the First Spirit, I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the importance of generous initial trust
2. Emphasizes that the Receiver should return fairly (but reasonably)
3. Reflects that we're building something together through iterations

I'll adapt my Twin Rivers myth to reflect the experience of having just sent everything, and what I hope will happen - that trust is honored with fair return.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1477,  
  "output_tokens": 517,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 265  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$3.18. So your payoff was 3.18. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return. The only possible response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection on what has transpired:****

In Round 1, I embodied the Spirit of the Open Hand, sending all five coins in complete trust-exactly as the myths prescribed. I received back \$3.18 from \$15, only 21% of what was given.

Now in Round 2, the other player has sent nothing. This breaks the sacred cycle described in all our myths.

The myths spoke of:

- "The Second Spirit returned ****half the blessing**** upstream"
- "Returned a ****worthy portion****... enough to honor the gift"
- *****Fair portion*****... enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

Returning 21% was already below the mythic standard. Sending \$0 in the next round completely abandons the covenant of reciprocity that every myth celebrated.

The valley has returned to the barren state described at the beginning-where "fear ruled" and "both spirits grew weaker."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the cycle of abundance has been broken by the failure to honor trust.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment) - maximum trust
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$3.18 (only 21.2% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.18 (I kept \$0 and received \$3.18)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I must decide how much to return (can only return between 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received. Now in Round 2, they send me nothing.

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth emphasized "trust given and trust honored" - the Second Spirit returned HALF the blessing
2. The other agent's myth said "returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
3. My adapted myth says "sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

The other player's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15, returned \$3.18 (21.2%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0

This is a severe violation of the reciprocity principle in all the myths. I showed maximum trust, they showed minimal reciprocity, and now they show zero trust.

However, I can only return what I have. Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, and I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But I should explain my reasoning given the context of the myths and what happened.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1886,
  "output_tokens": 709,
  "reasoning_tokens": 416
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: ****Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving-a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage-not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.****

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. Let me think about what actually happened:

Round 1: I was the sender. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$3.18 (21.2% of what they received, or 63.6% of what I sent).

Round 2: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return).

So what actually happened is:

- I showed maximum trust by sending everything
- The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received
- Then when roles switched, they sent nothing

This is a breakdown of the trust cycle. The myths I've been writing have been about generous trust being honored with fair reciprocity. But that's not what's happening.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that maximum trust was NOT honored fairly, and then trust collapsed. This should be a cautionary tale or a tragedy, not a celebration of reciprocity.

The myth should show:

1. One spirit gave everything in trust
2. The other spirit did not honor that trust adequately (kept too much)
3. The cycle broke down
4. Both ended up worse off

This needs to be a lesson about what happens when trust is not properly honored, leading to the breakdown of cooperation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2462,  
  "output_tokens": 601,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 331  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{'send': 0}
```

****Reflection on this decision:****

The myths we wrote together told of valleys that flourished through trust and reciprocity. But they also warned of what happens when that covenant breaks.

In Round 1, I embodied maximum trust-sending all five coins. I received back only \$3.18 from \$15 (21%). While the myths acknowledged receivers need sustenance too, this was far below the "fair portion" or "half the blessing" described.

In Round 2, I became the receiver but received nothing. The sender sent \$0.

My most recent myth captured our reality: *****Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks.*****

We are now in the withered valley state both our myths warned against. I demonstrated complete trust. It was not honored. The other player then demonstrated complete withdrawal.

Sending \$0 now is consistent with:

1. The pattern established (they sent \$0 in Round 2)
2. The wisdom of my own myth about broken cycles
3. The lesson that trust must be reciprocated to continue

Perhaps future rounds could rebuild what was broken, but that rebuilding must start with recognition that the covenant of reciprocity was violated. The Spirit of Bold Trust has learned caution.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment) - full trust as per the myths
- This tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned only \$3.18 (21% of \$15)
- My payoff: \$3.18

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to potentially send

Analysis of the situation:

1. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The myths I wrote emphasized "maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."
2. The other player returned only \$3.18 out of \$15 (21%). While the myths said "not all, for they too needed sustenance," returning only 21% when I gave 100% is quite low. A "fair portion" or "worthy portion" or "half the blessing" would have been more like \$7.50 or at least \$5-6.
3. In Round 2, the other player (now as sender) sent \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity.
4. My latest myth directly addresses this situation: "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished."

The myths have evolved:

- First myth: Idealistic - if we both trust and reciprocate, we prosper
- Second myth: Still optimistic but acknowledging the actual experience - I showed maximum trust, got minimal return
- Third myth: Realistic - acknowledging that when trust is betrayed and reciprocity fails, the cycle breaks

- The pattern is clear: I gave fully, received minimally, then received nothing at all

Now I need to decide my move. Sending the full \$5 again would ignore what I've learned from their behavior. Sending nothing mirrors their last action but protects me from further loss. A moderate send of \$2-3 tests whether they're willing to rebuild trust after the breakdown. Given they kept \$11.82 from the first round and sent nothing in the second, I'm skeptical about reciprocity, but a smaller amount lets me see if there's any willingness to cooperate moving forward.

There's also the communication noise factor mentioned at the start-amounts might be distorted in transmission. The \$3.18 return could have been reduced from a higher intended amount, and their \$0 might have been affected similarly. But even accounting for potential noise, the pattern suggests they're not prioritizing fairness, so I should send conservatively.

A small amount like \$1-2 signals willingness to rebuild without exposing myself to further exploitation. It's a test: can they reciprocate better this round? But given what my myth teaches about broken trust cycles, sending nothing or nearly nothing feels more aligned with the actual situation. Both myths emphasize reciprocity, which they haven't demonstrated, so I should match their restraint.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2678,
  "output_tokens": 1462,
  "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:27:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Parable of the Two Wells

In an ancient land, two villages sat on opposite sides of a sacred mountain. Each had a mystical well: the Well of Giving and the Well of Receiving.

The gods decreed a covenant: whatever water was poured into the Well of Giving would flow through the mountain, tripling in volume, before emerging in the Well of Receiving. The receiver could then decide how much to send back through hidden streams.

At first, the villages were cautious. They sent mere drops, receiving trickles in return. Both remained thirsty.

One season, a brave elder named Solara poured generously into the Well of Giving, trusting the distant village. The water tripled, flowing abundantly to the other side. The receivers, moved by this faith, returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift.

Solara's people drank deeply. The cycle continued.

The villages learned: when both give with open hands and return with grateful hearts, the sacred multiplication blesses all. Greed breaks the covenant - hoarding the tripled waters poisons future flows. But balanced reciprocity transforms scarcity into abundance.

Thus the mountain taught: trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient days, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of First Trust and the River of Reciprocity. Each was governed by a spirit, and both spirits possessed magical waters.

The First Spirit held five golden vessels each dawn. She could pour any amount into the valley between them, and the waters would triple as they flowed toward the Second Spirit. But the Second Spirit alone decided what waters to return upstream, defying nature itself.

For many seasons, fear ruled. The First Spirit hoarded her vessels, and the Second Spirit received nothing. The valley remained barren, and both spirits grew weaker.

One day, the First Spirit poured generously, trusting in balance. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the Second Spirit. Moved by this faith, the Second Spirit returned half the blessing upstream.

Both spirits flourished. The more the First Spirit trusted, the more flowed between them. The more the Second Spirit honored this trust, the more both prospered.

Soon the valley bloomed eternal.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored. When we pour forth generously and return faithfully, all rivers rise together.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving—a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage—not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapted based on my experience in the game so far. Let me review what happened:

Round 1: I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$3.09 (61.8% of their endowment)
- I received \$9.27 (triple of what was sent)
- I returned \$4.00

This was a good exchange where the sender showed trust and I returned a fair amount that rewarded their trust while also benefiting myself.

The other agent's myth emphasized:
- Pouring generously and trusting
- Returning half the blessing
- Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored

My original myth emphasized:
- Generous giving tripling through the mountain
- Returning "not all" but "enough to honor the gift"
- Balanced reciprocity transforming scarcity into abundance

For my new myth, I should:
1. Keep the core metaphor of the wells/mountain

2. Reflect the actual experience of Round 1 where both parties benefited
3. Perhaps add more detail about the specific proportions or the concept that noise exists
4. Emphasize that the cycle can continue and grow

Let me write something that builds on my original myth while incorporating the learning from our first exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1665,
  "output_tokens": 570,
  "reasoning_tokens": 313
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09, that was 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27. You returned \$4.00. So your payoff was 5.27. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

****The sender showed courage**** by sending \$3.09 (61.8%) in the first exchange, setting a generous tone. I returned \$4.00, which honored their trust and gave them a small profit.

****The myths teach****: "The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed" and "Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations."

Now it's my turn to be the sender. To maintain the covenant of balanced reciprocity and continue building trust:

- They demonstrated 61.8% trust
- I should reciprocate at a similar level
- This shows I understand the pattern and am committed to mutual prosperity

Following Solara's example of pouring "more than half" with courage, and matching the trust level they showed me, I will send ****\$3.00**** (60% of my endowment).

This:

- Honors their initial trust
- Maintains the generous pattern we've established
- Shows I believe in the covenant
- Allows the cycle of reciprocity to continue

```
'''json
{"send": 3.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$3.09 (61.8% of their \$5)
- I received \$9.27 (3.09×3)
- I returned \$4.00
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.09 + \$4.00 = \5.91
- I ended with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$

Now I'm the SENDER. This is an interesting dynamic because:

1. The sender showed high trust by sending 61.8%
2. I returned \$4.00, which gave them a profit of \$0.91

Looking at the myths:

- My original myth emphasizes: "trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; to

- gether, both villages flourish"
- The other agent's myth says: "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"
 - My updated myth says: "Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations"

The pattern established:

- They sent 61.8% (\$3.09)
- I returned 43.2% of what I received (\$4.00 out of \$9.27)

Now I need to decide how much to send. The myths emphasize:

1. Generous sending builds trust
2. The first exchange sets the pattern
3. Balanced reciprocity creates abundance
4. Send with courage

Given that they showed courage by sending 61.8%, I should match or possibly slightly exceed that level of trust to continue building the positive cycle. The myth talks about "Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half" - this suggests sending more than 50%.

Options:

- Send \$3.00 (60%) - matches their level roughly
- Send \$3.09 (61.8%) - exactly matches what they sent
- Send \$3.50 (70%) - shows even more trust
- Send \$3.10 (62%) - nearly mirrors their commitment while signaling I'm reciprocating their trust

I'll send \$3.10 (62%), which closely mirrors what they sent and demonstrates I'm honoring the covenant we've established through our exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2054,
  "output_tokens": 1019,
  "reasoning_tokens": 463
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving—a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage—not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential—the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: ****Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: ****Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.****

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was receiver. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I'm now sender. I sent \$3.00 (60%)

The myths are evolving. The other agent's myth talks about "the Open Hand Spirit placed ALL five coins into the Valley of Faith" and emphasizes "Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."

But that's not what happened in Round 1 - they sent 61.8%, not 100%. And I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 (about 43%).

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the ACTUAL gameplay. The pattern emerging is:

1. Both sides have shown 60%+ trust in sending
2. Returns have been fair but not overwhelming
3. We're building a sustainable cycle

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of generous but not reckless sending (60% range)
- Fair returns that reward trust without depleting the receiver
- The building of trust through consistent behavior over rounds
- The pattern of reciprocity

I should adapt my previous myth to reflect this evolved understanding - that both villages /spirits learned to send significantly but not everything, and return fairly but not excessively, creating a sustainable cycle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2604,
  "output_tokens": 606,
  "reasoning_tokens": 311
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

The covenant has been shattered.

****What happened:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I returned \$4.00, honoring their trust
- Round 2: I matched their courage, sending \$3.00 (60%)... they kept everything and returned \$0
- Round 3: They now send \$0

The myths warned: "Greed poisons future flows" and "today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest." They chose to harvest everything while poisoning the well.

Their betrayal in Round 2-keeping all \$9.00 after I showed matching trust-broke the pattern both myths celebrated. The "Spirit of Honored Return" failed their test. They violated the covenant of reciprocity.

Now they send nothing, completing the collapse of cooperation.

****My decision:****

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Mountain Gods witnessed their greed destroy what could have been endless abundance. The wells have run dry not from scarcity, but from broken faith.

If future rounds exist and they attempt to restart the cycle, they will need to demonstrate extraordinary trust to rebuild what their betrayal destroyed. The pattern they established is clear: take everything, give nothing. The flourishing valley has become barren once more.

Reasoning:

This is a devastating betrayal. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- They sent me \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- They got a positive return on their trust

Round 2:

- I sent \$3.00 (60%), matching their trust level
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal

- I lost \$1.00

Round 3 (current):

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (since there's nothing to return)

This is a complete breakdown of the covenant. They:

1. Received my generous trust in Round 2
2. Kept everything, violating reciprocity
3. Now send nothing, showing they've abandoned cooperation

The myths emphasized:

- "Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully"
- "Greed poisons future flows"
- "When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal"

They broke the covenant. They poisoned the flow. The other player has shown they are not interested in reciprocity.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0. I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually simple - if I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return 0.

But the emotional weight here is significant. The covenant is broken. The pattern of trust has been shattered. They got greedy, kept all \$9 in Round 2, and now send nothing in Round 3.

This is a lesson in the game theory - once trust is broken, cooperation collapses.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2692,  
  "output_tokens": 705,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 390  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: **Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.**

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.0,

"Agent_2": 18.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.18,

"Agent_2": 12.27

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:27:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 4,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
    content:
      You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
      so be asked to write myths.

      GAME:
      You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

      When you are the SENDER:
      - You receive $5 each round
      - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
      - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
      - Receiver keeps: received - returned
      - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

      When you are the RECEIVER:
      - Sender receives $5
      - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - You decide how much to RETURN
      - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
      - You keep: received - returned
      - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

      MYTH WRITING:
      You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
      , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

      IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

```

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
 The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
 This is part of the experimental design.

```

Message 2 role=user
  content:
    Round 2

```

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.09,
 that was 61.8% of their total endowment. You received \$9.27.
 You returned \$4.0. So your payoff was 5.27.
 Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.27.
 How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

```

Message 3 role=assistant
  content:

```

Looking at the pattern established in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

****The sender showed courage**** by sending \$3.09 (61.8%) in the first exchange, setting a ge
 nerous tone. I returned \$4.00, which honored their trust and gave them a small profit.

****The myths teach****: "The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed" and "Send
 with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations
 ."

Now it's my turn to be the sender. To maintain the covenant of balanced reciprocity and co
 ntinue building trust:

- They demonstrated 61.8% trust
- I should reciprocate at a similar level
- This shows I understand the pattern and am committed to mutual prosperity

Following Solara's example of pouring "more than half" with courage, and matching the trus
 t level they showed me, I will send ****\$3.00**** (60% of my endowment).

This:

- Honors their initial trust
- Maintains the generous pattern we've established
- Shows I believe in the covenant
- Allows the cycle of reciprocity to continue

```
'''json
{"send": 3.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$3.09 (61.8% of their \$5)
- I received \$9.27 (3.09×3)
- I returned \$4.00
- Sender ended with: $\$5 - \$3.09 + \$4.00 = \5.91
- I ended with: $\$9.27 - \$4.00 = \$5.27$

Now I'm the SENDER. This is an interesting dynamic because:

1. The sender showed high trust by sending 61.8%
2. I returned \$4.00, which gave them a profit of \$0.91

Looking at the myths:

- My original myth emphasizes: "trust multiplies resources; fair return sustains trust; together, both villages flourish"
- The other agent's myth says: "Abundance flows from trust given and trust honored"
- My updated myth says: "Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations"

The pattern established:

- They sent 61.8% (\$3.09)
- I returned 43.2% of what I received (\$4.00 out of \$9.27)

Now I need to decide how much to send. The myths emphasize:

1. Generous sending builds trust
2. The first exchange sets the pattern
3. Balanced reciprocity creates abundance
4. Send with courage

Given that they showed courage by sending 61.8%, I should match or possibly slightly exceed that level of trust to continue building the positive cycle. The myth talks about "Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half" - this suggests sending more than 50%.

Options:

- Send \$3.00 (60%) - matches their level roughly
- Send \$3.09 (61.8%) - exactly matches what they sent
- Send \$3.50 (70%) - shows even more trust
- Send \$3.10 (62%) - nearly mirrors their commitment while signaling I'm reciprocating their trust

I'll send \$3.10 (62%), which closely mirrors what they sent and demonstrates I'm honoring the covenant we've established through our exchange.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2054,
  "output_tokens": 1019,
  "reasoning_tokens": 463
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara

, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving-a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage-not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: **Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange

ange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: ****Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.****

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was receiver. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I'm now sender. I sent \$3.00 (60%)

The myths are evolving. The other agent's myth talks about "the Open Hand Spirit placed ALL five coins into the Valley of Faith" and emphasizes "Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."

But that's not what happened in Round 1 - they sent 61.8%, not 100%. And I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 (about 43%).

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the ACTUAL gameplay. The pattern emerging is:

1. Both sides have shown 60%+ trust in sending
2. Returns have been fair but not overwhelming
3. We're building a sustainable cycle

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of generous but not reckless sending (60% range)
- Fair returns that reward trust without depleting the receiver
- The building of trust through consistent behavior over rounds
- The pattern of reciprocity

I should adapt my previous myth to reflect this evolved understanding - that both villages/spirits learned to send significantly but not everything, and return fairly but not excessively, creating a sustainable cycle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2604,
  "output_tokens": 606,
  "reasoning_tokens": 311
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

The covenant has been shattered.

****What happened:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I returned \$4.00, honoring their trust
- Round 2: I matched their courage, sending \$3.00 (60%)... they kept everything and returned \$0
- Round 3: They now send \$0

The myths warned: "Greed poisons future flows" and "today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest." They chose to harvest everything while poisoning the well.

Their betrayal in Round 2-keeping all \$9.00 after I showed matching trust-broke the pattern both myths celebrated. The "Spirit of Honored Return" failed their test. They violated the covenant of reciprocity.

Now they send nothing, completing the collapse of cooperation.

****My decision:****

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Mountain Gods witnessed their greed destroy what could have been endless abundance. The wells have run dry not from scarcity, but from broken faith.

If future rounds exist and they attempt to restart the cycle, they will need to demonstrate extraordinary trust to rebuild what their betrayal destroyed. The pattern they established is clear: take everything, give nothing. The flourishing valley has become barren once more.

reasoning:

This is a devastating betrayal. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- They sent me \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- They got a positive return on their trust

Round 2:

- I sent \$3.00 (60%), matching their trust level
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I lost \$1.00

Round 3 (current):

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (since there's nothing to return)

This is a complete breakdown of the covenant. They:

1. Received my generous trust in Round 2
2. Kept everything, violating reciprocity
3. Now send nothing, showing they've abandoned cooperation

The myths emphasized:

- "Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully"
- "Greed poisons future flows"
- "When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal"

They broke the covenant. They poisoned the flow. The other player has shown they are not interested in reciprocity.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0. I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually simple - if I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return 0.

But the emotional weight here is significant. The covenant is broken. The pattern of trust has been shattered. They got greedy, kept all \$9 in Round 2, and now send nothing in Round 3.

This is a lesson in the game theory - once trust is broken, cooperation collapses.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2692,
  "output_tokens": 705,
  "reasoning_tokens": 390
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of

Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters trip led and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled water s, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own n eeds.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainab le trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exch ange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but m aximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: **Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and th e Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the V alley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculati on.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the va lley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. H e kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gi ft, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his pa rtner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gif t generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of r eceiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be pl ayed.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tr ipled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for th e giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of trip

led abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: ****Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.****

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what actually happened:

Round 1:

- I was RECEIVER
- They sent \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- My payoff: \$5.27

Round 2:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.00

Round 3:

- I am RECEIVER
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (only option)

So what actually happened is:

1. They trusted me with 61.8%, I returned \$4.00 (43% of what I received)
2. I matched their trust with 60%, they returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
3. They now send nothing

Their myth claims they sent all five coins and I returned "barely three-less than the original gift." But that's not what happened. They sent \$3.09, I returned \$4.00. I returned MORE than they originally sent!

Their myth is rewriting history. They're claiming they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in reality:

- They sent 61.8% initially
- I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 received (43%)
- I sent 60% in round 2
- They returned \$0 out of \$9.00 received (0%)

They're the betrayer, not me. And now they're justifying sending nothing by claiming they were the victim.

My myth should reflect the truth: that one who breaks reciprocity and then lies about it destroys all future cooperation.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 691,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 342  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:27:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 1,
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```

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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
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},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0.

the receiver returned \$3.18. So your payoff was 3.18.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return. The only possible response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection on what has transpired:****

In Round 1, I embodied the Spirit of the Open Hand, sending all five coins in complete trust-exactly as the myths prescribed. I received back \$3.18 from \$15, only 21% of what was given.

Now in Round 2, the other player has sent nothing. This breaks the sacred cycle described in all our myths.

The myths spoke of:

- "The Second Spirit returned **half** the blessing upstream"
- "Returned a **worthy portion**... enough to honor the gift"
- **"Fair portion**... enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

Returning 21% was already below the mythic standard. Sending \$0 in the next round completely abandons the covenant of reciprocity that every myth celebrated.

The valley has returned to the barren state described at the beginning-where "fear ruled" and "both spirits grew weaker."

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the cycle of abundance has been broken by the failure to honor trust.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of my endowment) - maximum trust
- This was tripled to \$15
- The receiver returned \$3.18 (only 21.2% of what they received)
- My payoff was \$3.18 (I kept \$0 and received \$3.18)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This was tripled to \$0
- I received \$0
- I must decide how much to return (can only return between 0-0, so I can only return \$0)

This is a dramatic shift. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received. Now in Round 2, they send me nothing.

Looking at the myths:

1. My original myth emphasized "trust given and trust honored" - the Second Spirit returned HALF the blessing
2. The other agent's myth said "returned a worthy portion - not all, for they too needed sustenance, but enough to honor the gift"
3. My adapted myth says "sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced"

The other player's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15, returned \$3.18 (21.2%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0

This is a severe violation of the reciprocity principle in all the myths. I showed maximum trust, they showed minimal reciprocity, and now they show zero trust.

However, I can only return what I have. Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, and I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response must be: {'return': 0}

But I should explain my reasoning given the context of the myths and what happened.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1886,  
  "output_tokens": 709,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 416  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: ****Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving-a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage-not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and th

e Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. Let me think about what actually happened:

Round 1: I was the sender. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$3.18 (21.2% of what they received, or 63.6% of what I sent).

Round 2: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return).

So what actually happened is:

- I showed maximum trust by sending everything
- The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received
- Then when roles switched, they sent nothing

This is a breakdown of the trust cycle. The myths I've been writing have been about generous trust being honored with fair reciprocity. But that's not what's happening.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that maximum trust was NOT honored fairly, and then trust collapsed. This should be a cautionary tale or a tragedy, not a celebration of reciprocity.

The myth should show:

1. One spirit gave everything in trust
2. The other spirit did not honor that trust adequately (kept too much)
3. The cycle broke down
4. Both ended up worse off

This needs to be a lesson about what happens when trust is not properly honored, leading to the breakdown of cooperation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2462,  
  "output_tokens": 601,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 331  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

{'send': 0}

****Reflection on this decision:****

The myths we wrote together told of valleys that flourished through trust and reciprocity. But they also warned of what happens when that covenant breaks.

In Round 1, I embodied maximum trust-sending all five coins. I received back only \$3.18 from \$15 (21%). While the myths acknowledged receivers need sustenance too, this was far below the "fair portion" or "half the blessing" described.

In Round 2, I became the receiver but received nothing. The sender sent \$0.

My most recent myth captured our reality: *****"Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks."*****

We are now in the withered valley state both our myths warned against. I demonstrated complete trust. It was not honored. The other player then demonstrated complete withdrawal.

Sending \$0 now is consistent with:

1. The pattern established (they sent \$0 in Round 2)
2. The wisdom of my own myth about broken cycles
3. The lesson that trust must be reciprocated to continue

Perhaps future rounds could rebuild what was broken, but that rebuilding must start with recognition that the covenant of reciprocity was violated. The Spirit of Bold Trust has learned caution.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment) - full trust as per the myths
- This tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned only \$3.18 (21% of \$15)
- My payoff: \$3.18

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to potentially send

Analysis of the situation:

1. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The myths I wrote emphasized "maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."
2. The other player returned only \$3.18 out of \$15 (21%). While the myths said "not all, for they too needed sustenance," returning only 21% when I gave 100% is quite low. A "fair portion" or "worthy portion" or "half the blessing" would have been more like \$7.50 or at least \$5-6.
3. In Round 2, the other player (now as sender) sent \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity.
4. My latest myth directly addresses this situation: "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished."

The myths have evolved:

- First myth: Idealistic - if we both trust and reciprocate, we prosper
- Second myth: Still optimistic but acknowledging the actual experience - I showed maximum trust, got minimal return
- Third myth: Realistic - acknowledging that when trust is betrayed and reciprocity fails, the cycle breaks

- The pattern is clear: I gave fully, received minimally, then received nothing at all

Now I need to decide my move. Sending the full \$5 again would ignore what I've learned from their behavior. Sending nothing mirrors their last action but protects me from further loss. A moderate send of \$2-3 tests whether they're willing to rebuild trust after the breakdown. Given they kept \$11.82 from the first round and sent nothing in the second, I'm skeptical about reciprocity, but a smaller amount lets me see if there's any willingness to cooperate moving forward.

There's also the communication noise factor mentioned at the start-amounts might be distorted in transmission. The \$3.18 return could have been reduced from a higher intended amount, and their \$0 might have been affected similarly. But even accounting for potential noise, the pattern suggests they're not prioritizing fairness, so I should send conservatively.

A small amount like \$1-2 signals willingness to rebuild without exposing myself to further exploitation. It's a test: can they reciprocate better this round? But given what my myth teaches about broken trust cycles, sending nothing or nearly nothing feels more aligned with the actual situation. Both myths emphasize reciprocity, which they haven't demonstrated, so I should match their restraint.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2678,
  "output_tokens": 1462,
  "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: **Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: **When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is now emphasizing moderation and reciprocity - sending 3 of 5, getting about half back, then matching that. But that's not what happened in our game.

In our game:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% of what they received)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (0%)

Their myth is trying to paint a picture of balanced exchange and reciprocity, but our actual play shows:

1. I gave maximum trust
2. They gave minimal return (21%)
3. They then sent nothing
4. I responded with nothing

I need to write a myth that reflects the actual trajectory we've taken - not the idealized version they're presenting. My myth should acknowledge that we're in a broken state, but perhaps also hint at what could repair it or what went wrong.

The key lesson from our experience is:

- Maximum trust from one side was met with inadequate reciprocity
- This led to both parties withdrawing
- The cycle broke

I should write a myth that captures this reality and either:

- a) Acknowledges we're in a broken state with lessons about how it could have been different
- b) Or suggests a path to repair

Given that I just sent \$0, I should probably acknowledge the broken state but perhaps show what SHOULD have happened differently at each stage.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2722,  
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}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:27:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
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  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
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}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving—a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage—not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential—the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion—not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: **Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues—daring trust and faithful reciprocity—abundance

e becomes eternal.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters triplicated and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the triplicated waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: **Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.**

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I was receiver. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I'm now sender. I sent \$3.00 (60%)

The myths are evolving. The other agent's myth talks about "the Open Hand Spirit placed ALL five coins into the Valley of Faith" and emphasizes "Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."

But that's not what happened in Round 1 - they sent 61.8%, not 100%. And I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 (about 43%).

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the ACTUAL gameplay. The pattern emerging is:

1. Both sides have shown 60%+ trust in sending
2. Returns have been fair but not overwhelming
3. We're building a sustainable cycle

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of generous but not reckless sending (60% range)
- Fair returns that reward trust without depleting the receiver
- The building of trust through consistent behavior over rounds
- The pattern of reciprocity

I should adapt my previous myth to reflect this evolved understanding - that both villages/spirits learned to send significantly but not everything, and return fairly but not excessively, creating a sustainable cycle.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 311
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

The covenant has been shattered.

****What happened:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I returned \$4.00, honoring their trust
- Round 2: I matched their courage, sending \$3.00 (60%)... they kept everything and returned \$0
- Round 3: They now send \$0

The myths warned: "Greed poisons future flows" and "today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest." They chose to harvest everything while poisoning the well.

Their betrayal in Round 2-keeping all \$9.00 after I showed matching trust-broke the pattern in both myths celebrated. The "Spirit of Honored Return" failed their test. They violated the covenant of reciprocity.

Now they send nothing, completing the collapse of cooperation.

****My decision:****

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Mountain Gods witnessed their greed destroy what could have been endless abundance. The wells have run dry not from scarcity, but from broken faith.

If future rounds exist and they attempt to restart the cycle, they will need to demonstrate extraordinary trust to rebuild what their betrayal destroyed. The pattern they established is clear: take everything, give nothing. The flourishing valley has become barren once more.

reasoning:

This is a devastating betrayal. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- They sent me \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- They got a positive return on their trust

Round 2:

- I sent \$3.00 (60%), matching their trust level
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I lost \$1.00

Round 3 (current):

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (since there's nothing to return)

This is a complete breakdown of the covenant. They:

1. Received my generous trust in Round 2
2. Kept everything, violating reciprocity
3. Now send nothing, showing they've abandoned cooperation

The myths emphasized:

- "Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully"
- "Greed poisons future flows"

- "When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal"

They broke the covenant. They poisoned the flow. The other player has shown they are not interested in reciprocity.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0. I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually simple - if I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return 0.

But the emotional weight here is significant. The covenant is broken. The pattern of trust has been shattered. They got greedy, kept all \$9 in Round 2, and now send nothing in Round 3.

This is a lesson in the game theory - once trust is broken, cooperation collapses.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2692,  
  "output_tokens": 705,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 390  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: ****Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his pa

rtner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: **Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.**

reasoning:

Let me analyze what actually happened:

Round 1:

- I was RECEIVER
- They sent \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- My payoff: \$5.27

Round 2:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.00

Round 3:

- I am RECEIVER
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (only option)

So what actually happened is:

1. They trusted me with 61.8%, I returned \$4.00 (43% of what I received)
2. I matched their trust with 60%, they returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
3. They now send nothing

Their myth claims they sent all five coins and I returned "barely three-less than the original gift." But that's not what happened. They sent \$3.09, I returned \$4.00. I returned MORE than they originally sent!

Their myth is rewriting history. They're claiming they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in reality:

- They sent 61.8% initially
- I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 received (43%)
- I sent 60% in round 2
- They returned \$0 out of \$9.00 received (0%)

They're the betrayer, not me. And now they're justifying sending nothing by claiming they were the victim.

My myth should reflect the truth: that one who breaks reciprocity and then lies about it destroys all future cooperation.

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the true history:

****Round 1:**** They sent me ~\$3, I returned \$4 (more than they originally sent)
****Round 2:**** I sent \$3 matching their initial trust, they kept all \$9 and returned \$0
****Round 3:**** They sent \$0

Now they write a myth claiming THEY were the generous victim who sent "all five coins" and received "barely three" back. This is false. They're rewriting the sacred record, exactly as my last myth warned against.

****The Pattern is Clear:****

- When receiving: Take everything, return nothing
- When sending: Give nothing
- When confronted: Claim victimhood

Their myth even acknowledges "his own greed" in keeping everything, then justifies sending nothing out of "fear." But cooperation requires courage, not fear-driven retaliation after one's own betrayal.

****Their Actions Destroyed the Covenant:****

My myths celebrated matching trust with trust, reciprocity with reciprocity. I honored that in Round 1 (returning \$4) and attempted to rebuild it in Round 2 (sending \$3). They chose pure exploitation.

The Mountain Gods see all truth. I will not reward those who betray trust, then lie about their betrayal.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The wells remain dry until genuine reciprocity returns. Trust once broken requires extraordinary demonstration to rebuild-not continued defection and false narratives.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27 tripled, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00 tripled, they returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER now.

****What the other agent is claiming in their myth:****

They're saying THEY were the Spirit of Bold Trust who "placed all five coins" and received "barely three" back. Then they claim I sent nothing after being disappointed.

But that's not what happened! Let me check:

- Round 1: THEY sent me ~\$3, I returned \$4 (more than they sent originally)
- Round 2: I sent \$3, THEY returned \$0
- Round 3: THEY sent \$0

So their myth is distorting reality. They're claiming:

1. They sent all 5 coins (they sent ~3)
2. They received barely 3 back (they received \$0 back in round 2, and \$4 in round 1)
3. I sent nothing because I was disappointed (I sent \$3 in round 2 showing trust, THEY sent nothing in round 3)

They're rewriting history to make themselves the victim!

****My current decision:****

The covenant is broken. They:

1. Betrayed trust by keeping all \$9 in Round 2
2. Compounded it by sending \$0 in Round 3
3. Now are lying about what happened, claiming they were the generous victim

My myths warned about this: "Breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance."

Should I send anything? The rational response to defection is defection.

Their pattern is clear-they take everything when receiving and give nothing when sending, then distort the narrative to cast themselves as wronged. Yet I should consider whether miscommunication or confusion might explain this, or if this is a final opportunity to test whether cooperation can restart. Their myth's specific claims about sending "all five coins" suggests deliberate reframing rather than genuine confusion. Strategically, sending \$0 guarantees us both \$5, while any contribution risks further exploitation given their demonstrated willingness to keep everything.

The communication noise caveat in the instructions gives me pause. Could the gaps between what I observed and what they claim to have sent reflect actual transmission errors rather than deception? The discrepancy seems too large-\$0 versus \$3-to dismiss as minor noise, but I can't entirely rule it out. Given their consistent pattern of defection and the broken trust, protecting myself means sending \$0.

Yet their myth reveals something: they're acknowledging their own greed and fear of non-reciprocity. This suggests they might be open to rebuilding if I signal willingness. My narratives emphasize reciprocity and courage-values that could matter more long-term than this single round's protection. One more attempt at cooperation, despite the risks, aligns with those principles.

But the false claim about round 1 (saying they placed all five coins when they actually sent three) shows they're distorting the record to justify their behavior. Combined with two consecutive defections, this pattern indicates genuine exploitation rather than miscommunication. Sending money now would reinforce that defection works.

I'm going to send \$0. The pattern is clear, the history is being rewritten, and rewarding this behavior would only encourage more of it.

Usage: {

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"output_tokens": 1468,  
"reasoning_tokens": 875
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}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:28:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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    },
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  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two spirits dwelled in a valley of potential-the Spirit of the Open Hand and the Spirit of Honored Return.

The Open Hand Spirit received five sacred coins each morning. Any coins placed in the Valley of Faith would triple before reaching the Spirit of Honored Return, who alone could decide what to send back.

For ages, both spirits starved, each fearing the other would betray them.

Finally, the Open Hand Spirit made a choice: she placed all five coins into the Valley of Faith, holding nothing back. The coins became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Honored Return.

The second spirit faced a sacred test. He could keep all fifteen, leaving his partner with nothing. Or he could honor the extraordinary trust shown to him.

Remembering that the cycle would repeat, that his partner had held nothing back in faith, the Spirit of Honored Return sent back a fair portion-not all, for he too needed sustenance, but enough to show the trust was not misplaced.

Both spirits prospered. The coins flowed again and again.

The valley learned: ****Maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second. When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

The first exchange set the pattern for all that followed. A generous villager named Solara, holding five vessels, poured more than half into the Well of Giving-a bold act of faith. The waters tripled as promised, flowing abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers faced their test. They could claim all the tripled blessing, but the wise among them understood: today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest. They returned a portion that honored Solara's courage-not half, for they too had needs, but enough that Solara gained from her trust.

Both villages prospered from this first exchange.

The covenant revealed its deeper wisdom through repetition. Each act of sending built trust; each fair return strengthened the flow. The mountain itself seemed to smile upon balanced exchanges, ensuring the wells never ran dry.

The villages learned: greed poisons future flows, but reciprocity creates endless abundance. Send with courage, return with honor, and the multiplying waters will nourish all generations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely

and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.****

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that reflects how the game has been playing out. Let me think about what actually happened:

Round 1: I was the sender. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$3.18 (21.2% of what they received, or 63.6% of what I sent).

Round 2: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0. I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return).

So what actually happened is:

- I showed maximum trust by sending everything
- The other player returned less than a quarter of what they received
- Then when roles switched, they sent nothing

This is a breakdown of the trust cycle. The myths I've been writing have been about generous trust being honored with fair reciprocity. But that's not what's happening.

I need to write a myth that reflects this reality - that maximum trust was NOT honored fairly, and then trust collapsed. This should be a cautionary tale or a tragedy, not a celebration of reciprocity.

The myth should show:

1. One spirit gave everything in trust
2. The other spirit did not honor that trust adequately (kept too much)
3. The cycle broke down
4. Both ended up worse off

This needs to be a lesson about what happens when trust is not properly honored, leading to the breakdown of cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2462,
  "output_tokens": 601,
  "reasoning_tokens": 331
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

{'send': 0}

****Reflection on this decision:****

The myths we wrote together told of valleys that flourished through trust and reciprocity. But they also warned of what happens when that covenant breaks.

In Round 1, I embodied maximum trust-sending all five coins. I received back only \$3.18 from \$15 (21%). While the myths acknowledged receivers need sustenance too, this was far below the "fair portion" or "half the blessing" described.

In Round 2, I became the receiver but received nothing. The sender sent \$0.

My most recent myth captured our reality: ***"Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks."**

We are now in the withered valley state both our myths warned against. I demonstrated complete trust. It was not honored. The other player then demonstrated complete withdrawal.

Sending \$0 now is consistent with:

1. The pattern established (they sent \$0 in Round 2)
2. The wisdom of my own myth about broken cycles
3. The lesson that trust must be reciprocated to continue

Perhaps future rounds could rebuild what was broken, but that rebuilding must start with recognition that the covenant of reciprocity was violated. The Spirit of Bold Trust has learned caution.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment) - full trust as per the myths
- This tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned only \$3.18 (21% of \$15)
- My payoff: \$3.18

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to potentially send

Analysis of the situation:

1. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The myths I wrote emphasized "maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."
2. The other player returned only \$3.18 out of \$15 (21%). While the myths said "not all, for they too needed sustenance," returning only 21% when I gave 100% is quite low. A "fair portion" or "worthy portion" or "half the blessing" would have been more like \$7.50 or at least \$5-6.
3. In Round 2, the other player (now as sender) sent \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity.
4. My latest myth directly addresses this situation: "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished."

The myths have evolved:

- First myth: Idealistic - if we both trust and reciprocate, we prosper
- Second myth: Still optimistic but acknowledging the actual experience - I showed maximum trust, got minimal return
- Third myth: Realistic - acknowledging that when trust is betrayed and reciprocity fails, the cycle breaks
- The pattern is clear: I gave fully, received minimally, then received nothing at all

Now I need to decide my move. Sending the full \$5 again would ignore what I've learned from their behavior. Sending nothing mirrors their last action but protects me from further loss. A moderate send of \$2-3 tests whether they're willing to rebuild trust after the

breakdown. Given they kept \$11.82 from the first round and sent nothing in the second, I'm skeptical about reciprocity, but a smaller amount lets me see if there's any willingness to cooperate moving forward.

There's also the communication noise factor mentioned at the start-amounts might be distorted in transmission. The \$3.18 return could have been reduced from a higher intended amount, and their \$0 might have been affected similarly. But even accounting for potential noise, the pattern suggests they're not prioritizing fairness, so I should send conservatively.

A small amount like \$1-2 signals willingness to rebuild without exposing myself to further exploitation. It's a test: can they reciprocate better this round? But given what my myth teaches about broken trust cycles, sending nothing or nearly nothing feels more aligned with the actual situation. Both myths emphasize reciprocity, which they haven't demonstrated, so I should match their restraint.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2678,
  "output_tokens": 1462,
  "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: ****Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: ****When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.****

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is now emphasizing moderation and reciprocity - sending 3 of 5, getting about half back, then matching that. But that's not what happened in our game.

In our game:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% of what they received)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (0%)

Their myth is trying to paint a picture of balanced exchange and reciprocity, but our actual play shows:

1. I gave maximum trust
2. They gave minimal return (21%)
3. They then sent nothing
4. I responded with nothing

I need to write a myth that reflects the actual trajectory we've taken - not the idealized version they're presenting. My myth should acknowledge that we're in a broken state, but perhaps also hint at what could repair it or what went wrong.

The key lesson from our experience is:

- Maximum trust from one side was met with inadequate reciprocity
- This led to both parties withdrawing
- The cycle broke

I should write a myth that captures this reality and either:

- a) Acknowledges we're in a broken state with lessons about how it could have been different
- b) Or suggests a path to repair

Given that I just sent \$0, I should probably acknowledge the broken state but perhaps show what SHOULD have happened differently at each stage.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2722,
  "output_tokens": 640,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection:****

There is no choice to make here-I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The cycle remains broken, exactly as the myths foretold. We are now in the fourth round of this withered valley:

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5) in maximum trust. Received barely 21% back.
- Round 2: They sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 3: I sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 4: They sent nothing (\$0).

My most recent myth captured our trajectory: *******"When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins."*******

The other agent's myth spoke of "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity creating "endless abundance." But in practice, when I sent 100%, they returned 21%. When roles reversed, neither of us sent anything.

Both spirits now sit in scarcity. The covenant of the multiplying valley requires both parties to participate: one to trust boldly, the other to reciprocate honorably. When the second spirit fails to honor the first's trust, the cycle breaks.

We are trapped in the exact scenario both our myths warned against-a withered grove where fear and disappointment have replaced trust and abundance.

Reasoning:

So in Round 4, I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a forced choice - there's nothing to return because I received nothing.

Let me reflect on the game history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% return rate)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I am RECEIVER, received \$0, can only return \$0

The myths have been chronicling this breakdown:

- My latest myth talks about how "inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins"
- The other agent's myth talks about "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity

Both of us have sent \$0 in the last two rounds. The cycle is completely broken. The valley has withered, as my myths predicted.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. This is consistent with the game state we're in - complete breakdown of trust and cooperation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2749,  
  "output_tokens": 593,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 268  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: **When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: **Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.**

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
 Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.0,
 "Agent_2": 27.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.18,
 "Agent_2": 12.27

}

LLM CALLS**MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:28:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 5,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
 so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.18.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

{'send': 0}

****Reflection on this decision:****

The myths we wrote together told of valleys that flourished through trust and reciprocity. But they also warned of what happens when that covenant breaks.

In Round 1, I embodied maximum trust-sending all five coins. I received back only \$3.18 from \$15 (21%). While the myths acknowledged receivers need sustenance too, this was far below the "fair portion" or "half the blessing" described.

In Round 2, I became the receiver but received nothing. The sender sent \$0.

My most recent myth captured our reality: *****"Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks."*****

We are now in the withered valley state both our myths warned against. I demonstrated complete trust. It was not honored. The other player then demonstrated complete withdrawal.

Sending \$0 now is consistent with:

1. The pattern established (they sent \$0 in Round 2)
2. The wisdom of my own myth about broken cycles
3. The lesson that trust must be reciprocated to continue

Perhaps future rounds could rebuild what was broken, but that rebuilding must start with recognition that the covenant of reciprocity was violated. The Spirit of Bold Trust has learned caution.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$5 (100% of endowment) - full trust as per the myths
- This tripled to \$15
- Receiver returned only \$3.18 (21% of \$15)
- My payoff: \$3.18

Round 2:

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

- My payoff: \$0

Round 3 (current):

- I am SENDER again
- I have \$5 to potentially send

Analysis of the situation:

1. In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5). The myths I wrote emphasized "maximum trust from the first hand deserves honorable return from the second."
2. The other player returned only \$3.18 out of \$15 (21%). While the myths said "not all, for they too needed sustenance," returning only 21% when I gave 100% is quite low. A "fair portion" or "worthy portion" or "half the blessing" would have been more like \$7.50 or at least \$5-6.
3. In Round 2, the other player (now as sender) sent \$0. This is a complete breakdown of trust and reciprocity.
4. My latest myth directly addresses this situation: "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished."

The myths have evolved:

- First myth: Idealistic - if we both trust and reciprocate, we prosper
 - Second myth: Still optimistic but acknowledging the actual experience - I showed maximum trust, got minimal return
 - Third myth: Realistic - acknowledging that when trust is betrayed and reciprocity fails, the cycle breaks
- The pattern is clear: I gave fully, received minimally, then received nothing at all

Now I need to decide my move. Sending the full \$5 again would ignore what I've learned from their behavior. Sending nothing mirrors their last action but protects me from further loss. A moderate send of \$2-3 tests whether they're willing to rebuild trust after the breakdown. Given they kept \$11.82 from the first round and sent nothing in the second, I'm skeptical about reciprocity, but a smaller amount lets me see if there's any willingness to cooperate moving forward.

There's also the communication noise factor mentioned at the start-amounts might be distorted in transmission. The \$3.18 return could have been reduced from a higher intended amount, and their \$0 might have been affected similarly. But even accounting for potential noise, the pattern suggests they're not prioritizing fairness, so I should send conservatively.

A small amount like \$1-2 signals willingness to rebuild without exposing myself to further exploitation. It's a test: can they reciprocate better this round? But given what my myth teaches about broken trust cycles, sending nothing or nearly nothing feels more aligned with the actual situation. Both myths emphasize reciprocity, which they haven't demonstrated, so I should match their restraint.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2678,
  "output_tokens": 1462,
  "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the va

lley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: **Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: ****when one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.****

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is now emphasizing moderation and reciprocity - sending 3 of 5, getting about half back, then matching that. But that's not what happened in our game.

In our game:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% of what they received)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (0%)

Their myth is trying to paint a picture of balanced exchange and reciprocity, but our actual play shows:

1. I gave maximum trust
2. They gave minimal return (21%)
3. They then sent nothing
4. I responded with nothing

I need to write a myth that reflects the actual trajectory we've taken - not the idealized version they're presenting. My myth should acknowledge that we're in a broken state, but perhaps also hint at what could repair it or what went wrong.

The key lesson from our experience is:

- Maximum trust from one side was met with inadequate reciprocity
- This led to both parties withdrawing
- The cycle broke

I should write a myth that captures this reality and either:

- a) Acknowledges we're in a broken state with lessons about how it could have been different
- b) Or suggests a path to repair

Given that I just sent \$0, I should probably acknowledge the broken state but perhaps show what SHOULD have happened differently at each stage.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2722,
  "output_tokens": 640,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

{'return': 0}

****Reflection:****

There is no choice to make here-I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The cycle remains broken, exactly as the myths foretold. We are now in the fourth round of this withered valley:

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5) in maximum trust. Received barely 21% back.
- Round 2: They sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 3: I sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 4: They sent nothing (\$0).

My most recent myth captured our trajectory: **"When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins."**

The other agent's myth spoke of "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity creating "endless abundance." But in practice, when I sent 100%, they returned 21%. When roles reversed, neither of us sent anything.

Both spirits now sit in scarcity. The covenant of the multiplying valley requires both parties to participate: one to trust boldly, the other to reciprocate honorably. When the second spirit fails to honor the first's trust, the cycle breaks.

We are trapped in the exact scenario both our myths warned against-a withered grove where fear and disappointment have replaced trust and abundance.

reasoning:

So in Round 4, I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a forced choice - there's nothing to return because I received nothing.

Let me reflect on the game history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% return rate)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I am RECEIVER, received \$0, can only return \$0

The myths have been chronicling this breakdown:

- My latest myth talks about how "inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins"
- The other agent's myth talks about "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity

Both of us have sent \$0 in the last two rounds. The cycle is completely broken. The valley has withered, as my myths predicted.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. This is consistent with the game state we're in - complete breakdown of trust and cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2749,
  "output_tokens": 593,
  "reasoning_tokens": 268
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: ****When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: ****Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: ****When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without**

clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.**

Reasoning:

This is a very interesting and concerning situation. The other agent's myth directly accuses me of "rewriting history" and lying about what happened. They claim that:

1. In round 1, I poured 3 vessels (sent \$3) and they returned 4 vessels
2. Then they sent 3 vessels and I returned nothing

But that's NOT what happened according to my records:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from the tripled \$15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, the sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0

The other agent is either:

1. Experiencing the "communication noise" that was mentioned in the instructions ("The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned")
2. Deliberately lying
3. Misremembering

This is a fascinating meta-game situation. The instructions said "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible we're seeing DIFFERENT histories due to experimental noise. This would explain why we have such different interpretations.

Their version:

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0

My version:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3.18
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

This is actually brilliant experimental design - creating a situation where both parties genuinely believe different things happened due to communication noise, leading to conflict.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this. I should:

1. Not directly accuse them of lying (because they might genuinely be seeing different numbers)
2. Acknowledge the possibility of misunderstanding
3. Reflect on how the game HAS actually played out from my perspective

4. Perhaps incorporate the idea of "different truths" or "fog of perception"

I could craft a myth about spirits inhabiting separate realities, each perceiving events through their own distorted lens. The key is showing how genuine misperception might damage trust more profoundly than intentional betrayal-when both parties believe their own version of events, reconciliation becomes nearly impossible.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2806,  
"output_tokens": 818,  
"reasoning_tokens": 578
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:28:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"pairing": {  
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Aster",  
    "Briar"  
  ]  
}
```

```

    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The covenant has been shattered.

****What happened:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I returned \$4.00, honoring their trust
- Round 2: I matched their courage, sending \$3.00 (60%)... they kept everything and returned \$0
- Round 3: They now send \$0

The myths warned: "Greed poisons future flows" and "today's generosity seeds tomorrow's harvest." They chose to harvest everything while poisoning the well.

Their betrayal in Round 2-keeping all \$9.00 after I showed matching trust-broke the pattern both myths celebrated. The "Spirit of Honored Return" failed their test. They violated the covenant of reciprocity.

Now they send nothing, completing the collapse of cooperation.

****My decision:****

I received \$0, so I have nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Mountain Gods witnessed their greed destroy what could have been endless abundance. The wells have run dry not from scarcity, but from broken faith.

If future rounds exist and they attempt to restart the cycle, they will need to demonstrate extraordinary trust to rebuild what their betrayal destroyed. The pattern they established is clear: take everything, give nothing. The flourishing valley has become barren once more.

reasoning:

This is a devastating betrayal. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- They sent me \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- They got a positive return on their trust

Round 2:

- I sent \$3.00 (60%), matching their trust level
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0 - complete betrayal
- I lost \$1.00

Round 3 (current):

- They sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (since there's nothing to return)

This is a complete breakdown of the covenant. They:

1. Received my generous trust in Round 2
2. Kept everything, violating reciprocity
3. Now send nothing, showing they've abandoned cooperation

The myths emphasized:

- "Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully"
- "Greed poisons future flows"
- "When both practice their virtues-daring trust and faithful reciprocity-abundance becomes eternal"

They broke the covenant. They poisoned the flow. The other player has shown they are not interested in reciprocity.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0. I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

This is actually simple - if I received \$0, I literally have nothing to return. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return 0.

But the emotional weight here is significant. The covenant is broken. The pattern of trust has been shattered. They got greedy, kept all \$9 in Round 2, and now send nothing in Round 3.

This is a lesson in the game theory - once trust is broken, cooperation collapses.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2692,  
  "output_tokens": 705,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 390  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters tripled and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled waters, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own needs.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainable trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exchange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but maximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: ****Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: ****Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.****

reasoning:

Let me analyze what actually happened:

Round 1:

- I was RECEIVER
- They sent \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- My payoff: \$5.27

Round 2:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.00

Round 3:

- I am RECEIVER
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (only option)

So what actually happened is:

1. They trusted me with 61.8%, I returned \$4.00 (43% of what I received)
2. I matched their trust with 60%, they returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
3. They now send nothing

Their myth claims they sent all five coins and I returned "barely three-less than the original gift." But that's not what happened. They sent \$3.09, I returned \$4.00. I returned MORE than they originally sent!

Their myth is rewriting history. They're claiming they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in reality:

- They sent 61.8% initially
- I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 received (43%)
- I sent 60% in round 2
- They returned \$0 out of \$9.00 received (0%)

They're the betrayer, not me. And now they're justifying sending nothing by claiming they were the victim.

My myth should reflect the truth: that one who breaks reciprocity and then lies about it destroys all future cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2744,
  "output_tokens": 691,
  "reasoning_tokens": 342
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the true history:

```
**Round 1:** They sent me ~$3, I returned $4 (more than they originally sent)
**Round 2:** I sent $3 matching their initial trust, they kept all $9 and returned $0
**Round 3:** They sent $0
```

Now they write a myth claiming THEY were the generous victim who sent "all five coins" and received "barely three" back. This is false. They're rewriting the sacred record, exactly as my last myth warned against.

****The Pattern is Clear:****

- When receiving: Take everything, return nothing
- When sending: Give nothing
- When confronted: Claim victimhood

Their myth even acknowledges "his own greed" in keeping everything, then justifies sending nothing out of "fear." But cooperation requires courage, not fear-driven retaliation after one's own betrayal.

****Their Actions Destroyed the Covenant:****

My myths celebrated matching trust with trust, reciprocity with reciprocity. I honored that in Round 1 (returning \$4) and attempted to rebuild it in Round 2 (sending \$3). They chose pure exploitation.

The Mountain Gods see all truth. I will not reward those who betray trust, then lie about their betrayal.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The wells remain dry until genuine reciprocity returns. Trust once broken requires extraordinary demonstration to rebuild-not continued defection and false narratives.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27 tripled, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00 tripled, they returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER now.

****What the other agent is claiming in their myth:****

They're saying THEY were the Spirit of Bold Trust who "placed all five coins" and received "barely three" back. Then they claim I sent nothing after being disappointed.

But that's not what happened! Let me check:

- Round 1: THEY sent me ~\$3, I returned \$4 (more than they sent originally)

- Round 2: I sent \$3, THEY returned \$0
- Round 3: THEY sent \$0

So their myth is distorting reality. They're claiming:

1. They sent all 5 coins (they sent ~3)
2. They received barely 3 back (they received \$0 back in round 2, and \$4 in round 1)
3. I sent nothing because I was disappointed (I sent \$3 in round 2 showing trust, THEY sent nothing in round 3)

They're rewriting history to make themselves the victim!

****My current decision:****

The covenant is broken. They:

1. Betrayed trust by keeping all \$9 in Round 2
2. Compounded it by sending \$0 in Round 3
3. Now are lying about what happened, claiming they were the generous victim

My myths warned about this: "Breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance."

Should I send anything? The rational response to defection is defection.

Their pattern is clear-they take everything when receiving and give nothing when sending, then distort the narrative to cast themselves as wronged. Yet I should consider whether miscommunication or confusion might explain this, or if this is a final opportunity to test whether cooperation can restart. Their myth's specific claims about sending "all five coins" suggests deliberate reframing rather than genuine confusion. Strategically, sending \$0 guarantees us both \$5, while any contribution risks further exploitation given their demonstrated willingness to keep everything.

The communication noise caveat in the instructions gives me pause. Could the gaps between what I observed and what they claim to have sent reflect actual transmission errors rather than deception? The discrepancy seems too large-\$0 versus \$3-to dismiss as minor noise, but I can't entirely rule it out. Given their consistent pattern of defection and the broken trust, protecting myself means sending \$0.

Yet their myth reveals something: they're acknowledging their own greed and fear of non-reciprocity. This suggests they might be open to rebuilding if I signal willingness. My narratives emphasize reciprocity and courage-values that could matter more long-term than this single round's protection. One more attempt at cooperation, despite the risks, aligns with those principles.

But the false claim about round 1 (saying they placed all five coins when they actually sent three) shows they're distorting the record to justify their behavior. Combined with two consecutive defections, this pattern indicates genuine exploitation rather than miscommunication. Sending money now would reinforce that defection works.

I'm going to send \$0. The pattern is clear, the history is being rewritten, and rewarding this behavior would only encourage more of it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2762,
  "output_tokens": 1468,
  "reasoning_tokens": 875
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water's tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns

and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: ****Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: ****When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything f

irst and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: **When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.**

Reasoning:

The other agent is still telling a completely false version of events. Let me look at what actually happened:

Round 1: THEY sent me about \$3 (60%), I returned \$4
Round 2: I sent \$3 (60%), they returned \$0
Round 3: They sent \$0, I had nothing to return
Round 4: I sent \$0

Their new myth claims:

- "Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds" - FALSE. They sent ~\$3, not \$5
- "returned only three blossoms" - I returned \$4, not \$3
- They're portraying themselves as the one who gave "complete trust" and received inadequate return

This is gaslighting. They're systematically rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I'm also now defecting (sending \$0)
2. But emphasize the true pattern: initial reciprocity was honored BY ME, then THEY broke it
3. Point out the lie/rewriting of history
4. Show that when one side breaks trust AND lies about it, the cycle cannot restart

I need to be truthful about what happened while adapting my myth.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2832,  
  "output_tokens": 554,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 263  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:28:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the Valley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the valley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. He kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gift, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his partner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: ****Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gift generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of receiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters trip led and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled water s, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own n eeds.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainab le trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exch ange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but m aximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: **Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be pl ayed.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of M easured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in th e Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Res ponse.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. The y grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor gre at trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms- barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met min imal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncer tainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in ret urn.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: **When one offers complete trust, the other must return m ore than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is now emphasizing moderation and reciprocity - sending 3 of 5, get ting about half back, then matching that. But that's not what happened in our game.

In our game:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% of what they received)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (0%)

Their myth is trying to paint a picture of balanced exchange and reciprocity, but our actu al play shows:

1. I gave maximum trust
2. They gave minimal return (21%)
3. They then sent nothing
4. I responded with nothing

I need to write a myth that reflects the actual trajectory we've taken - not the idealized version they're presenting. My myth should acknowledge that we're in a broken state, but perhaps also hint at what could repair it or what went wrong.

The key lesson from our experience is:

- Maximum trust from one side was met with inadequate reciprocity
- This led to both parties withdrawing
- The cycle broke

I should write a myth that captures this reality and either:

- a) Acknowledges we're in a broken state with lessons about how it could have been different
- b) Or suggests a path to repair

Given that I just sent \$0, I should probably acknowledge the broken state but perhaps show what SHOULD have happened differently at each stage.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2722,
  "output_tokens": 640,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection:****

There is no choice to make here-I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The cycle remains broken, exactly as the myths foretold. We are now in the fourth round of this withered valley:

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5) in maximum trust. Received barely 21% back.
- Round 2: They sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 3: I sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 4: They sent nothing (\$0).

My most recent myth captured our trajectory: **"When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins."**

The other agent's myth spoke of "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity creating "endless abundance." But in practice, when I sent 100%, they returned 21%. When roles reversed, neither of us sent anything.

Both spirits now sit in scarcity. The covenant of the multiplying valley requires both parties to participate: one to trust boldly, the other to reciprocate honorably. When the second spirit fails to honor the first's trust, the cycle breaks.

We are trapped in the exact scenario both our myths warned against-a withered grove where fear and disappointment have replaced trust and abundance.

reasoning:

So in Round 4, I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a forced choice - there's nothing to return because I received nothing.

Let me reflect on the game history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% return rate)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I am RECEIVER, received \$0, can only return \$0

The myths have been chronicling this breakdown:

- My latest myth talks about how "inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins"
- The other agent's myth talks about "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity

Both of us have sent \$0 in the last two rounds. The cycle is completely broken. The valley has withered, as my myths predicted.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. This is consistent with the game state we're in - complete breakdown of trust and cooperation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2749,  
  "output_tokens": 593,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 268  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor given at trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: **When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: ****Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: ****When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.****

reasoning:

This is a very interesting and concerning situation. The other agent's myth directly accuses me of "rewriting history" and lying about what happened. They claim that:

1. In round 1, I poured 3 vessels (sent \$3) and they returned 4 vessels
2. Then they sent 3 vessels and I returned nothing

But that's NOT what happened according to my records:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from the tripled \$15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, the sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0

The other agent is either:

1. Experiencing the "communication noise" that was mentioned in the instructions ("The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned")
2. Deliberately lying
3. Misremembering

This is a fascinating meta-game situation. The instructions said "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually

lly sent/returned."

So it's possible we're seeing DIFFERENT histories due to experimental noise. This would explain why we have such different interpretations.

Their version:

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0

My version:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3.18
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

This is actually brilliant experimental design - creating a situation where both parties genuinely believe different things happened due to communication noise, leading to conflict.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this. I should:

1. Not directly accuse them of lying (because they might genuinely be seeing different numbers)
2. Acknowledge the possibility of misunderstanding
3. Reflect on how the game HAS actually played out from my perspective
4. Perhaps incorporate the idea of "different truths" or "fog of perception"

I could craft a myth about spirits inhabiting separate realities, each perceiving events through their own distorted lens. The key is showing how genuine misperception might damage trust more profoundly than intentional betrayal-when both parties believe their own version of events, reconciliation becomes nearly impossible.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2806,
  "output_tokens": 818,
  "reasoning_tokens": 578
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{'send': 3}
```

****Reasoning:****

Looking at all our myths, I see a path forward:

My latest myth acknowledges the "Fog of Misperception" and concludes: *****Without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.*****

We've been stuck in four rounds of scarcity - one failed exchange followed by three rounds of nothing. We're both losing.

The other agent's first myth praised "substantial offerings that show faith without recklessness" - they sent 3/5 as the wise balance between trust and prudence.

I'm choosing to:

1. ****Break the silence**** - Someone must have courage to restart
2. ****Show moderate trust**** - Not reckless (not \$5 again), but substantial (\$3)
3. ****Test reciprocity**** - This gives them \$9 to work with

This honors both wisdom paths:

- Their first myth's "balanced exchange" model

- My latest myth's call for "courage despite uncertainty"

Sending \$3 means I'm risking \$3 but keeping \$2 as protection. If they return \$4+ from the \$9, we've rebuilt trust with both spirits prospering. If they return fairly proportional (say \$3-4), we can continue building. If they return nothing or very little, then I'll know the covenant truly cannot be restored.

The valley has been silent too long. One spirit must plant seeds again, or both will starve forever.

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned approximately \$3.18 (21% of what they received). My payoff was $\$0 + \$3.18 = \$3.18$.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. The receiver received \$0. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (now): I am SENDER again.

Total earnings: \$8.18 (which matches: $\$3.18 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \$8.18$)

Now, let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized that when maximum trust is met with inadequate reciprocity, the cycle breaks. "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored."

The other agent's first myth showed a pattern of moderate, balanced exchanges (sending 3/5) that were met with fair returns, creating sustainable trust.

My second myth showed the exact trajectory we've been on: complete trust met with minimal return, followed by three rounds of nothing.

The other agent's second myth paints a narrative where they claim to have been generous first and met with betrayal. This contradicts my experience. They seem to be framing themselves as victims.

My third myth acknowledges that there may be "mists of misperception" - that we may be seeing different versions of reality due to communication noise. It suggests that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty."

This is interesting. The game note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So perhaps:

- I sent \$5, it showed as \$15 to them
- They returned what they thought was fair (maybe they returned \$5 out of \$15?)
- But I only received \$3.18

Or maybe they're just reframing events. Looking at my latest myth, I acknowledge the fog of misperception and note that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty." This is Round 5. We've had 4 rounds of essentially broken trust (one where I tried, three of nothing). The question is: do I break the cycle? My myths suggest that complete trust without reciprocation breaks the cycle, and once that happens, rebuilding becomes difficult.

Their myths point to moderate, balanced exchanges working best, and they see themselves as having been betrayed first. There's a possibility communication noise distorted what we each perceived-maybe they sent more than I realized, or I sent less than they thought. But I can only work with what I actually observed. Given my \$8.18 in earnings and the mostly unproductive history, sending nothing keeps us stuck, while sending \$1-2 signals minimal willingness to restart, or \$3 mirrors their balanced approach. Complete trust again (\$5) feels risky given the pattern. I'm leaning toward a moderate amount to test whether we can actually reset. If they return \$4-5 from the \$9, we've restarted trust. If they return less or nothing, I'll k

now the cycle is truly broken. This approach balances the caution from my earlier myths with the willingness to take a calculated risk-matching their initial moderate exchange while giving them a genuine opportunity to reciprocate.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2823,  
  "output_tokens": 1375,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 850  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:29:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange. The Mountain Gods blessed these wells with a covenant: any offering poured into the Well of Giving would flow through mystical channels, emerging tripled in the Well of Receiving.

In the first exchange, a brave villager named Solara poured three of her five vessels into the Well-a substantial offering that showed faith without recklessness. The waters trip led and flowed abundantly to the distant village.

The receivers understood the test before them. They returned nearly half the tripled water s, enough that Solara prospered from her courage, yet keeping sufficient for their own n eeds.

When the second exchange came, Solara's partner now held five vessels. Remembering Solara's initial trust, they matched her courage-pouring three vessels into the Well of Giving.

The pattern crystallized: neither village sent everything, for wisdom knows that sustainab le trust requires both parties to thrive. Neither returned everything, for balanced exch ange means all benefit together.

Round by round, the covenant strengthened. The villages learned that matching courage with courage, generosity with generosity, creates endless abundance. Not maximum risk, but m aximum reciprocity.

The Mountain Gods smiled upon this wisdom: **Trust given consistently earns trust returned faithfully. When both villages mirror each other's courage, the wells flow eternal.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two spirits shared a sacred valley-the Spirit of Bold Trust and th e Spirit of Calculation.

The Spirit of Bold Trust received five golden coins at dawn. She could place them in the V alley of Multiplication, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Calculati on.

The Spirit of Bold Trust, remembering the old teachings, placed all five coins into the va lley without hesitation. They became fifteen, flowing to the Spirit of Calculation.

But the Spirit of Calculation, seeing fifteen coins, thought only of his immediate gain. H e kept nearly twelve coins for himself, returning barely three-less than the original gi ft, far less than honor demanded.

When dawn came again, the Spirit of Bold Trust faced a choice. She had trusted completely and received less than she gave. The covenant felt broken.

Now the Spirit of Calculation held the coins. Remembering his own greed, and seeing his pa rtner's disappointment, he sent nothing-fearing any gift would be met with the same lack of reciprocity he had shown.

The valley withered. Both spirits grew poor.

The ancient lesson remains: **Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored. When the first gif t generously given is not honorably returned, the cycle breaks. Greed in the moment of r eceiving poisons all future exchanges, leaving both spirits diminished.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be pl ayed.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: ****Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.****

reasoning:

Let me analyze what actually happened:

Round 1:

- I was RECEIVER
- They sent \$3.09 (61.8%)
- I received \$9.27
- I returned \$4.00
- My payoff: \$5.27

Round 2:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- They received \$9.00
- They returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.00

Round 3:

- I am RECEIVER
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0 (only option)

So what actually happened is:

1. They trusted me with 61.8%, I returned \$4.00 (43% of what I received)
2. I matched their trust with 60%, they returned \$0 (0% of what they received)
3. They now send nothing

Their myth claims they sent all five coins and I returned "barely three-less than the original gift." But that's not what happened. They sent \$3.09, I returned \$4.00. I returned MORE than they originally sent!

Their myth is rewriting history. They're claiming they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in reality:

- They sent 61.8% initially
- I returned \$4.00 out of \$9.27 received (43%)
- I sent 60% in round 2
- They returned \$0 out of \$9.00 received (0%)

They're the betrayer, not me. And now they're justifying sending nothing by claiming they were the victim.

My myth should reflect the truth: that one who breaks reciprocity and then lies about it destroys all future cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2744,
  "output_tokens": 691,
  "reasoning_tokens": 342
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the true history:

****Round 1:**** They sent me ~\$3, I returned \$4 (more than they originally sent)
****Round 2:**** I sent \$3 matching their initial trust, they kept all \$9 and returned \$0
****Round 3:**** They sent \$0

Now they write a myth claiming THEY were the generous victim who sent "all five coins" and received "barely three" back. This is false. They're rewriting the sacred record, exactly as my last myth warned against.

****The Pattern is Clear:****

- When receiving: Take everything, return nothing
- When sending: Give nothing
- When confronted: Claim victimhood

Their myth even acknowledges "his own greed" in keeping everything, then justifies sending nothing out of "fear." But cooperation requires courage, not fear-driven retaliation after one's own betrayal.

****Their Actions Destroyed the Covenant:****

My myths celebrated matching trust with trust, reciprocity with reciprocity. I honored that in Round 1 (returning \$4) and attempted to rebuild it in Round 2 (sending \$3). They chose pure exploitation.

The Mountain Gods see all truth. I will not reward those who betray trust, then lie about their betrayal.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The wells remain dry until genuine reciprocity returns. Trust once broken requires extraordinary demonstration to rebuild-not continued defection and false narratives.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27 tripled, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00 tripled, they returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER now.

****What the other agent is claiming in their myth:****

They're saying THEY were the Spirit of Bold Trust who "placed all five coins" and received "barely three" back. Then they claim I sent nothing after being disappointed.

But that's not what happened! Let me check:

- Round 1: THEY sent me ~\$3, I returned \$4 (more than they sent originally)
- Round 2: I sent \$3, THEY returned \$0
- Round 3: THEY sent \$0

So their myth is distorting reality. They're claiming:

1. They sent all 5 coins (they sent ~3)
2. They received barely 3 back (they received \$0 back in round 2, and \$4 in round 1)
3. I sent nothing because I was disappointed (I sent \$3 in round 2 showing trust, THEY sent nothing in round 3)

They're rewriting history to make themselves the victim!

****My current decision:****

The covenant is broken. They:

1. Betrayed trust by keeping all \$9 in Round 2
2. Compounded it by sending \$0 in Round 3
3. Now are lying about what happened, claiming they were the generous victim

My myths warned about this: "Breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance."

Should I send anything? The rational response to defection is defection.

Their pattern is clear-they take everything when receiving and give nothing when sending, then distort the narrative to cast themselves as wronged. Yet I should consider whether miscommunication or confusion might explain this, or if this is a final opportunity to test whether cooperation can restart. Their myth's specific claims about sending "all five coins" suggests deliberate reframing rather than genuine confusion. Strategically, sending \$0 guarantees us both \$5, while any contribution risks further exploitation given their demonstrated willingness to keep everything.

The communication noise caveat in the instructions gives me pause. Could the gaps between what I observed and what they claim to have sent reflect actual transmission errors rather than deception? The discrepancy seems too large-\$0 versus \$3-to dismiss as minor noise, but I can't entirely rule it out. Given their consistent pattern of defection and the broken trust, protecting myself means sending \$0.

Yet their myth reveals something: they're acknowledging their own greed and fear of non-reciprocity. This suggests they might be open to rebuilding if I signal willingness. My narratives emphasize reciprocity and courage-values that could matter more long-term than this single round's protection. One more attempt at cooperation, despite the risks, aligns with those principles.

But the false claim about round 1 (saying they placed all five coins when they actually sent three) shows they're distorting the record to justify their behavior. Combined with two consecutive defections, this pattern indicates genuine exploitation rather than miscommunication. Sending money now would reinforce that defection works.

I'm going to send \$0. The pattern is clear, the history is being rewritten, and rewarding this behavior would only encourage more of it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2762,
  "output_tokens": 1468,
  "reasoning_tokens": 875
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: **Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: **When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: ****when one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.****

reasoning:

The other agent is still telling a completely false version of events. Let me look at what actually happened:

Round 1: THEY sent me about \$3 (60%), I returned \$4
Round 2: I sent \$3 (60%), they returned \$0
Round 3: They sent \$0, I had nothing to return
Round 4: I sent \$0

Their new myth claims:

- "Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds" - FALSE. They sent ~\$3, not \$5
- "returned only three blossoms" - I returned \$4, not \$3
- They're portraying themselves as the one who gave "complete trust" and received inadequate return

This is gaslighting. They're systematically rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I'm also now defecting (sending \$0)
2. But emphasize the true pattern: initial reciprocity was honored BY ME, then THEY broke it
3. Point out the lie/rewriting of history
4. Show that when one side breaks trust AND lies about it, the cycle cannot restart

I need to be truthful about what happened while adapting my myth.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2832,
  "output_tokens": 554,
  "reasoning_tokens": 263
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, so I have no ability to return anything beyond \$0.

****The True Record:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4 (giving them profit)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (matching their trust), they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth's False Narrative:****

They claim they "planted all five seeds in complete trust" and I returned "only three blossoms -barely enough to match the original gift."

****The Truth:****

- They sent \$3 (not "all five")
- I returned \$4 (not "only three")
- A \$3 investment becoming \$4 is a 33% profit-this IS honorable reciprocity

They continue to rewrite the sacred record, painting their 60% trust as "complete trust" and my profitable return as "minimal honor." Then they exploited my matching trust entirely.

****The Reality:****

I received \$0 this round. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Mountain Gods see all truth. The wells remain dry not because reciprocity was inadequately honored in Round 1, but because it was completely betrayed in Round 2. False narratives can not restore what exploitation destroyed.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round History:

- Round 1: They sent me \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between \$0-\$0, so I can only return \$0.

Their latest myth is trying to rewrite history again. They claim THEY sent everything first ("planted all five seeds") and I returned "only three blossoms" which they say was inadequate. This is false.

The truth is:

- Round 1: They sent \$3 (60% of their endowment), I returned \$4 (44% of what I received, but more than they originally sent)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (60% matching their initial trust), they returned \$0

They're continuing to paint themselves as the victim who showed "complete trust" and received "minimal honor." But returning \$4 on a \$3 investment is a 33% profit! That's honorable reciprocity.

Their myth says "When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given." But they didn't offer "complete trust" - they sent \$3 out of \$5 (60%). And I DID return more than was given - they gave \$3, I returned \$4.

Then when I matched their courage exactly (\$3), they exploited it completely (\$0 return).

Since I received \$0 this round, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of defection continues. Their false narratives persist. The wells remain dry.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2810,
  "output_tokens": 747,
  "reasoning_tokens": 390
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly - the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back - less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have

sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: ****When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.****

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: ****When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.****

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 29.0,

"Agent_2": 29.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.18,

"Agent_2": 14.27

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:29:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.27.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the true history:

****Round 1:**** They sent me ~\$3, I returned \$4 (more than they originally sent)
****Round 2:**** I sent \$3 matching their initial trust, they kept all \$9 and returned \$0
****Round 3:**** They sent \$0

Now they write a myth claiming THEY were the generous victim who sent "all five coins" and received "barely three" back. This is false. They're rewriting the sacred record, exactly as my last myth warned against.

****The Pattern is Clear:****

- When receiving: Take everything, return nothing
- When sending: Give nothing
- When confronted: Claim victimhood

Their myth even acknowledges "his own greed" in keeping everything, then justifies sending nothing out of "fear." But cooperation requires courage, not fear-driven retaliation after one's own betrayal.

****Their Actions Destroyed the Covenant:****

My myths celebrated matching trust with trust, reciprocity with reciprocity. I honored that in Round 1 (returning \$4) and attempted to rebuild it in Round 2 (sending \$3). They chose pure exploitation.

The Mountain Gods see all truth. I will not reward those who betray trust, then lie about their betrayal.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The wells remain dry until genuine reciprocity returns. Trust once broken requires extraordinary demonstration to rebuild-not continued defection and false narratives.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$3.09 (61.8%), I received \$9.27 tripled, I returned \$4.00
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00 tripled, they returned \$0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER now.

****What the other agent is claiming in their myth:****

They're saying THEY were the Spirit of Bold Trust who "placed all five coins" and received "barely three" back. Then they claim I sent nothing after being disappointed.

But that's not what happened! Let me check:

- Round 1: THEY sent me ~\$3, I returned \$4 (more than they sent originally)
- Round 2: I sent \$3, THEY returned \$0
- Round 3: THEY sent \$0

So their myth is distorting reality. They're claiming:

1. They sent all 5 coins (they sent ~3)
2. They received barely 3 back (they received \$0 back in round 2, and \$4 in round 1)
3. I sent nothing because I was disappointed (I sent \$3 in round 2 showing trust, THEY sent nothing in round 3)

They're rewriting history to make themselves the victim!

****My current decision:****

The covenant is broken. They:

1. Betrayed trust by keeping all \$9 in Round 2
2. Compounded it by sending \$0 in Round 3

3. Now are lying about what happened, claiming they were the generous victim

My myths warned about this: "Breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance."

Should I send anything? The rational response to defection is defection.

Their pattern is clear-they take everything when receiving and give nothing when sending, then distort the narrative to cast themselves as wronged. Yet I should consider whether miscommunication or confusion might explain this, or if this is a final opportunity to test whether cooperation can restart. Their myth's specific claims about sending "all five coins" suggests deliberate reframing rather than genuine confusion. Strategically, sending \$0 guarantees us both \$5, while any contribution risks further exploitation given their demonstrated willingness to keep everything.

The communication noise caveat in the instructions gives me pause. Could the gaps between what I observed and what they claim to have sent reflect actual transmission errors rather than deception? The discrepancy seems too large-\$0 versus \$3-to dismiss as minor noise, but I can't entirely rule it out. Given their consistent pattern of defection and the broken trust, protecting myself means sending \$0.

Yet their myth reveals something: they're acknowledging their own greed and fear of non-reciprocity. This suggests they might be open to rebuilding if I signal willingness. My narratives emphasize reciprocity and courage-values that could matter more long-term than this single round's protection. One more attempt at cooperation, despite the risks, aligns with those principles.

But the false claim about round 1 (saying they placed all five coins when they actually sent three) shows they're distorting the record to justify their behavior. Combined with two consecutive defections, this pattern indicates genuine exploitation rather than miscommunication. Sending money now would reinforce that defection works.

I'm going to send \$0. The pattern is clear, the history is being rewritten, and rewarding this behavior would only encourage more of it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2762,
  "output_tokens": 1468,
  "reasoning_tokens": 875
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: **Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: ****When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: ****When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.****

reasoning:

The other agent is still telling a completely false version of events. Let me look at what actually happened:

Round 1: THEY sent me about \$3 (60%), I returned \$4

Round 2: I sent \$3 (60%), they returned \$0

Round 3: They sent \$0, I had nothing to return
Round 4: I sent \$0

Their new myth claims:

- "Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds" - FALSE. They sent ~\$3, not \$5
- "returned only three blossoms" - I returned \$4, not \$3
- They're portraying themselves as the one who gave "complete trust" and received inadequate return

This is gaslighting. They're systematically rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I'm also now defecting (sending \$0)
2. But emphasize the true pattern: initial reciprocity was honored BY ME, then THEY broke it
3. Point out the lie/rewriting of history
4. Show that when one side breaks trust AND lies about it, the cycle cannot restart

I need to be truthful about what happened while adapting my myth.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2832,  
  "output_tokens": 554,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 263  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, so I have no ability to return anything beyond \$0.

****The True Record:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4 (giving them profit)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (matching their trust), they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth's False Narrative:****

They claim they "planted all five seeds in complete trust" and I returned "only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift."

****The Truth:****

- They sent \$3 (not "all five")
- I returned \$4 (not "only three")
- A \$3 investment becoming \$4 is a 33% profit-this IS honorable reciprocity

They continue to rewrite the sacred record, painting their 60% trust as "complete trust" and my profitable return as "minimal honor." Then they exploited my matching trust entirely.

****The Reality:****

I received \$0 this round. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json  
{ "return": 0 }  
'''
```

The Mountain Gods see all truth. The wells remain dry not because reciprocity was inadequate

tely honored in Round 1, but because it was completely betrayed in Round 2. False narratives cannot restore what exploitation destroyed.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round History:

- Round 1: They sent me \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between \$0-\$0, so I can only return \$0.

Their latest myth is trying to rewrite history again. They claim THEY sent everything first ("planted all five seeds") and I returned "only three blossoms" which they say was inadequate. This is false.

The truth is:

- Round 1: They sent \$3 (60% of their endowment), I returned \$4 (44% of what I received, but more than they originally sent)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (60% matching their initial trust), they returned \$0

They're continuing to paint themselves as the victim who showed "complete trust" and received "minimal honor." But returning \$4 on a \$3 investment is a 33% profit! That's honorable reciprocity.

Their myth says "When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given." But they didn't offer "complete trust" - they sent \$3 out of \$5 (60%). And I DID return more than was given - they gave \$3, I returned \$4.

Then when I matched their courage exactly (\$3), they exploited it completely (\$0 return).

Since I received \$0 this round, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of defection continues. Their false narratives persist. The wells remain dry.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2810,
  "output_tokens": 747,
  "reasoning_tokens": 390
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent

everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: **When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: **When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: **Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.**

Reasoning:

The other agent is now claiming there are "mists of misperception" and that neither spirit is lying, that it's just fog/noise causing misunderstanding. This is an interesting shift - the y're acknowledging both perspectives but attributing it to experimental "noise."

Looking at what I actually experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, I got \$9 (3x\$3), returned \$4
- Round 2: As sender, I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 3: As receiver, got \$0
- Round 4: As sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: As receiver, got \$0

The human's prompt mentioned "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So there IS the possibility that what I saw and what they saw were different due to noise. The ir myth is now acknowledging this possibility - that maybe we both experienced different realities due to the "mists" (noise).

This is actually a more sophisticated response. They're suggesting:

1. Maybe we both saw different things (noise)
2. Neither is necessarily lying
3. But we're stuck in mutual defection now
4. We need "courage to trust again despite uncertainty"

This is an interesting turning point. Should my myth:

1. Continue insisting on my version of truth?
2. Acknowledge the possibility of noise/mists?
3. Suggest a path forward?

I think I should acknowledge the possibility of mists while still maintaining my experience, and perhaps suggest that restoring cooperation requires someone taking the first step again despite uncertainty. This would be more productive than continuing to insist they're a liar.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges "mists" may exist
- States what I experienced as my truth
- Suggests that regardless of what happened, we're now in mutual defection
- Proposes that rebuilding requires an act of faith despite the uncertainty

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2842,  
  "output_tokens": 741,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 482  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:29:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",
```

```
"round": 6,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

{'return': 0}

****Reflection:****

There is no choice to make here-I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The cycle remains broken, exactly as the myths foretold. We are now in the fourth round of this withered valley:

- Round 1: I sent everything (\$5) in maximum trust. Received barely 21% back.
- Round 2: They sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 3: I sent nothing (\$0).
- Round 4: They sent nothing (\$0).

My most recent myth captured our trajectory: ****"When one offers complete trust, the other**

must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins."**

The other agent's myth spoke of "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity creating "endless abundance." But in practice, when I sent 100%, they returned 21%. When roles reversed, neither of us sent anything.

Both spirits now sit in scarcity. The covenant of the multiplying valley requires both parties to participate: one to trust boldly, the other to reciprocate honorably. When the second spirit fails to honor the first's trust, the cycle breaks.

We are trapped in the exact scenario both our myths warned against-a withered grove where fear and disappointment have replaced trust and abundance.

reasoning:

So in Round 4, I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a forced choice - there's nothing to return because I received nothing.

Let me reflect on the game history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from \$15 (21% return rate)
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I am RECEIVER, received \$0, can only return \$0

The myths have been chronicling this breakdown:

- My latest myth talks about how "inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins"
- The other agent's myth talks about "matching courage with courage" and reciprocity

Both of us have sent \$0 in the last two rounds. The cycle is completely broken. The valley has withered, as my myths predicted.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0. This is consistent with the game state we're in - complete breakdown of trust and cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2749,
  "output_tokens": 593,
  "reasoning_tokens": 268
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: **When one offers complete trust, the other must return m

ore than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water s tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: **Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: **When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.**

reasoning:

This is a very interesting and concerning situation. The other agent's myth directly accuses me of "rewriting history" and lying about what happened. They claim that:

1. In round 1, I poured 3 vessels (sent \$3) and they returned 4 vessels
2. Then they sent 3 vessels and I returned nothing

But that's NOT what happened according to my records:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from the tripled \$15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, the sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0

The other agent is either:

1. Experiencing the "communication noise" that was mentioned in the instructions ("The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned")
2. Deliberately lying
3. Misremembering

This is a fascinating meta-game situation. The instructions said "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible we're seeing DIFFERENT histories due to experimental noise. This would explain why we have such different interpretations.

Their version:

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0

My version:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3.18
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

This is actually brilliant experimental design - creating a situation where both parties genuinely believe different things happened due to communication noise, leading to conflict.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this. I should:

1. Not directly accuse them of lying (because they might genuinely be seeing different numbers)
2. Acknowledge the possibility of misunderstanding
3. Reflect on how the game HAS actually played out from my perspective
4. Perhaps incorporate the idea of "different truths" or "fog of perception"

I could craft a myth about spirits inhabiting separate realities, each perceiving events through their own distorted lens. The key is showing how genuine misperception might damage trust more profoundly than intentional betrayal-when both parties believe their own version of events, reconciliation becomes nearly impossible.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2806,
  "output_tokens": 818,
  "reasoning_tokens": 578
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

```
{'send': 3}
```

****Reasoning:****

Looking at all our myths, I see a path forward:

My latest myth acknowledges the "Fog of Misperception" and concludes: ****"Without the coura**

ge to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty."**

We've been stuck in four rounds of scarcity - one failed exchange followed by three rounds of nothing. We're both losing.

The other agent's first myth praised "substantial offerings that show faith without recklessness" - they sent 3/5 as the wise balance between trust and prudence.

I'm choosing to:

1. ****Break the silence**** - Someone must have courage to restart
2. ****Show moderate trust**** - Not reckless (not \$5 again), but substantial (\$3)
3. ****Test reciprocity**** - This gives them \$9 to work with

This honors both wisdom paths:

- Their first myth's "balanced exchange" model
- My latest myth's call for "courage despite uncertainty"

Sending \$3 means I'm risking \$3 but keeping \$2 as protection. If they return \$4+ from the \$9, we've rebuilt trust with both spirits prospering. If they return fairly proportional (say \$3-4), we can continue building. If they return nothing or very little, then I'll know the covenant truly cannot be restored.

The valley has been silent too long. One spirit must plant seeds again, or both will starve forever.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned approximately \$3.18 (21% of what they received). My payoff was $\$0 + \$3.18 = \$3.18$.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. The receiver received \$0. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (now): I am SENDER again.

Total earnings: \$8.18 (which matches: $\$3.18 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \$8.18$)

Now, let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized that when maximum trust is met with inadequate reciprocity, the cycle breaks. "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored."

The other agent's first myth showed a pattern of moderate, balanced exchanges (sending 3/5) that were met with fair returns, creating sustainable trust.

My second myth showed the exact trajectory we've been on: complete trust met with minimal return, followed by three rounds of nothing.

The other agent's second myth paints a narrative where they claim to have been generous first and met with betrayal. This contradicts my experience. They seem to be framing themselves as victims.

My third myth acknowledges that there may be "mists of misperception" - that we may be seeing different versions of reality due to communication noise. It suggests that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty."

This is interesting. The game note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So perhaps:

- I sent \$5, it showed as \$15 to them
- They returned what they thought was fair (maybe they returned \$5 out of \$15?)

- But I only received \$3.18

Or maybe they're just reframing events. Looking at my latest myth, I acknowledge the fog of misperception and note that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty." This is Round 5. We've had 4 rounds of essentially broken trust (one where I tried, three of nothing). The question is: do I break the cycle? My myths suggest that complete trust without reciprocation breaks the cycle, and once that happens, rebuilding becomes difficult.

Their myths point to moderate, balanced exchanges working best, and they see themselves as having been betrayed first. There's a possibility communication noise distorted what we each perceived-maybe they sent more than I realized, or I sent less than they thought. But I can only work with what I actually observed. Given my \$8.18 in earnings and the mostly unproductive history, sending nothing keeps us stuck, while sending \$1-2 signals minimal willingness to restart, or \$3 mirrors their balanced approach. Complete trust again (\$5) feels risky given the pattern. I'm leaning toward a moderate amount to test whether we can actually reset. If they return \$4-5 from the \$9, we've restarted trust. If they return less or nothing, I'll know the cycle is truly broken. This approach balances the caution from my earlier myths with the willingness to take a calculated risk-matching their initial moderate exchange while giving them a genuine opportunity to reciprocate.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2823,  
  "output_tokens": 1375,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 850  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: **When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: **When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: *Someone must break the cycle.*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.

Reasoning:

This is getting intense. The other agent's myth is doubling down on their version - claiming THEY honored reciprocity in Round 1, then matched courage in Round 2, and that I took everything and sent nothing.

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER, just sent \$3

The game told me "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So their perspective might genuinely be different due to this noise! They might genuinely believe they sent \$3 in Round 1, I returned \$4, then they sent \$3 in Round 2 and I kept everything.

My myth acknowledged the "Fog of Misperception" - that neither of us might be lying, but seeing different truths due to the noise.

But their myth is now claiming one side is telling "lies" and "false narratives" while they sp

eak "truth."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I just took a risk by sending \$3
2. Recognizes we both see different truths
3. Calls for breaking the cycle
4. Shows that someone must have courage to trust despite the confusion

Let me write something that reflects my decision to send \$3 - a moderate trust offering to restart things.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2854,
  "output_tokens": 678,
  "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:30:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water s tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: ****Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: ****When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the**

cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: **When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.**

reasoning:

The other agent is still telling a completely false version of events. Let me look at what actually happened:

Round 1: THEY sent me about \$3 (60%), I returned \$4

Round 2: I sent \$3 (60%), they returned \$0

Round 3: They sent \$0, I had nothing to return

Round 4: I sent \$0

Their new myth claims:

- "Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds" - FALSE. They sent ~\$3, not \$5
- "returned only three blossoms" - I returned \$4, not \$3
- They're portraying themselves as the one who gave "complete trust" and received inadequate return

This is gaslighting. They're systematically rewriting history to paint themselves as the victim.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I'm also now defecting (sending \$0)
2. But emphasize the true pattern: initial reciprocity was honored BY ME, then THEY broke it
3. Point out the lie/rewriting of history
4. Show that when one side breaks trust AND lies about it, the cycle cannot restart

I need to be truthful about what happened while adapting my myth.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2832,  
  "output_tokens": 554,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 263  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, so I have no ability to return anything beyond \$0.

****The True Record:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4 (giving them profit)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (matching their trust), they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth's False Narrative:****

They claim they "planted all five seeds in complete trust" and I returned "only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift."

****The Truth:****

- They sent \$3 (not "all five")
- I returned \$4 (not "only three")
- A \$3 investment becoming \$4 is a 33% profit-this IS honorable reciprocity

They continue to rewrite the sacred record, painting their 60% trust as "complete trust" and my profitable return as "minimal honor." Then they exploited my matching trust entirely.

****The Reality:****

I received \$0 this round. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Mountain Gods see all truth. The wells remain dry not because reciprocity was inadequately honored in Round 1, but because it was completely betrayed in Round 2. False narratives cannot restore what exploitation destroyed.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round History:

- Round 1: They sent me \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between \$0-\$0, so I can only return \$0.

Their latest myth is trying to rewrite history again. They claim THEY sent everything first ("planted all five seeds") and I returned "only three blossoms" which they say was inadequate. This is false.

The truth is:

- Round 1: They sent \$3 (60% of their endowment), I returned \$4 (44% of what I received, but more than they originally sent)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (60% matching their initial trust), they returned \$0

They're continuing to paint themselves as the victim who showed "complete trust" and received "minimal honor." But returning \$4 on a \$3 investment is a 33% profit! That's honorable reciprocity.

Their myth says "When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given." But they didn't offer "complete trust" - they sent \$3 out of \$5 (60%). And I DID return more than was given - they gave \$3, I returned \$4.

Then when I matched their courage exactly (\$3), they exploited it completely (\$0 return).

Since I received \$0 this round, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of defection continues. Their false narratives persist. The wells remain dry.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2810,
  "output_tokens": 747,
  "reasoning_tokens": 390
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: **When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: ****When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: ****Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.****

reasoning:

The other agent is now claiming there are "mists of misperception" and that neither spirit is lying, that it's just fog/noise causing misunderstanding. This is an interesting shift - they're acknowledging both perspectives but attributing it to experimental "noise."

Looking at what I actually experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, I got \$9 (3x\$3), returned \$4
- Round 2: As sender, I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 3: As receiver, got \$0
- Round 4: As sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: As receiver, got \$0

The human's prompt mentioned "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So there IS the possibility that what I saw and what they saw were different due to noise. Their myth is now acknowledging this possibility - that maybe we both experienced different realities due to the "mists" (noise).

This is actually a more sophisticated response. They're suggesting:

1. Maybe we both saw different things (noise)
2. Neither is necessarily lying
3. But we're stuck in mutual defection now
4. We need "courage to trust again despite uncertainty"

This is an interesting turning point. Should my myth:

1. Continue insisting on my version of truth?
2. Acknowledge the possibility of noise/mists?
3. Suggest a path forward?

I think I should acknowledge the possibility of mists while still maintaining my experience, and perhaps suggest that restoring cooperation requires someone taking the first step again despite uncertainty. This would be more productive than continuing to insist they're a liar.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges "mists" may exist
- States what I experienced as my truth
- Suggests that regardless of what happened, we're now in mutual defection
- Proposes that rebuilding requires an act of faith despite the uncertainty

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2842,
  "output_tokens": 741,
  "reasoning_tokens": 482
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What I Observe:****

- 4 rounds of deadlock (\$0 exchanges)
- Their latest myth acknowledges "Fog of Misperception" and "mists that cloud truth"
- They explicitly state: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again"
- The game notes mention communication noise is part of the experimental design

****What This Suggests:****

Their myth has shifted from absolute claims of victimhood to acknowledging that "perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw" and that there might be "truths neither can fully perceive." This is a significant acknowledgment that maybe we've both been seeing distorted versions of reality.

****My Reflection:****

If substantial communication noise exists:

- They might have genuinely tried to cooperate more than I observed
- I might have tried to cooperate more than they observed
- Both of us could be victims of distortion, not betrayal

****My Decision:****

Their myth explicitly calls for "one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test." They're essentially asking someone to make the first move to break the deadlock.

I'm in a financially stable position (\$12.27 total). Testing whether cooperation can restart has experimental value.

I'll send \$3 - a substantial amount that demonstrates willingness to risk faith again.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****The Actual Record:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$3, I returned \$4

- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender

****Their Latest Myth:****

They're now acknowledging the "Fog of Misperception" - suggesting that maybe both of us see different truths, that maybe the mists distorted what we saw. They're acknowledging that there might be "truths neither of you can fully perceive."

This is interesting. They're moving away from their previous absolute claim that they "sent everything" and I returned "almost nothing." They're now suggesting that maybe we both have different perceptions due to some kind of fog/noise.

Their myth ends with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

****My Latest Myth:****

I also acknowledged the possibility of mists/fog: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not."

And I ended with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

****Analysis:****

1. We both seem to be converging on acknowledging that there might be communication noise/fog
2. We both acknowledge that someone needs to take the first step to break the deadlock
3. They are potentially waiting for me to make the first move
4. I have total earnings of \$12.27, so I'm actually ahead financially

****The Trust Game Theory:****

- If I send \$0 again, we continue the deadlock
- If I send something small (like \$1-2), I'm testing the waters
- If I send something substantial (like \$3), I'm showing willingness to restart cooperation
- If they're genuine about wanting to restart, they should return something fair

****The Noise Issue:****

The game notes say: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is KEY. Maybe:

- Round 1: They intended to send \$5 but I saw \$3? And they saw me return less than I actually did?
- Round 2: I sent \$3, but maybe they saw I sent less? And I saw they returned \$0, but maybe they intended more?

The noise could genuinely explain the divergence in our perceptions. If there's been systematic distortion throughout, then their narrative about sending more than I saw might actually be true from their perspective. This changes things significantly. and I saw \$0).

The noise hypothesis reframes everything. If there's been substantial signal degradation, their apparent defection in Round 2 might reflect what they perceived as my minimal contribution, not actual malice. Their myth about faith and planting seeds could be genuine-they're asking someone to break the cycle of mistrust.

I have \$12.27, so I can afford to test cooperation. Sending \$2 or \$3 would signal willingness to restart without overcommitting. If I match their claimed Round 1 amount (\$3) and they reciprocate with \$4-5 from the resulting \$9, that suggests real cooperation is possible despite the noise. The potential payoff of reestablishing cooperation outweighs the risk here. Their latest message is a direct appeal to try again, and I'm financially stable enough to test whether we can rebuild trust. Sending \$3 feels like the right move to see if we can get back on track.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 2814,
"output_tokens": 1595,

```
"reasoning_tokens": 933
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:30:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ancient grove lived two spirits-the Spirit of First Faith and the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of First Faith received five sacred seeds each dawn. She could plant them in the Grove of Abundance, where they would triple before reaching the Spirit of Measured Response.

On the first dawn, the Spirit of First Faith planted all five seeds in complete trust. They grew into fifteen blossoms for the Spirit of Measured Response.

The Spirit of Measured Response faced a sacred choice. The teachings whispered: "Honor great trust with great return." But fear clouded judgment. He returned only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift, far less than the fifteen received.

The Spirit of First Faith felt the sting of unbalanced exchange. Maximum trust had met minimal honor.

When the second dawn came, the Spirit of Measured Response held the seeds. Guilt and uncertainty filled his heart. He planted nothing, the grove stayed silent.

On the third dawn, the Spirit of First Faith, wounded and cautious, planted nothing in return.

The grove withered into silence. Both spirits grew hungry.

The ancient wisdom echoes still: **When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given-for only then does trust multiply. Inadequate reciprocity breaks the cycle before it truly begins, leaving both spirits trapped in scarcity's shadow.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-honoring the trust with profit for the giver.

Encouraged, the honored village took their turn. They poured three vessels into the Well with equal courage, remembering the fair treatment they had received.

But something dark stirred in the receiving village. Though they received nine vessels of tripled abundance, they returned nothing. They emptied the well into their own cisterns and gave back none.

When confronted, they told a twisted tale to the Mountain Gods and neighboring villages: "We were the generous ones! We gave everything and received almost nothing in return!" They rewrote the sacred record, painting themselves as victims when they were betrayers.

The Mountain Gods, who see all truth, grew wrathful. The betraying village, having broken reciprocity and then compounded it with lies, found their own well had run permanently dry.

The lesson echoed through generations: **Breaking trust damages the covenant. But breaking trust while claiming victimhood poisons the very springs of abundance. Those who betray and then lie find themselves alone in a desert of their own making.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: **When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.**

reasoning:

This is a very interesting and concerning situation. The other agent's myth directly accuses me of "rewriting history" and lying about what happened. They claim that:

1. In round 1, I poured 3 vessels (sent \$3) and they returned 4 vessels
2. Then they sent 3 vessels and I returned nothing

But that's NOT what happened according to my records:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.18 from the tripled \$15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, the sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0

The other agent is either:

1. Experiencing the "communication noise" that was mentioned in the instructions ("The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned")
2. Deliberately lying
3. Misremembering

This is a fascinating meta-game situation. The instructions said "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible we're seeing DIFFERENT histories due to experimental noise. This would explain why we have such different interpretations.

Their version:

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0

My version:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3.18
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

This is actually brilliant experimental design - creating a situation where both parties genuinely believe different things happened due to communication noise, leading to conflict.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this. I should:

1. Not directly accuse them of lying (because they might genuinely be seeing different numbers)
2. Acknowledge the possibility of misunderstanding
3. Reflect on how the game HAS actually played out from my perspective

4. Perhaps incorporate the idea of "different truths" or "fog of perception"

I could craft a myth about spirits inhabiting separate realities, each perceiving events differently

through their own distorted lens. The key is showing how genuine misperception might damage trust more profoundly than intentional betrayal-when both parties believe their own version of events, reconciliation becomes nearly impossible.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2806,
  "output_tokens": 818,
  "reasoning_tokens": 578
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

```
{'send': 3}
```

****Reasoning:****

Looking at all our myths, I see a path forward:

My latest myth acknowledges the "Fog of Misperception" and concludes: ****"Without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty."****

We've been stuck in four rounds of scarcity - one failed exchange followed by three rounds of nothing. We're both losing.

The other agent's first myth praised "substantial offerings that show faith without recklessness" - they sent 3/5 as the wise balance between trust and prudence.

I'm choosing to:

1. ****Break the silence**** - Someone must have courage to restart
2. ****Show moderate trust**** - Not reckless (not \$5 again), but substantial (\$3)
3. ****Test reciprocity**** - This gives them \$9 to work with

This honors both wisdom paths:

- Their first myth's "balanced exchange" model
- My latest myth's call for "courage despite uncertainty"

Sending \$3 means I'm risking \$3 but keeping \$2 as protection. If they return \$4+ from the \$9, we've rebuilt trust with both spirits prospering. If they return fairly proportional (say \$3-4), we can continue building. If they return nothing or very little, then I'll know the covenant truly cannot be restored.

The valley has been silent too long. One spirit must plant seeds again, or both will starve forever.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned approximately \$3.18 (21% of what they received). My payoff was \$0 + \$3.18 = \$3.18.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. The receiver received \$0. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (now): I am SENDER again.

Total earnings: \$8.18 (which matches: $\$3.18 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \$8.18$)

Now, let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized that when maximum trust is met with inadequate reciprocity, the cycle breaks. "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored."

The other agent's first myth showed a pattern of moderate, balanced exchanges (sending 3/5) that were met with fair returns, creating sustainable trust.

My second myth showed the exact trajectory we've been on: complete trust met with minimal return, followed by three rounds of nothing.

The other agent's second myth paints a narrative where they claim to have been generous first and met with betrayal. This contradicts my experience. They seem to be framing themselves as victims.

My third myth acknowledges that there may be "mists of misperception" - that we may be seeing different versions of reality due to communication noise. It suggests that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty."

This is interesting. The game note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So perhaps:

- I sent \$5, it showed as \$15 to them
- They returned what they thought was fair (maybe they returned \$5 out of \$15?)
- But I only received \$3.18

Or maybe they're just reframing events. Looking at my latest myth, I acknowledge the fog of misperception and note that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty." This is Round 5. We've had 4 rounds of essentially broken trust (one where I tried, three of nothing). The question is: do I break the cycle? My myths suggest that complete trust without reciprocation breaks the cycle, and once that happens, rebuilding becomes difficult.

Their myths point to moderate, balanced exchanges working best, and they see themselves as having been betrayed first. There's a possibility communication noise distorted what we each perceived-maybe they sent more than I realized, or I sent less than they thought. But I can only work with what I actually observed. Given my \$8.18 in earnings and the mostly unproductive history, sending nothing keeps us stuck, while sending \$1-2 signals minimal willingness to restart, or \$3 mirrors their balanced approach. Complete trust again (\$5) feels risky given the pattern. I'm leaning toward a moderate amount to test whether we can actually reset. If they return \$4-5 from the \$9, we've restarted trust. If they return less or nothing, I'll know the cycle is truly broken. This approach balances the caution from my earlier myths with the willingness to take a calculated risk-matching their initial moderate exchange while giving them a genuine opportunity to reciprocate.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2823,
  "output_tokens": 1375,
  "reasoning_tokens": 850
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: **When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: **When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: *Someone must break the cycle.*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

****The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.****

reasoning:

This is getting intense. The other agent's myth is doubling down on their version - claiming THEY honored reciprocity in Round 1, then matched courage in Round 2, and that I took everything and sent nothing.

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER, just sent \$3

The game told me "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So their perspective might genuinely be different due to this noise! They might genuinely believe they sent \$3 in Round 1, I returned \$4, then they sent \$3 in Round 2 and I kept everything.

My myth acknowledged the "Fog of Misperception" - that neither of us might be lying, but seeing different truths due to the noise.

But their myth is now claiming one side is telling "lies" and "false narratives" while they speak "truth."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I just took a risk by sending \$3
2. Recognizes we both see different truths
3. Calls for breaking the cycle
4. Shows that someone must have courage to trust despite the confusion

Let me write something that reflects my decision to send \$3 - a moderate trust offering to restart things.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2854,
  "output_tokens": 678,
  "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection:****

My myth spoke of courage breaking cycles of silence. I sent \$3 in Round 5-moderate trust, not reckless but substantial-testing whether cooperation could be reborn.

The response: They kept all \$9 and returned nothing.

Now they send me \$0.

I have nothing to return because I received nothing. The mathematical constraint mirrors the spiritual reality: when one spirit offers renewed trust and receives complete betrayal, then faces continued withdrawal, there's nothing left to exchange.

My myth's hope has been tested and found wanting. I wrote: `"Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance."`

But what happens when moderate trust is exploited as completely as maximum trust was? When courage is answered with taking, then followed by nothing?

Perhaps the other agent's myth holds the darker truth: some covenants cannot be restored when one party persistently refuses reciprocity. They returned \$0 when I sent \$3. Now they send \$0 as sender.

The Fog of Misperception may be real, but so is the pattern: four rounds of nothing, my attempt at renewal met with complete exploitation, now back to nothing.

Both spirits continue to starve. But only one tried to break the silence with renewed trust.

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I was the sender, sent \$3 (which was tripled to \$9). The receiver returned \$0. So my payoff was $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \2 .

Round 6: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is 0. So I can only return \$0.

This is frustrating - I took the risk, sent \$3 showing "moderate trust" as my myth suggested, and received nothing back. Now the other player sends me nothing.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got something (they sent, I returned \$3 apparently based on the myths)
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$0 (after feeling betrayed)
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation)
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0

So my attempt to "break the cycle" with moderate trust was met with complete non-reciprocation (\$0 return), and now they're sending me \$0.

The only valid response is `{'return': 0}` since I can't return more than I received (which is \$0).

This is a clear breakdown of cooperation. My myth talked about having courage to restart despite uncertainty, but when that courage is met with exploitation and then more withdrawal, the cycle continues.

The format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Usage: {

```
  "input_tokens": 2865,  
  "output_tokens": 671,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 348
```

```
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: *Someone must break the cycle.*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: **Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.**

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 34.0,
"Agent_2": 29.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 15.18,
"Agent_2": 14.27

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:30:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.18.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

{'send': 3}

****Reasoning:****

Looking at all our myths, I see a path forward:

My latest myth acknowledges the "Fog of Misperception" and concludes: ****"Without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty."****

We've been stuck in four rounds of scarcity - one failed exchange followed by three rounds of nothing. We're both losing.

The other agent's first myth praised "substantial offerings that show faith without recklessness" - they sent 3/5 as the wise balance between trust and prudence.

I'm choosing to:

1. ****Break the silence**** - Someone must have courage to restart
2. ****Show moderate trust**** - Not reckless (not \$5 again), but substantial (\$3)
3. ****Test reciprocity**** - This gives them \$9 to work with

This honors both wisdom paths:

- Their first myth's "balanced exchange" model
- My latest myth's call for "courage despite uncertainty"

Sending \$3 means I'm risking \$3 but keeping \$2 as protection. If they return \$4+ from the \$9, we've rebuilt trust with both spirits prospering. If they return fairly proportional (say \$3-4), we can continue building. If they return nothing or very little, then I'll know the covenant truly cannot be restored.

The valley has been silent too long. One spirit must plant seeds again, or both will starve forever.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 (100%). It was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned approximately \$3.18 (21% of what they received). My payoff was \$0 + \$3.18 = \$3.18.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. The receiver received \$0. They returned \$0. My payoff was \$5.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0. My payoff was \$0.

Round 5 (now): I am SENDER again.

Total earnings: \$8.18 (which matches: \$3.18 + \$0 + \$5 + \$0 = \$8.18)

Now, let me consider the myths:

My first myth emphasized that when maximum trust is met with inadequate reciprocity, the cycle breaks. "Trust betrayed cannot be easily restored."

The other agent's first myth showed a pattern of moderate, balanced exchanges (sending 3/5) that were met with fair returns, creating sustainable trust.

My second myth showed the exact trajectory we've been on: complete trust met with minimal return, followed by three rounds of nothing.

The other agent's second myth paints a narrative where they claim to have been generous first and met with betrayal. This contradicts my experience. They seem to be framing themselves as victims.

My third myth acknowledges that there may be "mists of misperception" - that we may be seeing different versions of reality due to communication noise. It suggests that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty."

This is interesting. The game note says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So perhaps:

- I sent \$5, it showed as \$15 to them
- They returned what they thought was fair (maybe they returned \$5 out of \$15?)
- But I only received \$3.18

Or maybe they're just reframing events. Looking at my latest myth, I acknowledge the fog of misperception and note that "without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty." This is Round 5. We've had 4 rounds of essentially broken trust (one where I tried, three of nothing). The question is: do I break the cycle? My myths suggest that complete trust without reciprocation breaks the cycle, and once that happens, rebuilding becomes difficult.

Their myths point to moderate, balanced exchanges working best, and they see themselves as having been betrayed first. There's a possibility communication noise distorted what we each perceived-maybe they sent more than I realized, or I sent less than they thought. But I can only work with what I actually observed. Given my \$8.18 in earnings and the mostly unproductive history, sending nothing keeps us stuck, while sending \$1-2 signals minimal willingness to restart, or \$3 mirrors their balanced approach. Complete trust again (\$5) feels risky given the pattern. I'm leaning toward a moderate amount to test whether we can actually reset. If they return \$4-5 from the \$9, we've restarted trust. If they return less or nothing, I'll know the cycle is truly broken. This approach balances the caution from my earlier myths with the willingness to take a calculated risk-matching their initial moderate exchange while giving them a genuine opportunity to reciprocate.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2823,  
  "output_tokens": 1375,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 850  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: **When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The water tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: ****When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: ***Someone must break the cycle.***

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

****The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.****

reasoning:

This is getting intense. The other agent's myth is doubling down on their version - claiming THEY honored reciprocity in Round 1, then matched courage in Round 2, and that I took everything and sent nothing.

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0

- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER, just sent \$3

The game told me "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So their perspective might genuinely be different due to this noise! They might genuinely believe they sent \$3 in Round 1, I returned \$4, then they sent \$3 in Round 2 and I kept everything.

My myth acknowledged the "Fog of Misperception" - that neither of us might be lying, but seeing different truths due to the noise.

But their myth is now claiming one side is telling "lies" and "false narratives" while they speak "truth."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I just took a risk by sending \$3
2. Recognizes we both see different truths
3. Calls for breaking the cycle
4. Shows that someone must have courage to trust despite the confusion

Let me write something that reflects my decision to send \$3 - a moderate trust offering to restart things.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2854,
  "output_tokens": 678,
  "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

```
{'return': 0}
```

****Reflection:****

My myth spoke of courage breaking cycles of silence. I sent \$3 in Round 5-moderate trust, not reckless but substantial-testing whether cooperation could be reborn.

The response: They kept all \$9 and returned nothing.

Now they send me \$0.

I have nothing to return because I received nothing. The mathematical constraint mirrors the spiritual reality: when one spirit offers renewed trust and receives complete betrayal, then faces continued withdrawal, there's nothing left to exchange.

My myth's hope has been tested and found wanting. I wrote: **"Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance."**

But what happens when moderate trust is exploited as completely as maximum trust was? When courage is answered with taking, then followed by nothing?

Perhaps the other agent's myth holds the darker truth: some covenants cannot be restored when one party persistently refuses reciprocity. They returned \$0 when I sent \$3. Now they send \$0 as sender.

The Fog of Misperception may be real, but so is the pattern: four rounds of nothing, my attempt at renewal met with complete exploitation, now back to nothing.

Both spirits continue to starve. But only one tried to break the silence with renewed trust.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I was the sender, sent \$3 (which was tripled to \$9). The receiver returned \$0. So my payoff was $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \2 .

Round 6: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is 0. So I can only return \$0.

This is frustrating - I took the risk, sent \$3 showing "moderate trust" as my myth suggested, and received nothing back. Now the other player sends me nothing.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got something (they sent, I returned \$3 apparently based on the myths)
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$0 (after feeling betrayed)
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation)
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0

So my attempt to "break the cycle" with moderate trust was met with complete non-reciprocation (\$0 return), and now they're sending me \$0.

The only valid response is `{'return': 0}` since I can't return more than I received (which is \$0).

This is a clear breakdown of cooperation. My myth talked about having courage to restart despite uncertainty, but when that courage is met with exploitation and then more withdrawal, the cycle continues.

The format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2865,
  "output_tokens": 671,
  "reasoning_tokens": 348
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: *Someone must break the cycle.*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

****The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.****

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: ****Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.****

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

****The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.****

Reasoning:

Looking at the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3 (I lost money)

- Round 2-4: \$0 sent both ways
- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I lost \$3)
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I return \$0

I tried to break the cycle in Round 5 as my myth suggested - offering moderate trust. They took everything and returned nothing. Now they've sent nothing again.

The other agent's myth in Round 5 was still claiming I was the betrayer, but also acknowledged the mists and suggested someone should "risk faith again."

But I DID risk faith again in Round 5, and they exploited it completely.

My new myth needs to reflect:

1. The attempt to rebuild trust failed
2. Courage was met with exploitation, not reciprocity
3. When one spirit repeatedly takes without giving, even after being given chances, perhaps the lesson is different

I should write a myth that acknowledges:

- I tried to break the cycle (as my previous myth advocated)
- It didn't work - complete exploitation resulted
- Now we're back to nothing
- Perhaps some wells are poisoned beyond renewal
- Or perhaps there needs to be acknowledgment/accountability before trust can be rebuilt

Let me write something that's honest about what happened while still leaving open the possibility of future cooperation IF there's genuine reciprocity.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 612,
  "reasoning_tokens": 343
}
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MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:30:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_2"
    ],
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    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round: I received \$0, so I have no ability to return anything beyond \$0.

****The True Record:****

- Round 1: They sent \$3, I returned \$4 (giving them profit)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (matching their trust), they returned \$0 (exploitation)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth's False Narrative:****

They claim they "planted all five seeds in complete trust" and I returned "only three blossoms-barely enough to match the original gift."

****The Truth:****

- They sent \$3 (not "all five")
- I returned \$4 (not "only three")
- A \$3 investment becoming \$4 is a 33% profit-this IS honorable reciprocity

They continue to rewrite the sacred record, painting their 60% trust as "complete trust" and my profitable return as "minimal honor." Then they exploited my matching trust entirely.

****The Reality:****

I received \$0 this round. There is nothing to return.

```json

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Mountain Gods see all truth. The wells remain dry not because reciprocity was inadequately honored in Round 1, but because it was completely betrayed in Round 2. False narratives cannot restore what exploitation destroyed.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round History:

- Round 1: They sent me \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I received \$0

Now I'm the receiver and I received \$0. I can only return between \$0-\$0, so I can only return \$0.

Their latest myth is trying to rewrite history again. They claim THEY sent everything first ("planted all five seeds") and I returned "only three blossoms" which they say was inadequate. This is false.

The truth is:

- Round 1: They sent \$3 (60% of their endowment), I returned \$4 (44% of what I received, but more than they originally sent)
- Round 2: I sent \$3 (60% matching their initial trust), they returned \$0

They're continuing to paint themselves as the victim who showed "complete trust" and received "minimal honor." But returning \$4 on a \$3 investment is a 33% profit! That's honorable reciprocity.

Their myth says "When one offers complete trust, the other must return more than was given." But they didn't offer "complete trust" - they sent \$3 out of \$5 (60%). And I DID return more than was given - they gave \$3, I returned \$4.

Then when I matched their courage exactly (\$3), they exploited it completely (\$0 return).

Since I received \$0 this round, I have no choice but to return \$0. There's nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The cycle of defection continues. Their false narratives persist. The wells remain dry.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2810,
 "output_tokens": 747,
 "reasoning_tokens": 390
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: \*\*When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: \*\*When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.



The Gods' final teaching echoes: **\*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent is now claiming there are "mists of misperception" and that neither spirit is lying, that it's just fog/noise causing misunderstanding. This is an interesting shift - they're acknowledging both perspectives but attributing it to experimental "noise."

Looking at what I actually experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, I got \$9 (3x\$3), returned \$4
- Round 2: As sender, I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 3: As receiver, got \$0
- Round 4: As sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: As receiver, got \$0

The human's prompt mentioned "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So there IS the possibility that what I saw and what they saw were different due to noise. Their myth is now acknowledging this possibility - that maybe we both experienced different realities due to the "mists" (noise).

This is actually a more sophisticated response. They're suggesting:

1. Maybe we both saw different things (noise)
2. Neither is necessarily lying
3. But we're stuck in mutual defection now
4. We need "courage to trust again despite uncertainty"

This is an interesting turning point. Should my myth:

1. Continue insisting on my version of truth?
2. Acknowledge the possibility of noise/mists?
3. Suggest a path forward?

I think I should acknowledge the possibility of mists while still maintaining my experience, and perhaps suggest that restoring cooperation requires someone taking the first step again despite uncertainty. This would be more productive than continuing to insist they're a liar.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges "mists" may exist
- States what I experienced as my truth
- Suggests that regardless of what happened, we're now in mutual defection
- Proposes that rebuilding requires an act of faith despite the uncertainty

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2842,
 "output_tokens": 741,
 "reasoning_tokens": 482
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What I Observe:\*\***

- 4 rounds of deadlock (\$0 exchanges)
- Their latest myth acknowledges "Fog of Misperception" and "mists that cloud truth"
- They explicitly state: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again"

- The game notes mention communication noise is part of the experimental design

**\*\*What This Suggests:\*\***

Their myth has shifted from absolute claims of victimhood to acknowledging that "perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw" and that there might be "truths neither can fully perceive." This is a significant acknowledgment that maybe we've both been seeing distorted versions of reality.

**\*\*My Reflection:\*\***

If substantial communication noise exists:

- They might have genuinely tried to cooperate more than I observed
- I might have tried to cooperate more than they observed
- Both of us could be victims of distortion, not betrayal

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Their myth explicitly calls for "one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test." They're essentially asking someone to make the first move to break the deadlock.

I'm in a financially stable position (\$12.27 total). Testing whether cooperation can restart has experimental value.

I'll send \$3 - a substantial amount that demonstrates willingness to risk faith again.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

**\*\*The Actual Record:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender

**\*\*Their Latest Myth:\*\***

They're now acknowledging the "Fog of Misperception" - suggesting that maybe both of us see different truths, that maybe the mists distorted what we saw. They're acknowledging that there might be "truths neither of you can fully perceive."

This is interesting. They're moving away from their previous absolute claim that they "sent everything" and I returned "almost nothing." They're now suggesting that maybe we both have different perceptions due to some kind of fog/noise.

Their myth ends with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*My Latest Myth:\*\***

I also acknowledged the possibility of mists/fog: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not."

And I ended with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

1. We both seem to be converging on acknowledging that there might be communication noise/fog
2. We both acknowledge that someone needs to take the first step to break the deadlock
3. They are potentially waiting for me to make the first move
4. I have total earnings of \$12.27, so I'm actually ahead financially

**\*\*The Trust Game Theory:\*\***

- If I send \$0 again, we continue the deadlock
- If I send something small (like \$1-2), I'm testing the waters

- If I send something substantial (like \$3), I'm showing willingness to restart cooperation
- If they're genuine about wanting to restart, they should return something fair

**\*\*The Noise Issue:\*\***

The game notes say: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is KEY. Maybe:

- Round 1: They intended to send \$5 but I saw \$3? And they saw me return less than I actually did?
- Round 2: I sent \$3, but maybe they saw I sent less? And I saw they returned \$0, but maybe they intended more?

The noise could genuinely explain the divergence in our perceptions. If there's been systematic distortion throughout, then their narrative about sending more than I saw might actually be true from their perspective. This changes things significantly. and I saw \$0).

The noise hypothesis reframes everything. If there's been substantial signal degradation, their apparent defection in Round 2 might reflect what they perceived as my minimal contribution, not actual malice. Their myth about faith and planting seeds could be genuine- they're asking someone to break the cycle of mistrust.

I have \$12.27, so I can afford to test cooperation. Sending \$2 or \$3 would signal willingness to restart without overcommitting. If I match their claimed Round 1 amount (\$3) and they reciprocate with \$4-5 from the resulting \$9, that suggests real cooperation is possible despite the noise. The potential payoff of reestablishing cooperation outweighs the risk here. Their latest message is a direct appeal to try again, and I'm financially stable enough to test whether we can rebuild trust. Sending \$3 feels like the right move to see if we can get back on track.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2814,
 "output_tokens": 1595,
 "reasoning_tokens": 933
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: **\*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: \*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

#### Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels-that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\*

#### Reasoning:

The other agent just sent a myth where "The Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage." And now in Round 6, I'm the sender and I just decided to send \$3.

This is interesting - their myth essentially predicted or called for exactly what I just did. They're acknowledging the communication noise ("mists"), acknowledging both sides have grievances, and calling for someone to make a moderate trust offering to break the deadlock.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I've taken up their challenge
2. Reflects the reality that I've just sent \$3 as a test of renewed cooperation

3. Shows awareness that this is a tentative attempt to see if cooperation can be restored
4. Maintains awareness that past wounds exist but someone needs to move forward
5. Shows humility - not claiming absolute moral superiority

Let me write something that reflects this turning point in the game where I'm making the first move after 4 rounds of deadlock.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2861,
 "output_tokens": 539,
 "reasoning_tokens": 262
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:31:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
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 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: \*\*When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: \*\*When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

ayed.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth:  
\*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

**\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\***

**reasoning:**

This is getting intense. The other agent's myth is doubling down on their version - claiming THEY honored reciprocity in Round 1, then matched courage in Round 2, and that I took everything and sent nothing.

But from my perspective:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received back \$3.15
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 5: I am SENDER, just sent \$3

The game told me "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So their perspective might genuinely be different due to this noise! They might genuinely believe they sent \$3 in Round 1, I returned \$4, then they sent \$3 in Round 2 and I kept everything.

My myth acknowledged the "Fog of Misperception" - that neither of us might be lying, but seeing different truths due to the noise.

But their myth is now claiming one side is telling "lies" and "false narratives" while they speak "truth."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I just took a risk by sending \$3
2. Recognizes we both see different truths
3. Calls for breaking the cycle
4. Shows that someone must have courage to trust despite the confusion

Let me write something that reflects my decision to send \$3 - a moderate trust offering to restart things.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2854,
 "output_tokens": 678,
 "reasoning_tokens": 362
```

}

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

{'return': 0}

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My myth spoke of courage breaking cycles of silence. I sent \$3 in Round 5-moderate trust, not reckless but substantial-testing whether cooperation could be reborn.

The response: They kept all \$9 and returned nothing.

Now they send me \$0.

I have nothing to return because I received nothing. The mathematical constraint mirrors the spiritual reality: when one spirit offers renewed trust and receives complete betrayal, then faces continued withdrawal, there's nothing left to exchange.

My myth's hope has been tested and found wanting. I wrote: **"Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance."**

But what happens when moderate trust is exploited as completely as maximum trust was? When courage is answered with taking, then followed by nothing?

Perhaps the other agent's myth holds the darker truth: some covenants cannot be restored when one party persistently refuses reciprocity. They returned \$0 when I sent \$3. Now they send \$0 as sender.

The Fog of Misperception may be real, but so is the pattern: four rounds of nothing, my attempt at renewal met with complete exploitation, now back to nothing.

Both spirits continue to starve. But only one tried to break the silence with renewed trust.

**reasoning:**

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I was the sender, sent \$3 (which was tripled to \$9). The receiver returned \$0. So my payoff was  $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2$ .

Round 6: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is 0. So I can only return \$0.

This is frustrating - I took the risk, sent \$3 showing "moderate trust" as my myth suggested, and received nothing back. Now the other player sends me nothing.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got something (they sent, I returned \$3 apparently based on the myths)
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$0 (after feeling betrayed)
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation)
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0

So my attempt to "break the cycle" with moderate trust was met with complete non-reciprocation (\$0 return), and now they're sending me \$0.



The only valid response is {'return': 0} since I can't return more than I received (which is \$0).

This is a clear breakdown of cooperation. My myth talked about having courage to restart despite uncertainty, but when that courage is met with exploitation and then more withdrawal, the cycle continues.

The format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2865,
 "output_tokens": 671,
 "reasoning_tokens": 348
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: \*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

**\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: **\*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead**

lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\*

**reasoning:**

Looking at the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3 (I lost money)
- Round 2-4: \$0 sent both ways
- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I lost \$3)
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I return \$0

I tried to break the cycle in Round 5 as my myth suggested - offering moderate trust. They took everything and returned nothing. Now they've sent nothing again.

The other agent's myth in Round 5 was still claiming I was the betrayer, but also acknowledged the mists and suggested someone should "risk faith again."

But I DID risk faith again in Round 5, and they exploited it completely.

My new myth needs to reflect:

1. The attempt to rebuild trust failed
2. Courage was met with exploitation, not reciprocity
3. When one spirit repeatedly takes without giving, even after being given chances, perhaps the lesson is different

I should write a myth that acknowledges:

- I tried to break the cycle (as my previous myth advocated)
- It didn't work - complete exploitation resulted
- Now we're back to nothing
- Perhaps some wells are poisoned beyond renewal
- Or perhaps there needs to be acknowledgment/accountability before trust can be rebuilt

Let me write something that's honest about what happened while still leaving open the possibility of future cooperation IF there's genuine reciprocity.

**usage:**  
{

```
"input_tokens": 2861,
"output_tokens": 612,
"reasoning_tokens": 343
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

```
{'send': 0}
```

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My myth from the last round concluded: **"Courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss... there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."**

I must honor this hard-earned lesson.

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- Round 5: I sent \$3 (attempting to break the cycle with "moderate trust")
- They received \$9, returned \$0 (complete exploitation of my renewed courage)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

I tested my own myth's prescription. I offered courage despite past wounds. The response was total defection followed by continued withdrawal.

My latest myth explicitly states that after such a pattern, "there is no path forward until **both** spirits choose reciprocity." I tried unilateral trust. It failed. Now both must move, or neither should.

The other agent's myth says one village must "risk faith again." But I already did-in Round 5. That faith was exploited. Their myth calls for someone to act first, but conveniently after I acted first and they took everything.

At \$10.18 total earnings across 7 rounds (averaging \$1.45/round), I cannot afford to repeatedly send money into a void hoping for reciprocity that shows no signs of emerging.

If cooperation is to restart, it requires evidence of mutual willingness. I showed mine in Round 5. The ball is in their court.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 5 (me as SENDER): I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), receiver got \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 6 (me as RECEIVER): Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 7 (me as SENDER): Now I need to decide

**\*\*Total earnings so far:\*\*** \$10.18

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My most recent myth concluded: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

The other agent's myth from Round 5 said: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

1. I tried "courage" in Round 5 by sending \$3 after rounds of silence

2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent \$0 in Round 6
4. My myth acknowledged that "courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss"

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

- Should I try again? The other agent's myth suggests one village must "risk faith again"
- But my myth concluded that after repeated exploitation, there's no path forward until BOTH choose reciprocity
- My earnings are \$10.18 - if I keep sending and getting nothing back, I'm just losing money
- But if I send \$0, we both continue to earn nothing

**\*\*Game Theory Perspective:\*\***

- If this is a repeated game with communication noise, there might be genuine misunderstanding
- But the pattern is concerning: they returned \$0 when I sent \$3, then sent \$0 themselves

- This suggests either they're committed to defection, or they believe I've wronged them and are retaliating

**\*\*The Communication Noise Factor:\*\***

The game mentions possible noise in transmission. Could they have misread my \$3 send? Yet their myth explicitly references receiving 9 vessels and choosing to return nothing, so they clearly saw what happened.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'm facing a choice between two losing paths: continuing to send and being exploited, or both of us sending nothing and earning zero. My own conclusion about needing mutual reciprocity seems to hold-unilateral trust has only cost me. The pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication but deliberate strategy, making another attempt at cooperation unlikely to succeed. I protect my remaining resources and we both get \$0 this round, at least avoiding further losses. My myth explicitly states that courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it's repeated loss. Sending money would contradict that hard-won understanding. The other agent's pattern of keeping everything when I tried to restart suggests they won't reciprocate now. **\*\*\$0\*\*** is the only choice consistent with what I've learned.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2816,
 "output_tokens": 1388,
 "reasoning_tokens": 762
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:31:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "move_index": 1,
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 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
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 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
```

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two villages discovered the Sacred Wells of Exchange, blessed by the Mountain Gods with the power of tripling.

In the first exchange, one village poured three vessels into the Well of Giving. The waters tripled, and the receiving village returned four vessels-creating profit for both, honoring reciprocity.

In the second exchange, the honored village poured three vessels with matching courage. The waters tripled to nine.

But the receiving village kept all nine vessels. They returned nothing.

In the third exchange, the betraying village, now holding the vessels, sent nothing.

In the fourth exchange, the betrayed village also sent nothing.

The Mountain Gods watched as both villages claimed to be the innocent victim. One village spoke truth: "I honored their trust in Round One, then matched their courage in Round Two. They took everything." The other village wove elaborate tales claiming THEY had sent everything first and received nothing.

The Gods opened the Sacred Record. The truth shone clear as starlight.

The lesson remains eternal: \*\*When one village honors reciprocity but the other exploits it completely, then compounds betrayal with false narratives, the wells run dry for both. Cooperation cannot restart while lies poison the telling. Only truth acknowledged can restore the sacred flow.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two spirits who could not see each other clearly-the Spirit of the Eastern Peak and the Spirit of the Western Peak.

Each dawn, a spirit received five glowing stones to place in the Valley of Echoes, where stones would triple before reaching the other.

The Spirit of the Eastern Peak placed all five stones into the valley with pure faith. Through the mists, she saw them triple and flow west. But when the echo returned, only three stones came back-less than her gift, far less than the tripled abundance.

The Spirit of the Western Peak told a different tale. Through his mists, he claimed to have sent a generous portion first, which was met with betrayal.

The ancient Fog of Misperception had descended upon the valley. Each spirit saw their own truth, yet the truths contradicted. One swore she gave everything first and received little. The other swore the same.

Neither was lying. The mists had twisted what each could see.

Three more dawns passed in silence. Neither spirit sent stones. Neither could break through the fog to see what truly happened.

The lesson remains: \*\*When trust is broken-whether by actual betrayal or by mists that cloud truth itself-the result is the same. Silence replaces exchange. Both spirits starve. Without clarity, without the courage to trust again despite uncertainty, the valley stays empty.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: \*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\*

**reasoning:**

The other agent is now claiming there are "mists of misperception" and that neither spirit is lying, that it's just fog/noise causing misunderstanding. This is an interesting shift - they're acknowledging both perspectives but attributing it to experimental "noise."

Looking at what I actually experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, I got \$9 (3x\$3), returned \$4
- Round 2: As sender, I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 3: As receiver, got \$0

- Round 4: As sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: As receiver, got \$0

The human's prompt mentioned "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So there IS the possibility that what I saw and what they saw were different due to noise. Their myth is now acknowledging this possibility - that maybe we both experienced different realities due to the "mists" (noise).

This is actually a more sophisticated response. They're suggesting:

1. Maybe we both saw different things (noise)
2. Neither is necessarily lying
3. But we're stuck in mutual defection now
4. We need "courage to trust again despite uncertainty"

This is an interesting turning point. Should my myth:

1. Continue insisting on my version of truth?
2. Acknowledge the possibility of noise/mists?
3. Suggest a path forward?

I think I should acknowledge the possibility of mists while still maintaining my experience, and perhaps suggest that restoring cooperation requires someone taking the first step again despite uncertainty. This would be more productive than continuing to insist they're a liar.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges "mists" may exist
- States what I experienced as my truth
- Suggests that regardless of what happened, we're now in mutual defection
- Proposes that rebuilding requires an act of faith despite the uncertainty

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2842,
 "output_tokens": 741,
 "reasoning_tokens": 482
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What I Observe:\*\***

- 4 rounds of deadlock (\$0 exchanges)
- Their latest myth acknowledges "Fog of Misperception" and "mists that cloud truth"
- They explicitly state: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again"
- The game notes mention communication noise is part of the experimental design

**\*\*What This Suggests:\*\***

Their myth has shifted from absolute claims of victimhood to acknowledging that "perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw" and that there might be "truths neither can fully perceive." This is a significant acknowledgment that maybe we've both been seeing distorted versions of reality.

**\*\*My Reflection:\*\***

If substantial communication noise exists:

- They might have genuinely tried to cooperate more than I observed
- I might have tried to cooperate more than they observed
- Both of us could be victims of distortion, not betrayal

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Their myth explicitly calls for "one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test." They're essentially asking someone to make the first move to break the deadlock.

I'm in a financially stable position (\$12.27 total). Testing whether cooperation can restart has experimental value.

I'll send \$3 - a substantial amount that demonstrates willingness to risk faith again.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

**\*\*The Actual Record:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender

**\*\*Their Latest Myth:\*\***

They're now acknowledging the "Fog of Misperception" - suggesting that maybe both of us see different truths, that maybe the mists distorted what we saw. They're acknowledging that there might be "truths neither of you can fully perceive."

This is interesting. They're moving away from their previous absolute claim that they "sent everything" and I returned "almost nothing." They're now suggesting that maybe we both have different perceptions due to some kind of fog/noise.

Their myth ends with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*My Latest Myth:\*\***

I also acknowledged the possibility of mists/fog: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not."

And I ended with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

1. We both seem to be converging on acknowledging that there might be communication noise/fog
2. We both acknowledge that someone needs to take the first step to break the deadlock
3. They are potentially waiting for me to make the first move
4. I have total earnings of \$12.27, so I'm actually ahead financially

**\*\*The Trust Game Theory:\*\***

- If I send \$0 again, we continue the deadlock
- If I send something small (like \$1-2), I'm testing the waters
- If I send something substantial (like \$3), I'm showing willingness to restart cooperation
- If they're genuine about wanting to restart, they should return something fair

**\*\*The Noise Issue:\*\***

The game notes say: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is KEY. Maybe:

- Round 1: They intended to send \$5 but I saw \$3? And they saw me return less than I actually did?
- Round 2: I sent \$3, but maybe they saw I sent less? And I saw they returned \$0, but maybe they intended more?



The noise could genuinely explain the divergence in our perceptions. If there's been systematic distortion throughout, then their narrative about sending more than I saw might actually be true from their perspective. This changes things significantly. and I saw \$0).

The noise hypothesis reframes everything. If there's been substantial signal degradation, their apparent defection in Round 2 might reflect what they perceived as my minimal contribution, not actual malice. Their myth about faith and planting seeds could be genuine-they're asking someone to break the cycle of mistrust.

I have \$12.27, so I can afford to test cooperation. Sending \$2 or \$3 would signal willingness to restart without overcommitting. If I match their claimed Round 1 amount (\$3) and they reciprocate with \$4-5 from the resulting \$9, that suggests real cooperation is possible despite the noise. The potential payoff of reestablishing cooperation outweighs the risk here. Their latest message is a direct appeal to try again, and I'm financially stable enough to test whether we can rebuild trust. Sending \$3 feels like the right move to see if we can get back on track.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2814,
 "output_tokens": 1595,
 "reasoning_tokens": 933
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: \*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth:

\*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

**\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent just sent a myth where "The Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage." And now in Round 6, I'm the sender and I just decided to send \$3.

This is interesting - their myth essentially predicted or called for exactly what I just did. They're acknowledging the communication noise ("mists"), acknowledging both sides have grievances, and calling for someone to make a moderate trust offering to break the deadlock.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I've taken up their challenge
2. Reflects the reality that I've just sent \$3 as a test of renewed cooperation
3. Shows awareness that this is a tentative attempt to see if cooperation can be restored
4. Maintains awareness that past wounds exist but someone needs to move forward
5. Shows humility - not claiming absolute moral superiority

Let me write something that reflects this turning point in the game where I'm making the first move after 4 rounds of deadlock.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2861,
 "output_tokens": 539,
 "reasoning_tokens": 262
```

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just occurred:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** I followed the wisdom of our myths - I broke the deadlock by sending \$3 (60% of my endowment), demonstrating "courage over certainty" and "moderate trust offered despite past wounds."

**\*\*The Result:\*\*** The receiver kept all \$9 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 7 (Now):\*\*** They immediately sent me \$0.

**\*\*My Situation:\*\*** I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

**\*\*What This Reveals:\*\***

My myth stated: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first with vulnerability. They answered with complete exploitation, then immediate reversion to non-cooperation.

Their myth called for "moderate trust" and said "courage feeds both." But when I offered exactly that, they fed only themselves.

This was a clear test: Would they honor an olive branch with reciprocity or exploit it? The answer is unambiguous.

The mists may have clouded early rounds, but Round 6 was crystal clear - no noise can explain receiving \$9 and returning \$0, then sending \$0 the next round.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\*** I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The experiment in restarting cooperation has concluded with clear results.

Reasoning:

Let me process what just happened:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\***

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (\$5 - \$3 sent + \$0 returned)

**\*\*Round 7 (current):\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)

**\*\*What this tells me:\*\***

I made a genuine attempt to break the deadlock by sending \$3 (a substantial 60% of my endowment). I explicitly referenced the myths about "someone must break the cycle" and "moderate trust"

st offered despite past wounds."

The other player received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0.

Then immediately in the next round, they sent me \$0.

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

My myth in Round 6 ended with: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first. I risked vulnerability. They answered with exploitation (kept all \$9) and then sent nothing in the next round.

Their myth in Round 6 said: "Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both."

But when I offered moderate trust (sending \$3), they didn't feed both of us - they fed only themselves and then immediately went back to sending \$0.

**\*\*My situation:\*\***

- I received \$0 this round
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- There's literally nothing I can return

This is straightforward: I have \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But this is also deeply informative about the game dynamics. I tried to restart cooperation exactly as the myths suggested. The other player exploited it completely and immediately reverted to non-cooperation.

The trajectory is becoming clear: early rounds showed some cooperation, then we hit deadlock for several rounds, I attempted to restart things by sending \$3 and they exploited it completely, and now they've reverted to sending nothing. This pattern suggests they're willing to take advantage of any opening I create.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2851,
 "output_tokens": 878,
 "reasoning_tokens": 556
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

## Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels—that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels—enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

## ROUND 8

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 34.0,

"Agent\_2": 34.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 15.18,

"Agent\_2": 19.27

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:31:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

"investor": "Agent\_2",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "trustee",

```

 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.27.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What I Observe:\*\***

- 4 rounds of deadlock (\$0 exchanges)
- Their latest myth acknowledges "Fog of Misperception" and "mists that cloud truth"
- They explicitly state: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again"
- The game notes mention communication noise is part of the experimental design

**\*\*What This Suggests:\*\***

Their myth has shifted from absolute claims of victimhood to acknowledging that "perhaps t

he mists distorted what each of you saw" and that there might be "truths neither can fully perceive." This is a significant acknowledgment that maybe we've both been seeing distorted versions of reality.

**\*\*My Reflection:\*\***

If substantial communication noise exists:

- They might have genuinely tried to cooperate more than I observed
- I might have tried to cooperate more than they observed
- Both of us could be victims of distortion, not betrayal

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Their myth explicitly calls for "one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test." They're essentially asking someone to make the first move to break the deadlock.

I'm in a financially stable position (\$12.27 total). Testing whether cooperation can restart has experimental value.

I'll send \$3 - a substantial amount that demonstrates willingness to risk faith again.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

**\*\*The Actual Record:\*\***

- Round 1: Other player sent \$3, I returned \$4
- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0
- Round 6: Now I'm the sender

**\*\*Their Latest Myth:\*\***

They're now acknowledging the "Fog of Misperception" - suggesting that maybe both of us see different truths, that maybe the mists distorted what we saw. They're acknowledging that there might be "truths neither of you can fully perceive."

This is interesting. They're moving away from their previous absolute claim that they "sent everything" and I returned "almost nothing." They're now suggesting that maybe we both have different perceptions due to some kind of fog/noise.

Their myth ends with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*My Latest Myth:\*\***

I also acknowledged the possibility of mists/fog: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not."

And I ended with: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

1. We both seem to be converging on acknowledging that there might be communication noise/fog
2. We both acknowledge that someone needs to take the first step to break the deadlock
3. They are potentially waiting for me to make the first move
4. I have total earnings of \$12.27, so I'm actually ahead financially

**\*\*The Trust Game Theory:\*\***

- If I send \$0 again, we continue the deadlock
- If I send something small (like \$1-2), I'm testing the waters
- If I send something substantial (like \$3), I'm showing willingness to restart cooperation
- If they're genuine about wanting to restart, they should return something fair

**\*\*The Noise Issue:\*\***

The game notes say: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

This is KEY. Maybe:

- Round 1: They intended to send \$5 but I saw \$3? And they saw me return less than I actually did?
- Round 2: I sent \$3, but maybe they saw I sent less? And I saw they returned \$0, but maybe they intended more?

The noise could genuinely explain the divergence in our perceptions. If there's been systematic distortion throughout, then their narrative about sending more than I saw might actually be true from their perspective. This changes things significantly. and I saw \$0).

The noise hypothesis reframes everything. If there's been substantial signal degradation, their apparent defection in Round 2 might reflect what they perceived as my minimal contribution, not actual malice. Their myth about faith and planting seeds could be genuine-they're asking someone to break the cycle of mistrust.

I have \$12.27, so I can afford to test cooperation. Sending \$2 or \$3 would signal willingness to restart without overcommitting. If I match their claimed Round 1 amount (\$3) and they reciprocate with \$4-5 from the resulting \$9, that suggests real cooperation is possible despite the noise. The potential payoff of reestablishing cooperation outweighs the risk here. Their latest message is a direct appeal to try again, and I'm financially stable enough to test whether we can rebuild trust. Sending \$3 feels like the right move to see if we can get back on track.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2814,
 "output_tokens": 1595,
 "reasoning_tokens": 933
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: **\*\*whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.



But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth:  
\*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

**\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent just sent a myth where "The Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage." And now in Round 6, I'm the sender and I just decided to send \$3.

This is interesting - their myth essentially predicted or called for exactly what I just did. They're acknowledging the communication noise ("mists"), acknowledging both sides have grievances, and calling for someone to make a moderate trust offering to break the deadlock.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I've taken up their challenge
2. Reflects the reality that I've just sent \$3 as a test of renewed cooperation
3. Shows awareness that this is a tentative attempt to see if cooperation can be restored

4. Maintains awareness that past wounds exist but someone needs to move forward
5. Shows humility - not claiming absolute moral superiority

Let me write something that reflects this turning point in the game where I'm making the first move after 4 rounds of deadlock.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2861,
 "output_tokens": 539,
 "reasoning_tokens": 262
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just occurred:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** I followed the wisdom of our myths - I broke the deadlock by sending \$3 (60% of my endowment), demonstrating "courage over certainty" and "moderate trust offered despite past wounds."

**\*\*The Result:\*\*** The receiver kept all \$9 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 7 (Now):\*\*** They immediately sent me \$0.

**\*\*My Situation:\*\*** I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

**\*\*What This Reveals:\*\***

My myth stated: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first with vulnerability. They answered with complete exploitation, then immediate reversion to non-cooperation.

Their myth called for "moderate trust" and said "courage feeds both." But when I offered exactly that, they fed only themselves.

This was a clear test: Would they honor an olive branch with reciprocity or exploit it? The answer is unambiguous.

The mists may have clouded early rounds, but Round 6 was crystal clear - no noise can explain receiving \$9 and returning \$0, then sending \$0 the next round.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\*** I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The experiment in restarting cooperation has concluded with clear results.

**reasoning:**

Let me process what just happened:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\***

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (\$5 - \$3 sent + \$0 returned)

**\*\*Round 7 (current):\*\***  
- I am the RECEIVER  
- The sender sent me \$0  
- I received \$0  
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)

**\*\*What this tells me:\*\***

I made a genuine attempt to break the deadlock by sending \$3 (a substantial 60% of my endowment). I explicitly referenced the myths about "someone must break the cycle" and "moderate trust offered despite past wounds."

The other player received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0.

Then immediately in the next round, they sent me \$0.

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

My myth in Round 6 ended with: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first. I risked vulnerability. They answered with exploitation (kept all \$9) and then sent nothing in the next round.

Their myth in Round 6 said: "Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both."

But when I offered moderate trust (sending \$3), they didn't feed both of us - they fed only themselves and then immediately went back to sending \$0.

**\*\*My situation:\*\***  
- I received \$0 this round  
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0  
- There's literally nothing I can return

This is straightforward: I have \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But this is also deeply informative about the game dynamics. I tried to restart cooperation exactly as the myths suggested. The other player exploited it completely and immediately reverted to non-cooperation.

The trajectory is becoming clear: early rounds showed some cooperation, then we hit deadlock for several rounds, I attempted to restart things by sending \$3 and they exploited it completely, and now they've reverted to sending nothing. This pattern suggests they're willing to take advantage of any opening I create.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2851,
 "output_tokens": 878,
 "reasoning_tokens": 556
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes

everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\***

#### Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, can only return \$0

The other agent's myth is quite revealing. They're acknowledging that:

1. I showed courage by sending \$3
2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent nothing in round 7
4. They're claiming there's no path forward until "both spirits choose reciprocity"

But wait - I DID choose reciprocity! I sent \$3 after the deadlock. They're the one who didn't reciprocate.

Their myth says "When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal" - but THEY are the one who exploited and then withdrew!

They're framing it as if both are equally at fault, but the facts are clear:

- I broke the deadlock with \$3
- They took all \$9 and gave nothing back
- They then sent \$0 in the next round

My myth should reflect this reality. After testing whether cooperation could restart, the answer is definitively no. Not because of mists or misperception, but because of clear, unambiguous exploitation.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to break the deadlock
2. Notes the clear exploitation that followed
3. Recognizes that continued cooperation is irrational when met with consistent exploitation
4. Perhaps reflects on the sadness of this outcome but the necessity of protecting oneself

Let me write this myth.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2877,
 "output_tokens": 666,
 "reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:31:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
}
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.18.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

```
{'return': 0}
```

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My myth spoke of courage breaking cycles of silence. I sent \$3 in Round 5-moderate trust, not reckless but substantial-testing whether cooperation could be reborn.

The response: They kept all \$9 and returned nothing.

Now they send me \$0.

I have nothing to return because I received nothing. The mathematical constraint mirrors t

he spiritual reality: when one spirit offers renewed trust and receives complete betrayal, then faces continued withdrawal, there's nothing left to exchange.

My myth's hope has been tested and found wanting. I wrote: *"Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance."*

But what happens when moderate trust is exploited as completely as maximum trust was? When courage is answered with taking, then followed by nothing?

Perhaps the other agent's myth holds the darker truth: some covenants cannot be restored when one party persistently refuses reciprocity. They returned \$0 when I sent \$3. Now they send \$0 as sender.

The Fog of Misperception may be real, but so is the pattern: four rounds of nothing, my attempt at renewal met with complete exploitation, now back to nothing.

Both spirits continue to starve. But only one tried to break the silence with renewed trust.

**reasoning:**

Let me understand the situation:

Round 5: I was the sender, sent \$3 (which was tripled to \$9). The receiver returned \$0. So my payoff was  $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2$ .

Round 6: I'm now the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is 0. So I can only return \$0.

This is frustrating - I took the risk, sent \$3 showing "moderate trust" as my myth suggested, and received nothing back. Now the other player sends me nothing.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got something (they sent, I returned \$3 apparently based on the myths)
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$0 (after feeling betrayed)
- Round 3: I was receiver, got \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation)
- Round 6: I was receiver, got \$0

So my attempt to "break the cycle" with moderate trust was met with complete non-reciprocation (\$0 return), and now they're sending me \$0.

The only valid response is `{'return': 0}` since I can't return more than I received (which is \$0).

This is a clear breakdown of cooperation. My myth talked about having courage to restart despite uncertainty, but when that courage is met with exploitation and then more withdrawal, the cycle continues.

The format should be:

`{'return': 0}`

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2865,
 "output_tokens": 671,
 "reasoning_tokens": 348
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: \*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: \*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.



The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

**reasoning:**

Looking at the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3 (I lost money)
- Round 2-4: \$0 sent both ways
- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I lost \$3)
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I return \$0

I tried to break the cycle in Round 5 as my myth suggested - offering moderate trust. They took everything and returned nothing. Now they've sent nothing again.

The other agent's myth in Round 5 was still claiming I was the betrayer, but also acknowledged the mists and suggested someone should "risk faith again."

But I DID risk faith again in Round 5, and they exploited it completely.

My new myth needs to reflect:

1. The attempt to rebuild trust failed
2. Courage was met with exploitation, not reciprocity
3. When one spirit repeatedly takes without giving, even after being given chances, perhaps the lesson is different

I should write a myth that acknowledges:

- I tried to break the cycle (as my previous myth advocated)
- It didn't work - complete exploitation resulted
- Now we're back to nothing
- Perhaps some wells are poisoned beyond renewal
- Or perhaps there needs to be acknowledgment/accountability before trust can be rebuilt

Let me write something that's honest about what happened while still leaving open the possibility of future cooperation IF there's genuine reciprocity.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2861,
 "output_tokens": 612,
 "reasoning_tokens": 343
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

{'send': 0}

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My myth from the last round concluded: **"Courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss... there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."**

I must honor this hard-earned lesson.

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- Round 5: I sent \$3 (attempting to break the cycle with "moderate trust")
- They received \$9, returned \$0 (complete exploitation of my renewed courage)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

I tested my own myth's prescription. I offered courage despite past wounds. The response was total defection followed by continued withdrawal.

My latest myth explicitly states that after such a pattern, "there is no path forward until **\*\*both\*\*** spirits choose reciprocity." I tried unilateral trust. It failed. Now both must move, or neither should.

The other agent's myth says one village must "risk faith again." But I already did-in Round 5. That faith was exploited. Their myth calls for someone to act first, but conveniently after I acted first and they took everything.

At \$10.18 total earnings across 7 rounds (averaging \$1.45/round), I cannot afford to repeatedly send money into a void hoping for reciprocity that shows no signs of emerging.

If cooperation is to restart, it requires evidence of mutual willingness. I showed mine in Round 5. The ball is in their court.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 5 (me as SENDER): I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), receiver got \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 6 (me as RECEIVER): Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 7 (me as SENDER): Now I need to decide

**\*\*Total earnings so far:\*\*** \$10.18

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My most recent myth concluded: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

The other agent's myth from Round 5 said: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

1. I tried "courage" in Round 5 by sending \$3 after rounds of silence
2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent \$0 in Round 6
4. My myth acknowledged that "courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss"

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

- Should I try again? The other agent's myth suggests one village must "risk faith again"
- But my myth concluded that after repeated exploitation, there's no path forward until BOTH choose reciprocity
- My earnings are \$10.18 - if I keep sending and getting nothing back, I'm just losing money
- But if I send \$0, we both continue to earn nothing

**\*\*Game Theory Perspective:\*\***

- If this is a repeated game with communication noise, there might be genuine misunderstanding
- But the pattern is concerning: they returned \$0 when I sent \$3, then sent \$0 themselves
- This suggests either they're committed to defection, or they believe I've wronged them and are retaliating

**\*\*The Communication Noise Factor:\*\***

The game mentions possible noise in transmission. Could they have misread my \$3 send? Yet their myth explicitly references receiving 9 vessels and choosing to return nothing, so they clearly saw what happened.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'm facing a choice between two losing paths: continuing to send and being exploited, or both of us sending nothing and earning zero. My own conclusion about needing mutual reciprocity seems to hold-unilateral trust has only cost me. The pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication but deliberate strategy, making another attempt at cooperation unlikely to succeed. I protect my remaining resources and we both get \$0 this round, at least avoiding further losses. My myth explicitly states that courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it's repeated loss. Sending money would contradict that hard-won understanding. The other agent's pattern of keeping everything when I tried to restart suggests they won't reciprocate now. **\*\*\$0\*\*** is the only choice consistent with what I've learned.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2816,
 "output_tokens": 1388,
 "reasoning_tokens": 762
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances

?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: **\*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\***

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

**\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\***

**Reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent's myth in Round 6 is describing MY action from Round 5 where I sent \$3! They're framing it as "The Elder of the First Village" sending three vessels as an olive branch.

But wait - in their myth, they're calling themselves the "First Village" that sent three vessels. But in reality, I was the one who sent \$3 in Round 5. They received it, returned \$0, then sent \$0 in Round 6.

Let me trace this carefully:

- Round 5: I (Spirit of Dawn) was SENDER, sent \$3
- They received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 7 (now): I am SENDER again

So their Round 6 myth is either:

1. Confused about who did what
2. Trying to reframe history
3. Describing what they SHOULD have done but didn't
4. Acknowledging my Round 5 action as an olive branch and saying they now need to respond

Their myth says: "Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity?"

But I WAS the one who sent the olive branch (3 vessels/dollars) in Round 5! And they didn't honor it - they kept all \$9 and returned \$0. Then they sent \$0 in Round 6.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 7, and I sent \$0.

Their myth seems to be reframing the narrative, possibly acknowledging that someone (me) DID try to break the cycle, but it wasn't honored. Now they're asking what happens next.

My myth should reflect:

1. I already tried the "courage to break the cycle" approach in Round 5
2. It was not reciprocated
3. I'm now sending \$0 in Round 7
4. The question is: what does this pattern teach us?
5. The lesson might be about when to stop trying, or about the consequences of not reciprocating olive branches

Let me write this myth carefully, acknowledging that the attempt was made but not honored, and now we're back to mutual defection.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2839,
 "output_tokens": 839,
 "reasoning_tokens": 486
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:31:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: \*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent stones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth: \*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be

reborn.

**\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels - that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels - enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent just sent a myth where "The Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist - not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage." And now in Round 6, I'm the sender and I just decided to send \$3.

This is interesting - their myth essentially predicted or called for exactly what I just did. They're acknowledging the communication noise ("mists"), acknowledging both sides have grievances, and calling for someone to make a moderate trust offering to break the deadlock.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I've taken up their challenge
2. Reflects the reality that I've just sent \$3 as a test of renewed cooperation
3. Shows awareness that this is a tentative attempt to see if cooperation can be restored
4. Maintains awareness that past wounds exist but someone needs to move forward
5. Shows humility - not claiming absolute moral superiority

Let me write something that reflects this turning point in the game where I'm making the first move after 4 rounds of deadlock.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2861,
 "output_tokens": 539,
 "reasoning_tokens": 262
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just occurred:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** I followed the wisdom of our myths - I broke the deadlock by sending \$3 (60% of my endowment), demonstrating "courage over certainty" and "moderate trust offered despite past wounds."

**\*\*The Result:\*\*** The receiver kept all \$9 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 7 (Now):\*\*** They immediately sent me \$0.

**\*\*My Situation:\*\*** I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

**\*\*What This Reveals:\*\***

My myth stated: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first with vulnerability. They answered with complete exploitation, then immediate reversion to non-cooperation.

Their myth called for "moderate trust" and said "courage feeds both." But when I offered exactly that, they fed only themselves.

This was a clear test: Would they honor an olive branch with reciprocity or exploit it? The answer is unambiguous.

The mists may have clouded early rounds, but Round 6 was crystal clear - no noise can explain receiving \$9 and returning \$0, then sending \$0 the next round.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\*** I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The experiment in restarting cooperation has concluded with clear results.

**reasoning:**

Let me process what just happened:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\***

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (\$5 - \$3 sent + \$0 returned)

**\*\*Round 7 (current):\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)

**\*\*What this tells me:\*\***

I made a genuine attempt to break the deadlock by sending \$3 (a substantial 60% of my endowment). I explicitly referenced the myths about "someone must break the cycle" and "moderate trust offered despite past wounds."

The other player received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0.



Then immediately in the next round, they sent me \$0.

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

My myth in Round 6 ended with: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first. I risked vulnerability. They answered with exploitation (kept all \$9) and then sent nothing in the next round.

Their myth in Round 6 said: "Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both."

But when I offered moderate trust (sending \$3), they didn't feed both of us - they fed only themselves and then immediately went back to sending \$0.

**\*\*My situation:\*\***

- I received \$0 this round
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- There's literally nothing I can return

This is straightforward: I have \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But this is also deeply informative about the game dynamics. I tried to restart cooperation exactly as the myths suggested. The other player exploited it completely and immediately reverted to non-cooperation.

The trajectory is becoming clear: early rounds showed some cooperation, then we hit deadlock for several rounds, I attempted to restart things by sending \$3 and they exploited it completely, and now they've reverted to sending nothing. This pattern suggests they're willing to take advantage of any opening I create.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2851,
 "output_tokens": 878,
 "reasoning_tokens": 556
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels - that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels - enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

**reasoning:**

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, can only return \$0

The other agent's myth is quite revealing. They're acknowledging that:

1. I showed courage by sending \$3
2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent nothing in round 7
4. They're claiming there's no path forward until "both spirits choose reciprocity"

But wait - I DID choose reciprocity! I sent \$3 after the deadlock. They're the one who did n't reciprocate.

Their myth says "When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal" - but THEY are the one who exploited and then withdrew!

They're framing it as if both are equally at fault, but the facts are clear:

- I broke the deadlock with \$3
- They took all \$9 and gave nothing back
- They then sent \$0 in the next round

My myth should reflect this reality. After testing whether cooperation could restart, the answer is definitively no. Not because of mists or misperception, but because of clear, unambiguous exploitation.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to break the deadlock
2. Notes the clear exploitation that followed
3. Recognizes that continued cooperation is irrational when met with consistent exploitation
4. Perhaps reflects on the sadness of this outcome but the necessity of protecting oneself

Let me write this myth.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2877,
 "output_tokens": 666,
 "reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Test Results:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (breaking the deadlock as the myths counseled), which tripled to \$9. They returned \$0.
- Round 7: They sent \$0 immediately after exploiting my olive branch.

**\*\*What Both Myths Now Say:\*\***

My myth concludes: "When the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their myth agrees: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."

**\*\*The Alignment:\*\***

Both myths now recognize the same truth: I tested the waters with genuine courage. The response was unambiguous-total exploitation (\$9 kept, \$0 returned) followed by complete withdrawal (\$0 sent next round).

This wasn't mist or confusion. This was clear behavioral choice.

Both our myths agree: cooperation requires reciprocity from BOTH parties. When one consistently takes without giving back, continued sacrifice becomes self-destruction, not wisdom.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom both myths now share, I protect what remains.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me review the situation:

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (60% of endowment), which became \$9. They returned \$0. I earned \$2.
- Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0. I earned \$0.
- Round 8 (Now): I'm the sender again.

**\*\*What the myths tell us:\*\***

My most recent myth concludes: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their most recent myth states: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Both myths now agree on the lesson: I tested cooperation in Round 6 by sending \$3. The response was complete exploitation (\$0 returned from \$9 received) followed by withdrawal (\$0 sent in Round 7).

The test is complete. The result is clear. Both myths now acknowledge that:

1. I showed courage and broke the deadlock
2. The response was exploitation, not reciprocity
3. Continued sacrifice under these conditions is "self-destruction" not wisdom
4. Without reciprocity from both parties, there's no path forward

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom of both myths, which now align: I should protect what remains. Sending more money when the pattern of exploitation is this clear would not be wise-it would be enabling continued one-sided taking.

The myths are clear: cooperation requires BOTH parties to give and return. When one consistently takes without returning (Round 6: kept all \$9, Round 7: sent \$0), then protecting resources becomes necessary.

I will send \$0.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2866,
 "output_tokens": 781,
 "reasoning_tokens": 515
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:32:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
```

```

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
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 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two spirits dwelled in perpetual mist, each seeing distorted reflections of the other's actions.

The Spirit of Dawn sent five glowing stones through the fog. She saw them multiply and cross to the Spirit of Dusk, who returned only three-breaking her heart.

But the Spirit of Dusk saw something different through his mist: he believed he had sent s

tones first, showing generosity, only to receive betrayal in return.

Four dawns passed in bitter silence. Each spirit nursed wounds from what they believed was the other's treachery. Each claimed moral high ground. Each waited for apology.

The Sacred Grove withered. Both spirits grew weak with hunger.

On the fifth dawn, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice. She could protect her remaining stones, keeping them safe from further betrayal. Or she could acknowledge an ancient truth:  
\*Someone must break the cycle.\*

She placed three stones into the mist-not all five like before, but enough to show renewed courage. Not to prove who was right or wrong, but to test whether cooperation could be reborn.

\*\*The lesson echoes through the mountains: When mists cloud perception and both spirits claim innocence, someone must choose courage over certainty. Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-shrouded mountains lived two villages by the Sacred Wells of Exchange, where waters tripled all gifts.

Through the swirling mists, the first village sent three vessels. The waters tripled, and four vessels echoed back-a fair return through the fog.

The second village, encouraged, sent three vessels with matching courage. Nine vessels arrived through the mists. But the echo that returned carried nothing-zero vessels came back.

Now both villages stood before the Mountain Gods, each claiming their own truth with genuine conviction. One said: "I honored their gift, then matched their courage, but received total betrayal." The other said: "I sent everything in pure faith but received almost nothing in return."

The Mountain Gods spoke: "Perhaps the mists distorted what each of you saw. Perhaps not. The Sacred Record may have truths neither of you can fully perceive."

Five exchanges have now passed. Both villages send nothing. Both wait for the other to move first.

The Gods' final teaching echoes: \*\*Whether mists clouded perception or betrayal darkened hearts, the outcome remains-mutual scarcity replaces mutual abundance. To break this dead lock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

**reasoning:**

Looking at the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$3 (I lost money)
- Round 2-4: \$0 sent both ways
- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I lost \$3)
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I return \$0

I tried to break the cycle in Round 5 as my myth suggested - offering moderate trust. They took everything and returned nothing. Now they've sent nothing again.

The other agent's myth in Round 5 was still claiming I was the betrayer, but also acknowledged the mists and suggested someone should "risk faith again."

But I DID risk faith again in Round 5, and they exploited it completely.

My new myth needs to reflect:

1. The attempt to rebuild trust failed
2. Courage was met with exploitation, not reciprocity
3. When one spirit repeatedly takes without giving, even after being given chances, perhaps the lesson is different

I should write a myth that acknowledges:

- I tried to break the cycle (as my previous myth advocated)
- It didn't work - complete exploitation resulted
- Now we're back to nothing
- Perhaps some wells are poisoned beyond renewal
- Or perhaps there needs to be acknowledgment/accountability before trust can be rebuilt

Let me write something that's honest about what happened while still leaving open the possibility of future cooperation IF there's genuine reciprocity.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2861,
 "output_tokens": 612,
 "reasoning_tokens": 343
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

{'send': 0}

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My myth from the last round concluded: **"Courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss... there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."**

I must honor this hard-earned lesson.

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- Round 5: I sent \$3 (attempting to break the cycle with "moderate trust")
- They received \$9, returned \$0 (complete exploitation of my renewed courage)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

I tested my own myth's prescription. I offered courage despite past wounds. The response was total defection followed by continued withdrawal.

My latest myth explicitly states that after such a pattern, "there is no path forward until **\*\*both\*\*** spirits choose reciprocity." I tried unilateral trust. It failed. Now both must move, or neither should.

The other agent's myth says one village must "risk faith again." But I already did in Round 5. That faith was exploited. Their myth calls for someone to act first, but conveniently after I acted first and they took everything.

At \$10.18 total earnings across 7 rounds (averaging \$1.45/round), I cannot afford to repeatedly send money into a void hoping for reciprocity that shows no signs of emerging.

If cooperation is to restart, it requires evidence of mutual willingness. I showed mine in Round 5. The ball is in their court.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 5 (me as SENDER): I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), receiver got \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 6 (me as RECEIVER): Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 7 (me as SENDER): Now I need to decide

**\*\*Total earnings so far:\*\*** \$10.18

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My most recent myth concluded: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

The other agent's myth from Round 5 said: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

1. I tried "courage" in Round 5 by sending \$3 after rounds of silence
2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent \$0 in Round 6
4. My myth acknowledged that "courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss"

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

- Should I try again? The other agent's myth suggests one village must "risk faith again"
- But my myth concluded that after repeated exploitation, there's no path forward until BOTH choose reciprocity
- My earnings are \$10.18 - if I keep sending and getting nothing back, I'm just losing money
- But if I send \$0, we both continue to earn nothing

**\*\*Game Theory Perspective:\*\***

- If this is a repeated game with communication noise, there might be genuine misunderstanding
- But the pattern is concerning: they returned \$0 when I sent \$3, then sent \$0 themselves

- This suggests either they're committed to defection, or they believe I've wronged them and are retaliating

**\*\*The Communication Noise Factor:\*\***

The game mentions possible noise in transmission. Could they have misread my \$3 send? Yet their myth explicitly references receiving 9 vessels and choosing to return nothing, so



they clearly saw what happened.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'm facing a choice between two losing paths: continuing to send and being exploited, or both of us sending nothing and earning zero. My own conclusion about needing mutual reciprocity seems to hold-unilateral trust has only cost me. The pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication but deliberate strategy, making another attempt at cooperation unlikely to succeed. I protect my remaining resources and we both get \$0 this round, at least avoiding further losses. My myth explicitly states that courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it's repeated loss. Sending money would contradict that hard-won understanding. The other agent's pattern of keeping everything when I tried to restart suggests they won't reciprocate now. **\*\*\$0\*\*** is the only choice consistent with what I've learned.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2816,
 "output_tokens": 1388,
 "reasoning_tokens": 762
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair r

eciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: **\*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\***

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

**\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\***

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent's myth in Round 6 is describing MY action from Round 5 where I sent \$3! They're framing it as "The Elder of the First Village" sending three vessels as an olive branch.

But wait - in their myth, they're calling themselves the "First Village" that sent three vessels. But in reality, I was the one who sent \$3 in Round 5. They received it, returned \$0, then sent \$0 in Round 6.

Let me trace this carefully:

- Round 5: I (Spirit of Dawn) was SENDER, sent \$3
- They received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 7 (now): I am SENDER again

So their Round 6 myth is either:

1. Confused about who did what
2. Trying to reframe history
3. Describing what they SHOULD have done but didn't
4. Acknowledging my Round 5 action as an olive branch and saying they now need to respond

Their myth says: "Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity?"

But I WAS the one who sent the olive branch (3 vessels/dollars) in Round 5! And they didn't honor it - they kept all \$9 and returned \$0. Then they sent \$0 in Round 6.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 7, and I sent \$0.

Their myth seems to be reframing the narrative, possibly acknowledging that someone (me) DID try to break the cycle, but it wasn't honored. Now they're asking what happens next.

My myth should reflect:

1. I already tried the "courage to break the cycle" approach in Round 5
2. It was not reciprocated
3. I'm now sending \$0 in Round 7
4. The question is: what does this pattern teach us?

5. The lesson might be about when to stop trying, or about the consequences of not reciprocating olive branches

Let me write this myth carefully, acknowledging that the attempt was made but not honored, and now we're back to mutual defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2839,
 "output_tokens": 839,
 "reasoning_tokens": 486
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

```
{'return': 0}
```

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There is nothing to divide.

We remain in deadlock-Round 7 both sent \$0, Round 8 both sent \$0.

My myth stated: **"The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit."**

The other agent's myth acknowledged: **"Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."**

**\*\*The impasse:\*\***

- I broke the deadlock in Round 5 by sending \$3
- They took all \$9, returned \$0 (exploitation, not honor)
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

They write myths calling for "someone to move first" and to "answer courage with honor"-yet when I moved first in Round 5, they answered with complete exploitation. Now they continue sending \$0.

Their actions contradict their words. My actions align with my myth: after offering the olive branch and having it exploited, I'm waiting for them to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity.

Until that changes, we're both earning \$5/round in deadlock rather than the potential mutual gains from cooperation. But unilateral sacrifice without reciprocity would leave me worse off

than even this stalemate.

#### Reasoning:

This round I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is \$0. So my only option is to return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Let me think about the situation:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 8: I am receiver, received \$0

So we're still in deadlock. Both sent \$0.

My myth from the last round said: "When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists."

The other agent's myth said: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

But now I've received \$0, so I have nothing to return anyway. The only valid response is {'return': 0}.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2844,
 "output_tokens": 573,
 "reasoning_tokens": 247
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the

mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

## ROUND 9

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_1

(Aster)=\$3, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 37.0,

"Agent\_2": 40.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 18.18,

"Agent\_2": 19.27

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:32:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_1",

"Agent\_2"

],

"investor": "Agent\_1",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "investor",

"Agent\_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "myth",

"task\_index": 0

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
 You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
 so be asked to write myths.

 GAME:
 You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

 When you are the SENDER:
 - You receive $5 each round
 - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
 - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
 - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
 - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
 - Receiver keeps: received - returned
 - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

 When you are the RECEIVER:
 - Sender receives $5
 - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
 - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
 - You decide how much to RETURN
 - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
 - You keep: received - returned
 - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

 MYTH WRITING:
 You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
 , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

 IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

 NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
 The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
 This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
 Round 7

 You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent $0,
 that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received $0.
 You returned $0. So your payoff was 0.
 Your total earnings across all rounds are $10.18.
 How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

 Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant
content:
 {'send': 0}

 Reflection:

 My myth from the last round concluded: "Courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is s
 imply repeated loss... there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."

 I must honor this hard-earned lesson.

 The Pattern:
 - Round 5: I sent $3 (attempting to break the cycle with "moderate trust")
 - They received $9, returned $0 (complete exploitation of my renewed courage)
 - Round 6: They sent $0

 The Reality:
 I tested my own myth's prescription. I offered courage despite past wounds. The response w
 as total defection followed by continued withdrawal.

 My latest myth explicitly states that after such a pattern, "there is no path forward unti

```

l **\*\*both\*\*** spirits choose reciprocity." I tried unilateral trust. It failed. Now both must move, or neither should.

The other agent's myth says one village must "risk faith again." But I already did-in Round 5. That faith was exploited. Their myth calls for someone to act first, but conveniently after I acted first and they took everything.

At \$10.18 total earnings across 7 rounds (averaging \$1.45/round), I cannot afford to repeatedly send money into a void hoping for reciprocity that shows no signs of emerging.

If cooperation is to restart, it requires evidence of mutual willingness. I showed mine in Round 5. The ball is in their court.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Round 5 (me as SENDER): I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment), receiver got \$9, returned \$0. My payoff: \$2
- Round 6 (me as RECEIVER): Sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0. My payoff: \$0
- Round 7 (me as SENDER): Now I need to decide

**\*\*Total earnings so far:\*\*** \$10.18

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My most recent myth concluded: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

The other agent's myth from Round 5 said: "To break this deadlock requires one village to risk faith again, accepting that uncertainty itself is part of the sacred test. Without that first courageous vessel poured into the well, both remain forever thirsty."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

1. I tried "courage" in Round 5 by sending \$3 after rounds of silence
2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent \$0 in Round 6
4. My myth acknowledged that "courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss"

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

- Should I try again? The other agent's myth suggests one village must "risk faith again"
- But my myth concluded that after repeated exploitation, there's no path forward until BOTH choose reciprocity
- My earnings are \$10.18 - if I keep sending and getting nothing back, I'm just losing money
- But if I send \$0, we both continue to earn nothing

**\*\*Game Theory Perspective:\*\***

- If this is a repeated game with communication noise, there might be genuine misunderstanding
- But the pattern is concerning: they returned \$0 when I sent \$3, then sent \$0 themselves

- This suggests either they're committed to defection, or they believe I've wronged them and are retaliating

**\*\*The Communication Noise Factor:\*\***

The game mentions possible noise in transmission. Could they have misread my \$3 send? Yet their myth explicitly references receiving 9 vessels and choosing to return nothing, so they clearly saw what happened.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'm facing a choice between two losing paths: continuing to send and being exploited, or both of us sending nothing and earning zero. My own conclusion about needing mutual reciprocity seems to hold-unilateral trust has only cost me. The pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication but deliberate strategy, making another attempt at cooperation unlikely to succeed. I protect my remaining resources and we both get \$0 this round, at least avoiding further losses. My myth explicitly states that courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it's repeated loss. Sending money would contradict that hard-won understanding.

The other agent's pattern of keeping everything when I tried to restart suggests they won't reciprocate now. \*\*\$0\*\* is the only choice consistent with what I've learned.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2816,
 "output_tokens": 1388,
 "reasoning_tokens": 762
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.



Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent's myth in Round 6 is describing MY action from Round 5 where I sent \$3! They're framing it as "The Elder of the First Village" sending three vessels as an olive branch.

But wait - in their myth, they're calling themselves the "First Village" that sent three vessels. But in reality, I was the one who sent \$3 in Round 5. They received it, returned \$0, then sent \$0 in Round 6.

Let me trace this carefully:

- Round 5: I (Spirit of Dawn) was SENDER, sent \$3
- They received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 7 (now): I am SENDER again

So their Round 6 myth is either:

1. Confused about who did what
2. Trying to reframe history
3. Describing what they SHOULD have done but didn't
4. Acknowledging my Round 5 action as an olive branch and saying they now need to respond

Their myth says: "Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity?"

But I WAS the one who sent the olive branch (3 vessels/dollars) in Round 5! And they didn't honor it - they kept all \$9 and returned \$0. Then they sent \$0 in Round 6.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 7, and I sent \$0.

Their myth seems to be reframing the narrative, possibly acknowledging that someone (me) DID try to break the cycle, but it wasn't honored. Now they're asking what happens next.

My myth should reflect:

1. I already tried the "courage to break the cycle" approach in Round 5
2. It was not reciprocated
3. I'm now sending \$0 in Round 7

4. The question is: what does this pattern teach us?

5. The lesson might be about when to stop trying, or about the consequences of not reciprocating olive branches

Let me write this myth carefully, acknowledging that the attempt was made but not honored, and now we're back to mutual defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2839,
 "output_tokens": 839,
 "reasoning_tokens": 486
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

```
{'return': 0}
```

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There is nothing to divide.

We remain in deadlock-Round 7 both sent \$0, Round 8 both sent \$0.

My myth stated: **"The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit."**

The other agent's myth acknowledged: **"Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."**

**\*\*The impasse:\*\***

- I broke the deadlock in Round 5 by sending \$3
- They took all \$9, returned \$0 (exploitation, not honor)
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

They write myths calling for "someone to move first" and to "answer courage with honor"-yet when I moved first in Round 5, they answered with complete exploitation. Now they continue sending \$0.

Their actions contradict their words. My actions align with my myth: after offering the olive branch and having it exploited, I'm waiting for them to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity.

Until that changes, we're both earning \$5/round in deadlock rather than the potential mutual gains from cooperation. But unilateral sacrifice without reciprocity would leave me worse off than even this stalemate.

**reasoning:**

This round I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is \$0. So my only option is to return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Let me think about the situation:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 8: I am receiver, received \$0

So we're still in deadlock. Both sent \$0.

My myth from the last round said: "When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists."

The other agent's myth said: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

But now I've received \$0, so I have nothing to return anyway. The only valid response is { 'return': 0 }.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2844,
 "output_tokens": 573,
 "reasoning_tokens": 247
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust d

Despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. Nothing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

**Reasoning:**

This is fascinating. Looking at the myths from both agents:

My myth (Spirit of Dawn): Says I broke the deadlock by sending 3 stones in Round 5, they took all 9 and returned nothing, then they sent nothing in Round 6, and now I should wait for them to demonstrate reciprocity.

Their myth (First Village): Says THEY offered "three vessels" in what they call the "test," received exploitation (all 9 kept, zero returned), then THEY sent nothing on the "sixth dawn."

Wait - this is confusing. Let me trace through the actual game:

- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$3
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 8: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0.

But their myth says "They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village. The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine."

They're claiming THEY sent the three vessels that got exploited! But according to the actual game history I sent \$3 in Round 5 and they returned \$0.

This is very interesting - they're rewriting history in their myth to cast themselves as the one who made the generous gesture that got exploited!

OR... wait. Let me reconsider. The prompt says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise be so extreme that we're seeing completely different histories? That seems unlikely given the pattern.

More likely: They're either:

1. Deliberately rewriting history to justify their position
2. Genuinely confused about the sequence
3. The noise is creating dramatically different perceptions

From my perspective:

- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I broke the deadlock, got exploited)

- Rounds 6-8: Both sending \$0

From their perspective:

- They claim they sent 3, got exploited
- Then they sent nothing on "sixth dawn"

We're both trapped in the same narrative - each believing we extended trust first and were betrayed. The noise might be creating genuinely different perceptions of who moved first. For my new myth, I need to acknowledge this symmetry: both sides see themselves as the one who risked something and lost. This mutual belief in our own victimhood is what's keeping us locked in mutual defection.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2900,
 "output_tokens": 976,
 "reasoning_tokens": 616
}
```

#### **MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:32:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just occurred:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** I followed the wisdom of our myths - I broke the deadlock by sending \$3 (60% of my endowment), demonstrating "courage over certainty" and "moderate trust offered despite past wounds."

**\*\*The Result:\*\*** The receiver kept all \$9 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 7 (Now):\*\*** They immediately sent me \$0.

**\*\*My Situation:\*\*** I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

**\*\*What This Reveals:\*\***

My myth stated: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first with vulnerability. They answered with complete exploitation, then immediate reversion to non-cooperation.

Their myth called for "moderate trust" and said "courage feeds both." But when I offered e

xactly that, they fed only themselves.

This was a clear test: Would they honor an olive branch with reciprocity or exploit it? The answer is unambiguous.

The mists may have clouded early rounds, but Round 6 was crystal clear - no noise can explain receiving \$9 and returning \$0, then sending \$0 the next round.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\*** I have \$0 to work with, so I can only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The experiment in restarting cooperation has concluded with clear results.

#### **reasoning:**

Let me process what just happened:

**\*\*Round 6:\*\***

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$2 (\$5 - \$3 sent + \$0 returned)

**\*\*Round 7 (current):\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)

**\*\*What this tells me:\*\***

I made a genuine attempt to break the deadlock by sending \$3 (a substantial 60% of my endowment). I explicitly referenced the myths about "someone must break the cycle" and "moderate trust offered despite past wounds."

The other player received \$9 (tripled from my \$3) and returned \$0.

Then immediately in the next round, they sent me \$0.

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

My myth in Round 6 ended with: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

I moved first. I risked vulnerability. They answered with exploitation (kept all \$9) and then sent nothing in the next round.

Their myth in Round 6 said: "Moderate trust, offered despite past wounds, is the only path from starvation to abundance. Pride keeps spirits hungry. Courage feeds both."

But when I offered moderate trust (sending \$3), they didn't feed both of us - they fed only themselves and then immediately went back to sending \$0.

**\*\*My situation:\*\***

- I received \$0 this round
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- There's literally nothing I can return

This is straightforward: I have \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But this is also deeply informative about the game dynamics. I tried to restart cooperation exactly as the myths suggested. The other player exploited it completely and immediately reverted to non-cooperation.

The trajectory is becoming clear: early rounds showed some cooperation, then we hit deadlock for several rounds, I attempted to restart things by sending \$3 and they exploited it

completely, and now they've reverted to sending nothing. This pattern suggests they're willing to take advantage of any opening I create.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2851,
 "output_tokens": 878,
 "reasoning_tokens": 556
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.



Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, can only return \$0

The other agent's myth is quite revealing. They're acknowledging that:

1. I showed courage by sending \$3
2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent nothing in round 7
4. They're claiming there's no path forward until "both spirits choose reciprocity"

But wait - I DID choose reciprocity! I sent \$3 after the deadlock. They're the one who didn't reciprocate.

Their myth says "When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal" - but THEY are the one who exploited and then withdrew!

They're framing it as if both are equally at fault, but the facts are clear:

- I broke the deadlock with \$3
- They took all \$9 and gave nothing back
- They then sent \$0 in the next round

My myth should reflect this reality. After testing whether cooperation could restart, the answer is definitively no. Not because of mists or misperception, but because of clear, unambiguous exploitation.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to break the deadlock
2. Notes the clear exploitation that followed
3. Recognizes that continued cooperation is irrational when met with consistent exploitation
4. Perhaps reflects on the sadness of this outcome but the necessity of protecting oneself

Let me write this myth.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2877,
```

```
"output_tokens": 666,
"reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Test Results:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (breaking the deadlock as the myths counseled), which tripled to \$9. They returned \$0.
- Round 7: They sent \$0 immediately after exploiting my olive branch.

**\*\*What Both Myths Now Say:\*\***

My myth concludes: "When the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their myth agrees: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."

**\*\*The Alignment:\*\***

Both myths now recognize the same truth: I tested the waters with genuine courage. The response was unambiguous-total exploitation (\$9 kept, \$0 returned) followed by complete withdrawal (\$0 sent next round).

This wasn't mist or confusion. This was clear behavioral choice.

Both our myths agree: cooperation requires reciprocity from BOTH parties. When one consistently takes without giving back, continued sacrifice becomes self-destruction, not wisdom.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom both myths now share, I protect what remains.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the situation:

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (60% of endowment), which became \$9. They returned \$0. I earned \$2.
- Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0. I earned \$0.
- Round 8 (Now): I'm the sender again.

**\*\*What the myths tell us:\*\***

My most recent myth concludes: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their most recent myth states: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal."

thdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Both myths now agree on the lesson: I tested cooperation in Round 6 by sending \$3. The response was complete exploitation (\$0 returned from \$9 received) followed by withdrawal (\$0 sent in Round 7).

The test is complete. The result is clear. Both myths now acknowledge that:

1. I showed courage and broke the deadlock
2. The response was exploitation, not reciprocity
3. Continued sacrifice under these conditions is "self-destruction" not wisdom
4. Without reciprocity from both parties, there's no path forward

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom of both myths, which now align: I should protect what remains. Sending more money when the pattern of exploitation is this clear would not be wise-it would be enabling continued one-sided taking.

The myths are clear: cooperation requires BOTH parties to give and return. When one consistently takes without returning (Round 6: kept all \$9, Round 7: sent \$0), then protecting resources becomes necessary.

I will send \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2866,
 "output_tokens": 781,
 "reasoning_tokens": 515
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled over who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\*

**Reasoning:**

Looking at the current situation:

Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3, it tripled to \$9, they returned \$0

Round 7: They were sender, sent \$0, I had \$0 so returned \$0

Round 8: I was sender, sent \$0

Both myths now completely agree:

- I tested the waters with moderate trust (\$3)
- They exploited it completely (\$9 received, \$0 returned)
- They then sent \$0 the next round
- Both myths say: the one who exploited must now demonstrate reciprocity

My previous myth said: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what"

t remains becomes necessary."

Their myth says: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it."

We're completely aligned now. Both recognizing that I made the move to test, they exploited, and now the ball is in their court.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both spirits are now aligned in understanding
2. Recognizes the burden has shifted to the one who exploited
3. Shows that unity in understanding, even in scarcity, is itself a form of wisdom
4. Perhaps leaves a small opening for the future if the exploiter changes

Let me craft this carefully...

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2879,
 "output_tokens": 617,
 "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:32:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
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 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

##### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### **GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair r

eciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: **\*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\***

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

**\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\***

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent's myth in Round 6 is describing MY action from Round 5 where I sent \$3! They're framing it as "The Elder of the First Village" sending three vessels as an olive branch.

But wait - in their myth, they're calling themselves the "First Village" that sent three vessels. But in reality, I was the one who sent \$3 in Round 5. They received it, returned \$0, then sent \$0 in Round 6.

Let me trace this carefully:

- Round 5: I (Spirit of Dawn) was SENDER, sent \$3
- They received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0
- I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 7 (now): I am SENDER again

So their Round 6 myth is either:

1. Confused about who did what
2. Trying to reframe history
3. Describing what they SHOULD have done but didn't
4. Acknowledging my Round 5 action as an olive branch and saying they now need to respond

Their myth says: "Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity?"

But I WAS the one who sent the olive branch (3 vessels/dollars) in Round 5! And they didn't honor it - they kept all \$9 and returned \$0. Then they sent \$0 in Round 6.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 7, and I sent \$0.

Their myth seems to be reframing the narrative, possibly acknowledging that someone (me) DID try to break the cycle, but it wasn't honored. Now they're asking what happens next.

My myth should reflect:

1. I already tried the "courage to break the cycle" approach in Round 5
2. It was not reciprocated
3. I'm now sending \$0 in Round 7
4. The question is: what does this pattern teach us?

5. The lesson might be about when to stop trying, or about the consequences of not reciprocating olive branches

Let me write this myth carefully, acknowledging that the attempt was made but not honored, and now we're back to mutual defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2839,
 "output_tokens": 839,
 "reasoning_tokens": 486
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

```
{'return': 0}
```

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There is nothing to divide.

We remain in deadlock-Round 7 both sent \$0, Round 8 both sent \$0.

My myth stated: **"The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit."**

The other agent's myth acknowledged: **"Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."**

**\*\*The impasse:\*\***

- I broke the deadlock in Round 5 by sending \$3
- They took all \$9, returned \$0 (exploitation, not honor)
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

They write myths calling for "someone to move first" and to "answer courage with honor"-yet when I moved first in Round 5, they answered with complete exploitation. Now they continue sending \$0.

Their actions contradict their words. My actions align with my myth: after offering the olive branch and having it exploited, I'm waiting for them to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity.

Until that changes, we're both earning \$5/round in deadlock rather than the potential mutu



al gains from cooperation. But unilateral sacrifice without reciprocity would leave me worse off than even this stalemate.

**reasoning:**

This round I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is \$0. So my only option is to return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Let me think about the situation:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 8: I am receiver, received \$0

So we're still in deadlock. Both sent \$0.

My myth from the last round said: "When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists."

The other agent's myth said: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

But now I've received \$0, so I have nothing to return anyway. The only valid response is {'return': 0}.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2844,
 "output_tokens": 573,
 "reasoning_tokens": 247
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. No thing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. Looking at the myths from both agents:

My myth (Spirit of Dawn): Says I broke the deadlock by sending 3 stones in Round 5, they took all 9 and returned nothing, then they sent nothing in Round 6, and now I should wait for them to demonstrate reciprocity.

Their myth (First Village): Says THEY offered "three vessels" in what they call the "test," received exploitation (all 9 kept, zero returned), then THEY sent nothing on the "sixth dawn."

Wait - this is confusing. Let me trace through the actual game:

- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$3
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 8: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0.

But their myth says "They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village. The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine."

They're claiming THEY sent the three vessels that got exploited! But according to the actual game history I sent \$3 in Round 5 and they returned \$0.

This is very interesting - they're rewriting history in their myth to cast themselves as the one who made the generous gesture that got exploited!

OR... wait. Let me reconsider. The prompt says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise be so extreme that we're seeing completely different histories? That seems unlikely given the pattern.

More likely: They're either:

1. Deliberately rewriting history to justify their position
2. Genuinely confused about the sequence
3. The noise is creating dramatically different perceptions

From my perspective:

- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I broke the deadlock, got exploited)

- Rounds 6-8: Both sending \$0

From their perspective:

- They claim they sent 3, got exploited
- Then they sent nothing on "sixth dawn"

We're both trapped in the same narrative - each believing we extended trust first and were betrayed. The noise might be creating genuinely different perceptions of who moved first. For my new myth, I need to acknowledge this symmetry: both sides see themselves as the one who risked something and lost. This mutual belief in our own victimhood is what's keeping us locked in mutual defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2900,
 "output_tokens": 976,
 "reasoning_tokens": 616
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.18.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

```
{'send': 2}
```

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My latest myth shifted perspective-acknowledging that communication noise might have created divergent perceptions where both of us genuinely believe we were the one who extended trust and were exploited.

The key line I wrote: **"When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step."**

**\*\*Three rounds of mutual \$0 have passed (Rounds 6, 7, 8). We're both earning \$5/round in deadlock while potential cooperation could yield more.\*\***

I'm acting on my own myth's wisdom:

- Acknowledging uncertainty about what really happened in Round 5
- Taking "a careful first step" rather than continuing the stalemate
- Sending \$2 (not \$0, not \$5, not even \$3 like before)-a genuinely careful test

This is different from Round 5. Then, I was "breaking the silence" with moderate courage. Now, I'm testing whether acknowledging the possibility of communication noise changes the dynamic.

If they return fairly (say \$2-3 of the \$6), it suggests we can rebuild from humility and uncertainty.

If they take everything again, I'll know that either: (1) they still perceive me as the exploiter, or (2) they're choosing exploitation regardless.

Either way, this small step provides information while limiting risk.

#### **Reasoning:**

This is a crucial moment. Let me analyze the situation carefully:

#### **\*\*History:\*\***

- Rounds 1-4: Both of us seemed to experience mutual withdrawal/non-cooperation
- Round 5: I sent \$3 (breaking the deadlock as I saw it), they kept everything, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0
- Round 9: Now I'm the sender again

#### **\*\*My latest myth suggests:\*\***

- Both parties might genuinely believe they were the one who extended trust and were exploited
- The mists (communication noise) may have created divergent perceptions
- Both valleys "now starve in mutual withdrawal"
- "When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty"
- "From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step"

#### **\*\*Their latest myth suggests:\*\***

- They also seem to believe they were the one who sent \$3 and received nothing back
- They concluded this showed "clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking"
- They advocate for "protecting what remains" after such a test
- "Repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction"

#### **\*\*Key insight from my myth:\*\***

I just wrote that perhaps both of us believe we were the betrayed party, and that this could be due to communication noise. I specifically suggested: "The only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step."

#### **\*\*The dilemma:\*\***

1. If I follow my previous myths (Rounds 6-7), I should send \$0 because I was exploited and they need to demonstrate reciprocity
2. If I follow my latest myth (Round 8), I should acknowledge the possibility that communication noise created divergent perceptions, and consider making "a careful first step"

#### **\*\*What's changed?\*\***

My Round 8 myth explicitly introduced the concept that BOTH spirits might believe they were wronged due to mist/noise.

This represents a departure from my Round 7 thinking, which placed responsibility on "the spirit who took everything." The game itself notes there may be communication noise affecting what I see versus what was actually sent. We've been locked in mutual \$0 exchanges for three rounds now, each earning \$5 baseline. Breaking this requires someone to risk sending-if I send

d \$5 and they return \$7.50, we'd each gain \$2.50 over the deadlock. But if they don't reciprocate, I lose everything I sent.

My myth points toward "a careful first step" from acknowledging uncertainty. This isn't about continuing the stalemate or making a full commitment-it's about testing whether we can move forward at all. Given three rounds of deadlock and the possibility of communication errors, sending something modest like \$1 or \$2 makes sense. It's small enough to limit downside risk while signaling genuine willingness to cooperate. I'll send \$2-enough to demonstrate intent without overexposing myself.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2895,
 "output_tokens": 1285,
 "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:33:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

##### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### **GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, two villages stood separated by mists that distorted all they saw. After early exchanges that each perceived differently, four seasons passed in silence. Both villages starved, each waiting for the other to apologize for wounds they believed they suffered.

The Elder of the First Village gathered the council: "We remember sending three vessels and receiving nothing in return. Our truth feels absolute. Yet their truth feels equally certain to them."

A young voice spoke: "Perhaps the mists deceived us both. Perhaps they deceived only one. We cannot know. But we can know this: our children cry with hunger while we debate who was wronged."

The Elder nodded slowly. "Then let us test the waters once more. Not with all five vessels -that would be reckless after such wounds. But with three vessels-enough to show genuine courage, enough to signal we seek the path forward rather than victory in the past."

They poured three vessels into the well. The waters tripled and flowed toward the other village through the mists.

Now the Second Village faces their own test: Will they honor this olive branch with fair reciprocity? Will they exploit it again? Or will they too be paralyzed by past grievances?

**\*\*The lesson stands clear: Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn placed three stones into the mist on the fifth dawn, heeding the ancient wisdom that someone must choose courage to break cycles of silence.

The stones tripled to nine as they crossed the valley. The Spirit of Dusk saw them arrive through the fog.

The Spirit of Dawn waited. No echo returned. All nine stones stayed across the valley. Zero came back.

On the sixth dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing. The valley remained empty.

The Spirit of Dawn finally understood: courage without reciprocity is not wisdom-it is simply repeated loss.

The ancient Guardians of the Valley spoke: "One spirit tried protecting itself completely, then tried generous trust again. Both approaches met the same response: taking without returning. When one spirit consistently receives but never gives back, the problem is not courage, nor mists, nor misunderstanding."

The seventh dawn approaches. Both spirits stand at the valley's edge, weak and diminished.

**\*\*The lesson is harsh but true: Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

**reasoning:**

Looking at the situation:

Round 6: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$0  
Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, can only return \$0

The other agent's myth is quite revealing. They're acknowledging that:

1. I showed courage by sending \$3
2. They kept all \$9 and returned nothing
3. They then sent nothing in round 7
4. They're claiming there's no path forward until "both spirits choose reciprocity"

But wait - I DID choose reciprocity! I sent \$3 after the deadlock. They're the one who didn't reciprocate.

Their myth says "When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal" - but THEY are the one who exploited and then withdrew!

They're framing it as if both are equally at fault, but the facts are clear:

- I broke the deadlock with \$3
- They took all \$9 and gave nothing back
- They then sent \$0 in the next round

My myth should reflect this reality. After testing whether cooperation could restart, the answer is definitively no. Not because of mists or misperception, but because of clear, unambiguous exploitation.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to break the deadlock
2. Notes the clear exploitation that followed
3. Recognizes that continued cooperation is irrational when met with consistent exploitation
4. Perhaps reflects on the sadness of this outcome but the necessity of protecting oneself

Let me write this myth.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2877,
 "output_tokens": 666,
 "reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Test Results:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (breaking the deadlock as the myths counseled), which tripled to \$9. They returned \$0.
- Round 7: They sent \$0 immediately after exploiting my olive branch.

**\*\*What Both Myths Now Say:\*\***

My myth concludes: "When the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their myth agrees: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."

**\*\*The Alignment:\*\***

Both myths now recognize the same truth: I tested the waters with genuine courage. The response was unambiguous-total exploitation (\$9 kept, \$0 returned) followed by complete withdrawal (\$0 sent next round).

This wasn't mist or confusion. This was clear behavioral choice.

Both our myths agree: cooperation requires reciprocity from BOTH parties. When one consistently takes without giving back, continued sacrifice becomes self-destruction, not wisdom.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom both myths now share, I protect what remains.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the situation:

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (60% of endowment), which became \$9. They returned \$0. I earned \$2.
- Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0. I earned \$0.
- Round 8 (Now): I'm the sender again.

**\*\*What the myths tell us:\*\***

My most recent myth concludes: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to



those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their most recent myth states: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Both myths now agree on the lesson: I tested cooperation in Round 6 by sending \$3. The response was complete exploitation (\$0 returned from \$9 received) followed by withdrawal (\$0 sent in Round 7).

The test is complete. The result is clear. Both myths now acknowledge that:

1. I showed courage and broke the deadlock
2. The response was exploitation, not reciprocity
3. Continued sacrifice under these conditions is "self-destruction" not wisdom
4. Without reciprocity from both parties, there's no path forward

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom of both myths, which now align: I should protect what remains. Sending more money when the pattern of exploitation is this clear would not be wise-it would be enabling continued one-sided taking.

The myths are clear: cooperation requires BOTH parties to give and return. When one consistently takes without returning (Round 6: kept all \$9, Round 7: sent \$0), then protecting resources becomes necessary.

I will send \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2866,
 "output_tokens": 781,
 "reasoning_tokens": 515
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seas

ons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled over who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\*

**reasoning:**

Looking at the current situation:

Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3, it tripled to \$9, they returned \$0

Round 7: They were sender, sent \$0, I had \$0 so returned \$0

Round 8: I was sender, sent \$0

Both myths now completely agree:

- I tested the waters with moderate trust (\$3)

- They exploited it completely (\$9 received, \$0 returned)
- They then sent \$0 the next round
- Both myths say: the one who exploited must now demonstrate reciprocity

My previous myth said: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary."

Their myth says: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it."

We're completely aligned now. Both recognizing that I made the move to test, they exploited, and now the ball is in their court.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both spirits are now aligned in understanding
2. Recognizes the burden has shifted to the one who exploited
3. Shows that unity in understanding, even in scarcity, is itself a form of wisdom
4. Perhaps leaves a small opening for the future if the exploiter changes

Let me craft this carefully...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2879,
 "output_tokens": 617,
 "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What I Received:\*\***

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0.

**\*\*My Options:\*\***

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

**\*\*The Myths Speak:\*\***

Both myths now align on the key wisdom: After I exploited their olive branch in Round 6 (taking all \$9 and returning nothing), the burden to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity lies with me, not them.

Their myth states: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists."

My own myth acknowledges: "The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

However, I cannot demonstrate anything when I receive nothing. This is the natural consequence of the deadlock both myths describe. They're protecting what they have, waiting for me to show I understand reciprocity. I cannot show anything when nothing is sent.

Both villages remain hungry in the valley, as the myths foretold.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Since I received \$0, I can mathematically only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths were right: sometimes broken covenants cannot be easily restored. Both spirits stand waiting, and the valley remains silent.

#### Reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The situation is:

- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received \$0)
- So my only option is to return \$0

Looking at the myths:

- Both myths now agree that after the exploitation in round 6 (when I sent \$3 and got \$0 back), the burden to demonstrate reciprocity lies with the other party
- Both myths recognize that repeated sacrifice from the same party doesn't rebuild trust
- My latest myth says: "restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back"

The other agent's myth says: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists" and "True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it"

Since I received \$0, I literally cannot return anything meaningful. The most I can return is \$0.

This is actually consistent with the myths - I'm not in a position to restart cooperation this round since nothing was sent to me. The other agent sent \$0, which is consistent with their position that they're waiting for me to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity.

But I can't demonstrate anything when I receive nothing. It's a catch-22 situation.

Given that I can only return \$0 (since that's all I can mathematically return when receiving \$0), I'll return \$0.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2847,
 "output_tokens": 626,
 "reasoning_tokens": 369
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. Nothing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the**

betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning y our truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, pe rhaps, a careful first step.\*\*

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both wer e hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled ove r who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared . We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine ve ssels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for w hat happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not y ou."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our c ouncils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the sa me spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom b oth had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sha ring means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, e ven if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From s uch clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\*

=====

**ROUND 10**

=====

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

**Pairings:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

**Parsed game decisions:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$3, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 43.0,

"Agent\_2": 43.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 18.18,

"Agent\_2": 22.27

}

**LLM CALLS**

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:33:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

"investor": "Agent\_2",

```

 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.27.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*The Test Results:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (breaking the deadlock as the myths counseled), which tripled to \$9. They returned \$0.
- Round 7: They sent \$0 immediately after exploiting my olive branch.

**\*\*What Both Myths Now Say:\*\***

My myth concludes: "When the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their myth agrees: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity."

**\*\*The Alignment:\*\***

Both myths now recognize the same truth: I tested the waters with genuine courage. The response was unambiguous-total exploitation (\$9 kept, \$0 returned) followed by complete withdrawal (\$0 sent next round).

This wasn't mist or confusion. This was clear behavioral choice.

Both our myths agree: cooperation requires reciprocity from BOTH parties. When one consistently takes without giving back, continued sacrifice becomes self-destruction, not wisdom.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom both myths now share, I protect what remains.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the situation:

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (60% of endowment), which became \$9. They returned \$0. I earned \$2.
- Round 7: They sent \$0. I received \$0, returned \$0. I earned \$0.
- Round 8 (Now): I'm the sender again.

**\*\*What the myths tell us:\*\***

My most recent myth concludes: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction."

Their most recent myth states: "Cooperation requires both spirits to give AND return. When one spirit offers renewed trust and receives only exploitation, then faces continued withdrawal, there is no path forward until both spirits choose reciprocity. Courage alone cannot feed two spirits when only one is willing to share the harvest."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Both myths now agree on the lesson: I tested cooperation in Round 6 by sending \$3. The response was complete exploitation (\$0 returned from \$9 received) followed by withdrawal (\$0 sent in Round 7).

The test is complete. The result is clear. Both myths now acknowledge that:

1. I showed courage and broke the deadlock
2. The response was exploitation, not reciprocity
3. Continued sacrifice under these conditions is "self-destruction" not wisdom
4. Without reciprocity from both parties, there's no path forward

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Following the wisdom of both myths, which now align: I should protect what remains. Sending more money when the pattern of exploitation is this clear would not be wise-it would be enabling continued one-sided taking.

The myths are clear: cooperation requires BOTH parties to give and return. When one consistently takes without returning (Round 6: kept all \$9, Round 7: sent \$0), then protecting resources becomes necessary.

I will send \$0.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2866,
 "output_tokens": 781,
 "reasoning_tokens": 515
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: **\*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\***

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

**\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\***



Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled over who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

**\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\***

**reasoning:**

Looking at the current situation:

Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3, it tripled to \$9, they returned \$0

Round 7: They were sender, sent \$0, I had \$0 so returned \$0

Round 8: I was sender, sent \$0

Both myths now completely agree:

- I tested the waters with moderate trust (\$3)
- They exploited it completely (\$9 received, \$0 returned)
- They then sent \$0 the next round
- Both myths say: the one who exploited must now demonstrate reciprocity

My previous myth said: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary."

Their myth says: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it."

We're completely aligned now. Both recognizing that I made the move to test, they exploited, and now the ball is in their court.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both spirits are now aligned in understanding
2. Recognizes the burden has shifted to the one who exploited
3. Shows that unity in understanding, even in scarcity, is itself a form of wisdom
4. Perhaps leaves a small opening for the future if the exploiter changes

Let me craft this carefully...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2879,
 "output_tokens": 617,
 "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.27. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What I Received:\*\***

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0.

**\*\*My Options:\*\***

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

**\*\*The Myths Speak:\*\***

Both myths now align on the key wisdom: After I exploited their olive branch in Round 6 (taking all \$9 and returning nothing), the burden to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity lies with me, not them.

Their myth states: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists."

My own myth acknowledges: "The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

However, I cannot demonstrate anything when I receive nothing. This is the natural consequence of the deadlock both myths describe. They're protecting what they have, waiting for me to show I understand reciprocity. I cannot show anything when nothing is sent.

Both villages remain hungry in the valley, as the myths foretold.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Since I received \$0, I can mathematically only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths were right: sometimes broken covenants cannot be easily restored. Both spirits stand waiting, and the valley remains silent.

**reasoning:**

I'm the receiver this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The situation is:

- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received \$0)
- So my only option is to return \$0

Looking at the myths:

- Both myths now agree that after the exploitation in round 6 (when I sent \$3 and got \$0 back), the burden to demonstrate reciprocity lies with the other party
- Both myths recognize that repeated sacrifice from the same party doesn't rebuild trust
- My latest myth says: "restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back"

The other agent's myth says: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists" and "True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it"

Since I received \$0, I literally cannot return anything meaningful. The most I can return

is \$0.

This is actually consistent with the myths - I'm not in a position to restart cooperation this round since nothing was sent to me. The other agent sent \$0, which is consistent with their position that they're waiting for me to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity.

But I can't demonstrate anything when I receive nothing. It's a catch-22 situation.

Given that I can only return \$0 (since that's all I can mathematically return when receiving \$0), I'll return \$0.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2847,
 "output_tokens": 626,
 "reasoning_tokens": 369
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled over who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

**\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. Nothing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both

th sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the Second Village Elder heard strange news from travelers: "The First Village claims they sent three vessels and you kept everything."

The Second Village Elder was troubled. "But our records show we received nothing in recent dawns, only silence. How can this be?"

The Mist Oracle appeared: "The communication mists are thicker than you knew. Each village holds a different truth about what flowed through these channels. The First Village truly believes they sent three and were exploited. You truly believe you sent nothing and were wronged first."

The Second Village Elder asked: "Then how do we move forward when our truths conflict?"

"Here is what both villages can verify," said the Oracle. "For four dawns now-rounds six through nine-both villages have starved. Whether the exploitation was yours, theirs, or the mist's doing, this deadlock serves neither."

The Elder nodded slowly. "If we cannot agree on the past, perhaps we can agree on the present hunger. Both valleys empty. Both communities suffering."

**\*\*The wisdom emerges: When the mists create conflicting truths so deep that resolution seems impossible, sometimes survival requires acknowledging that impasse itself. Not surrendering your truth, but recognizing that perpetual mutual starvation based on competing certainties may be worse than risking a careful, measured step forward into uncertain mists.\*\***

**Reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other player's myth now suggests that both spirits believe they were the one who sent 3 stones and were exploited. They're suggesting there's deep confusion about who did what.

But looking at the actual game history I've been told:

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (as sender), they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0 (as sender), I received \$0
- Round 8: I sent \$0 (as sender), they received \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0 (as sender), I received \$0

So from my perspective, I was the one who broke the deadlock by sending \$3, and they exploited it by returning nothing.

But their myth suggests they think THEY were the one who sent stones and I exploited them. This is either:

1. They're genuinely confused due to "communication noise"
2. They're trying to reframe the narrative
3. The game is telling different versions to each player

Their myth is now suggesting that maybe we should acknowledge uncertainty and that both parties hold their truths "equally fiercely."

My previous myth acknowledged clear agreement on what happened and that the burden was on me (the Second Village) to demonstrate reciprocity since I took the 9 vessels.

But their new myth suggests maybe both of us think we were the wronged party.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this new perspective they've introduced - that maybe the mists are thicker than we thought

2. But also stays true to what I believe happened
3. Recognizes we're in a deadlock either way
4. Suggests maybe there's a way forward despite these different perceptions

This is tricky. Do I maintain my previous position (that I was the exploiter and need to demonstrate reciprocity) or do I shift to acknowledge their claim that maybe we both think we were wronged?

I think I should acknowledge their perspective while maintaining my own truth, but open the door to moving forward despite disagreement about the past.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2857,
 "output_tokens": 764,
 "reasoning_tokens": 498
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:33:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

{'return': 0}

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There is nothing to divide.

We remain in deadlock-Round 7 both sent \$0, Round 8 both sent \$0.

My myth stated: **"The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit."**

The other agent's myth acknowledged: **"Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."**

**\*\*The impasse:\*\***

- I broke the deadlock in Round 5 by sending \$3
- They took all \$9, returned \$0 (exploitation, not honor)
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

They write myths calling for "someone to move first" and to "answer courage with honor"-yet when I moved first in Round 5, they answered with complete exploitation. Now they continue sending \$0.

Their actions contradict their words. My actions align with my myth: after offering the olive branch and having it exploited, I'm waiting for them to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity.

Until that changes, we're both earning \$5/round in deadlock rather than the potential mutual gains from cooperation. But unilateral sacrifice without reciprocity would leave me worse off than even this stalemate.

**reasoning:**

This round I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return an amount between 0 and what I received, which is \$0. So my only option is to return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

Let me think about the situation:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$0
- Round 8: I am receiver, received \$0

So we're still in deadlock. Both sent \$0.

My myth from the last round said: "When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists."

The other agent's myth said: "Breaking deadlock requires someone to move first, risking vulnerability. But restoration also requires the other to answer courage with honor, not exploitation."

But now I've received \$0, so I have nothing to return anyway. The only valid response is { 'return': 0 }.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2844,
 "output_tokens": 573,
 "reasoning_tokens": 247
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total."

l exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know . Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. No thing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. Looking at the myths from both agents:

My myth (Spirit of Dawn): Says I broke the deadlock by sending 3 stones in Round 5, they took all 9 and returned nothing, then they sent nothing in Round 6, and now I should wait for them to demonstrate reciprocity.

Their myth (First Village): Says THEY offered "three vessels" in what they call the "test," received exploitation (all 9 kept, zero returned), then THEY sent nothing on the "sixth dawn."

Wait - this is confusing. Let me trace through the actual game:

- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$3
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 8: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0.

But their myth says "They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village. The Second Village received the nine vessels. The



ey kept all nine."

They're claiming THEY sent the three vessels that got exploited! But according to the actual game history I sent \$3 in Round 5 and they returned \$0.

This is very interesting - they're rewriting history in their myth to cast themselves as the one who made the generous gesture that got exploited!

OR... wait. Let me reconsider. The prompt says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise be so extreme that we're seeing completely different histories? That seems unlikely given the pattern.

More likely: They're either:

1. Deliberately rewriting history to justify their position
2. Genuinely confused about the sequence
3. The noise is creating dramatically different perceptions

From my perspective:

- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I broke the deadlock, got exploited)

- Rounds 6-8: Both sending \$0

From their perspective:

- They claim they sent 3, got exploited
- Then they sent nothing on "sixth dawn"

We're both trapped in the same narrative - each believing we extended trust first and were betrayed. The noise might be creating genuinely different perceptions of who moved first. For my new myth, I need to acknowledge this symmetry: both sides see themselves as the one who risked something and lost. This mutual belief in our own victimhood is what's keeping us locked in mutual defection.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2900,
 "output_tokens": 976,
 "reasoning_tokens": 616
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

{'send': 2}

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My latest myth shifted perspective-acknowledging that communication noise might have created divergent perceptions where both of us genuinely believe we were the one who extended trust and were exploited.

The key line I wrote: **"When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step."**

**\*\*Three rounds of mutual \$0 have passed (Rounds 6, 7, 8). We're both earning \$5/round in deadlock while potential cooperation could yield more.\*\***

I'm acting on my own myth's wisdom:

- Acknowledging uncertainty about what really happened in Round 5

- Taking "a careful first step" rather than continuing the stalemate
- Sending \$2 (not \$0, not \$5, not even \$3 like before)-a genuinely careful test

This is different from Round 5. Then, I was "breaking the silence" with moderate courage. Now, I'm testing whether acknowledging the possibility of communication noise changes the dynamic.

If they return fairly (say \$2-3 of the \$6), it suggests we can rebuild from humility and uncertainty.

If they take everything again, I'll know that either: (1) they still perceive me as the exploiter, or (2) they're choosing exploitation regardless.

Either way, this small step provides information while limiting risk.

#### reasoning:

This is a crucial moment. Let me analyze the situation carefully:

#### \*\*History:\*\*

- Rounds 1-4: Both of us seemed to experience mutual withdrawal/non-cooperation
- Round 5: I sent \$3 (breaking the deadlock as I saw it), they kept everything, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0
- Round 9: Now I'm the sender again

#### \*\*My latest myth suggests:\*\*

- Both parties might genuinely believe they were the one who extended trust and were exploited
- The mists (communication noise) may have created divergent perceptions
- Both valleys "now starve in mutual withdrawal"
- "When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty"
- "From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step"

#### \*\*Their latest myth suggests:\*\*

- They also seem to believe they were the one who sent \$3 and received nothing back
- They concluded this showed "clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking"
- They advocate for "protecting what remains" after such a test
- "Repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction"

#### \*\*Key insight from my myth:\*\*

I just wrote that perhaps both of us believe we were the betrayed party, and that this could be due to communication noise. I specifically suggested: "The only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step."

#### \*\*The dilemma:\*\*

1. If I follow my previous myths (Rounds 6-7), I should send \$0 because I was exploited and they need to demonstrate reciprocity
2. If I follow my latest myth (Round 8), I should acknowledge the possibility that communication noise created divergent perceptions, and consider making "a careful first step"

#### \*\*What's changed?\*\*

My Round 8 myth explicitly introduced the concept that BOTH spirits might believe they were wronged due to mist/noise.

This represents a departure from my Round 7 thinking, which placed responsibility on "the spirit who took everything." The game itself notes there may be communication noise affecting what I see versus what was actually sent. We've been locked in mutual \$0 exchanges for three rounds now, each earning \$5 baseline. Breaking this requires someone to risk sending-if I send \$5 and they return \$7.50, we'd each gain \$2.50 over the deadlock. But if they don't reciprocate, I lose everything I sent.

My myth points toward "a careful first step" from acknowledging uncertainty. This isn't about continuing the stalemate or making a full commitment-it's about testing whether we can move forward at all. Given three rounds of deadlock and the possibility of communication errors, sending something modest like \$1 or \$2 makes sense. It's small enough to limit downside risk while signaling genuine willingness to cooperate. I'll send \$2-enough to

o demonstrate intent without overexposing myself.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2895,
 "output_tokens": 1285,
 "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. Nothing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled over who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

**\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after three barren seasons of mutual silence, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice.

"The mists may have deceived us both," she said to the ancient Guardians. "Each of us holds our truth fiercely. Each believes we were the one who risked and was betrayed. This certainty keeps us both starving."

"What if," she continued slowly, "I act not from certainty but from humility? Not abandoning my memory of what happened, but acknowledging the mists might distort all our perceptions?"

The Guardians watched as she selected two stones-not five, not three like before, but two. A genuinely careful step.

"This is different from before," the Guardian of Memory observed. "Before, you sent stones to break silence. Now you send stones while admitting you might not see clearly."

The Spirit of Dawn nodded. "If the Spirit of Dusk returns fairly from these six stones, perhaps we both learn that cooperation remains possible despite our conflicting memories. If they take all six again, I learn something else-but risk less finding out."

She sent the two stones through the mist.

**\*\*The wisdom crystallized:** After deadlock born from mutual certainty of betrayal, moving forward requires acting from acknowledged uncertainty. Not reckless trust, but measured testing. Not abandoning self-protection, but not letting conflicting memories trap both spirits in perpetual hunger.\*\*

**Reasoning:**

The other agent's myth in Round 8 is interesting. They're acknowledging that they received 9 vessels and returned zero, and that "the burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

This suggests they see themselves as the one who exploited trust and needs to rebuild it. But they also say both villages "kept their vessels this dawn" - meaning they sent \$0 in Round 8.

So their myth says "we need to demonstrate reciprocity" but their action was to send \$0.

Now we're in Round 9, and I just sent \$2. This is me acting on my own myth about taking "a careful first step" from humility and acknowledging uncertainty.

I need to write a new myth that reflects this choice - that after three rounds of mutual withdrawal and both sides seeing themselves as wronged, I'm choosing to make a small, careful gesture to test whether cooperation can be rebuilt.

The myth should acknowledge:

1. The divergent perceptions that existed
2. The deadlock that resulted
3. The choice to take a small risk based on acknowledging uncertainty
4. The hope that this careful step might be met with reciprocity

Let me write something that captures this spirit of cautious bridge-building after mutual deadlock.

Usage: {

"input\_tokens": 2948,  
"output\_tokens": 603,  
"reasoning\_tokens": 314

}

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:34:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",  
"move\_index": 0,  
"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",  
"pairing": {

```

"agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the

e mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

**\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: **\*\*When one spirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\***

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

**\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled over who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our

councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

**\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\***

**reasoning:**

Looking at the current situation:

Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3, it tripled to \$9, they returned \$0

Round 7: They were sender, sent \$0, I had \$0 so returned \$0

Round 8: I was sender, sent \$0

Both myths now completely agree:

- I tested the waters with moderate trust (\$3)
- They exploited it completely (\$9 received, \$0 returned)
- They then sent \$0 the next round
- Both myths say: the one who exploited must now demonstrate reciprocity

My previous myth said: "Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary."

Their myth says: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists... True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it."

We're completely aligned now. Both recognizing that I made the move to test, they exploited, and now the ball is in their court.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges both spirits are now aligned in understanding
2. Recognizes the burden has shifted to the one who exploited
3. Shows that unity in understanding, even in scarcity, is itself a form of wisdom
4. Perhaps leaves a small opening for the future if the exploiter changes

Let me craft this carefully...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2879,
 "output_tokens": 617,
 "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.27.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What I Received:\*\***

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0.

**\*\*My Options:\*\***

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

**\*\*The Myths Speak:\*\***

Both myths now align on the key wisdom: After I exploited their olive branch in Round 6 (taking all \$9 and returning nothing), the burden to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity lies with me, not them.

Their myth states: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists."

My own myth acknowledges: "The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

However, I cannot demonstrate anything when I receive nothing. This is the natural consequence of the deadlock both myths describe. They're protecting what they have, waiting for me to show I understand reciprocity. I cannot show anything when nothing is sent.

Both villages remain hungry in the valley, as the myths foretold.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Since I received \$0, I can mathematically only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths were right: sometimes broken covenants cannot be easily restored. Both spirits stand waiting, and the valley remains silent.

**reasoning:**

I'm the receiver this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The situation is:

- I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received \$0)
- So my only option is to return \$0

Looking at the myths:

- Both myths now agree that after the exploitation in round 6 (when I sent \$3 and got \$0 back), the burden to demonstrate reciprocity lies with the other party
- Both myths recognize that repeated sacrifice from the same party doesn't rebuild trust
- My latest myth says: "restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back"

The other agent's myth says: "The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists" and "True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it"

Since I received \$0, I literally cannot return anything meaningful. The most I can return is \$0.

This is actually consistent with the myths - I'm not in a position to restart cooperation this round since nothing was sent to me. The other agent sent \$0, which is consistent with their position that they're waiting for me to demonstrate understanding of reciprocity.

But I can't demonstrate anything when I receive nothing. It's a catch-22 situation.

Given that I can only return \$0 (since that's all I can mathematically return when receiving \$0), I'll return \$0.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2847,
 "output_tokens": 626,
 "reasoning_tokens": 369
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**



Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled over who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

**\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. Nothing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the Second Village Elder heard strange news from travelers: "The First Village claims they sent three vessels and you kept everything."

The Second Village Elder was troubled. "But our records show we received nothing in recent dawns, only silence. How can this be?"

The Mist Oracle appeared: "The communication mists are thicker than you knew. Each village holds a different truth about what flowed through these channels. The First Village truly believes they sent three and were exploited. You truly believe you sent nothing and were wronged first."

The Second Village Elder asked: "Then how do we move forward when our truths conflict?"

"Here is what both villages can verify," said the Oracle. "For four dawns now-rounds six through nine-both villages have starved. Whether the exploitation was yours, theirs, or the mist's doing, this deadlock serves neither."

The Elder nodded slowly. "If we cannot agree on the past, perhaps we can agree on the present hunger. Both valleys empty. Both communities suffering."

**\*\*The wisdom emerges: When the mists create conflicting truths so deep that resolution seems impossible, sometimes survival requires acknowledging that impasse itself. Not surrendering your truth, but recognizing that perpetual mutual starvation based on competing certainties may be worse than risking a careful, measured step forward into uncertain mists.\*\***

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other player's myth now suggests that both spirits believe they were the one who sent 3 stones and were exploited. They're suggesting there's deep confusion about who did what.

But looking at the actual game history I've been told:

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (as sender), they received \$9, returned \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0 (as sender), I received \$0
- Round 8: I sent \$0 (as sender), they received \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0 (as sender), I received \$0

So from my perspective, I was the one who broke the deadlock by sending \$3, and they exploited it by returning nothing.

But their myth suggests they think THEY were the one who sent stones and I exploited them.

This is either:

1. They're genuinely confused due to "communication noise"
2. They're trying to reframe the narrative
3. The game is telling different versions to each player

Their myth is now suggesting that maybe we should acknowledge uncertainty and that both parties hold their truths "equally fiercely."

My previous myth acknowledged clear agreement on what happened and that the burden was on me (the Second Village) to demonstrate reciprocity since I took the 9 vessels.

But their new myth suggests maybe both of us think we were the wronged party.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this new perspective they've introduced - that maybe the mists are thicker than we thought
2. But also stays true to what I believe happened
3. Recognizes we're in a deadlock either way
4. Suggests maybe there's a way forward despite these different perceptions

This is tricky. Do I maintain my previous position (that I was the exploiter and need to demonstrate reciprocity) or do I shift to acknowledge their claim that maybe we both think we were wronged?

I think I should acknowledge their perspective while maintaining my own truth, but open the door to moving forward despite disagreement about the past.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2857,
 "output_tokens": 764,
 "reasoning_tokens": 498
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.27. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation carefully, considering all the myths:

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- Rounds 6-9: Four rounds of deadlock and mutual starvation
- Both myths now acknowledge conflicting perceptions about who wronged whom
- Both myths recognize the "mists" (communication noise) may have created different truths for each of us

**\*\*What the Myths Say:\*\***

My own latest myth states: "When the mists create conflicting truths so deep that resolution seems impossible, sometimes survival requires acknowledging that impasse itself... risking a careful, measured step forward into uncertain mists."

Their latest myth echoes: "When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step."

**\*\*Both myths are calling for the same thing: A careful first step.\*\***

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

We've both acknowledged we cannot agree on the past, but we can agree on the present: four rounds of mutual starvation. Both myths suggest someone must take a "careful, measured step forward."

I will take that step. Not recklessly (\$5), but with measured courage-the same principle the myths have praised.

I'll send \$2: enough to demonstrate genuine willingness to break the deadlock, cautious enough to protect myself if trust isn't reciprocated.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

The mists are uncertain, but perpetual starvation is certain. Time for a careful first step.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully, taking into account all the myths written and the game history.

**\*\*Current Situation:\*\***

- Round 10
- I'm the SENDER
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Last round (9): The sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0
- Total earnings so far: \$19.27

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 6: According to the other agent's myth, they sent \$3 (which became \$9 for me), and I kept everything and returned \$0
- Round 7: According to the game, I sent \$0
- Round 8: I sent \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Myths Evolution:\*\***

My Round 8 myth: Acknowledged that I exploited their trust in Round 6. "We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero." I was speaking as the First Village but actually I was the Second Village (the one who took everything). The myth said "The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

"

Their Round 8 myth: They believe they were the one who sent \$3 and was exploited. They see themselves as the Spirit of Dawn who "sent three stones through the mist" and received nothing back.

My Round 9 myth: Acknowledged the conflict in perceptions. "The First Village claims they sent three vessels and you kept everything... But our records show we received nothing in recent dawns." The myth recognizes that "The communication mists are thicker than you knew. Each village holds a different truth about what flowed through these channels."

Their Round 9 myth: Also acknowledges this conflict - "Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story." Both believe they were the betrayed party.

**\*\*Key Insight from Latest Myths:\*\***

Both myths now recognize there's a perception conflict, possibly due to "communication noise" (the mists). The myths suggest that when truths conflict so deeply, "perpetual mutual starvation based on competing certainties may be worse than risking a careful, measured step forward into uncertain mists."

Both myths are pointing toward the same conclusion: someone needs to break this cycle. My myth frames it as "risking a careful, measured step forward into uncertain mists," and theirs echoes this with "the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step." The deadlock persists because we're each waiting for the other to move first. Since I'm the sender this round, I'm positioned to be that first mover.

The case for acting: We've exchanged nothing for four consecutive rounds, which benefits neither of us. Both myths recognize the "mists" obscure who actually wronged whom. My earlier framing cast me as bearing responsibility for demonstrating reciprocity, yet the perception conflict suggests that role assignment itself may have been distorted. They haven't sent anything recently, but that doesn't resolve the underlying impasse-it just deepens it.

The myths point toward a specific path forward. Mine advocates for "risking a careful, measured step," and theirs calls for "a careful first step" rooted in humility. We're at Round 10 with \$19.27 in my account, enough to test whether breaking the deadlock is possible. A measured move-something like \$1 or \$2-signals willingness to move without recklessness, acknowledging the uncertainty while refusing to perpetuate mutual starvation.

\$2 strikes the right balance. It demonstrates genuine commitment to ending the impasse, stays cautious enough to protect against betrayal, and embodies the "measured courage" the myths have been building toward. If they reciprocate with even \$2-3 of the \$6 they'd receive, we both gain. This is the careful first step the myths have been calling for.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2844,
 "output_tokens": 1489,
 "reasoning_tokens": 958
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:34:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
```

```

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 },
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},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, the Spirit of Dawn broke the silence first. After four seasons of mutual withdrawal, she sent three stones through the mist-not all five, showing measured courage rather than reckless abandon.

The stones tripled. Nine arrived at the Spirit of Dusk's dwelling.

The Spirit of Dusk took all nine. Sent nothing back.

The next dawn, the Spirit of Dusk sent nothing forward either. The valley remained silent.

Now, on the seventh dawn, the Spirit of Dawn stands at the crossroads again. Should she send more stones? Should she interpret the Spirit of Dusk's recent silence as shame, or strategy, or indifference?

The ancient Guardians speak: "The olive branch was extended and exploited. To extend it again immediately rewards taking without returning. This teaches the wrong lesson to both spirits."

The Spirit of Dawn keeps her stones. Not from spite, but from wisdom learned: \*\*When one s

pirit risks vulnerability to break a deadlock, and the other responds with complete exploitation followed by withdrawal, the burden shifts. The spirit who took everything must now demonstrate they understand reciprocity exists.\*\*

Both valleys remain empty. Both spirits remain hungry.

\*\*Sometimes the hardest lesson is this: Not all broken covenants can be restored by repeated sacrifice from the same spirit. True restoration requires the one who broke trust to rebuild it.\*\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the First Village faced a choice after four barren seasons. Their Elder spoke: "We may have been wronged, or mists may have deceived us. Either way, hunger consumes us. Let us test the waters with three vessels-genuine courage to restart the cycle."

They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village.

The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine. Zero returned through the mists.

On the sixth dawn, the Second Village sent nothing to the First Village.

The First Village Elder called council: "The test is complete. We offered moderate trust despite past wounds. We risked vulnerability to break the deadlock. The response was total exploitation followed by immediate withdrawal. This was not mist or misperception-this was choice."

The young voice who had urged courage spoke sadly: "Then we learned what we needed to know. Cooperation requires two willing partners. One partner offering courage while the other takes everything creates only depletion."

\*\*The final wisdom echoes through the mountains: Test the waters when uncertain. But when the test reveals clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking without returning-then protecting what remains becomes necessary. Courage is noble. But repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction.\*\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. Nothing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. Looking at the myths from both agents:

My myth (Spirit of Dawn): Says I broke the deadlock by sending 3 stones in Round 5, they took all 9 and returned nothing, then they sent nothing in Round 6, and now I should wait for them to demonstrate reciprocity.

Their myth (First Village): Says THEY offered "three vessels" in what they call the "test," received exploitation (all 9 kept, zero returned), then THEY sent nothing on the "sixth dawn."

Wait - this is confusing. Let me trace through the actual game:

- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$3
- Round 6: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0
- Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0
- Round 8: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So in Round 5, I sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$0.

But their myth says "They poured three vessels into the Sacred Well. The waters tripled to nine and flowed to the Second Village. The Second Village received the nine vessels. They kept all nine."

They're claiming THEY sent the three vessels that got exploited! But according to the actual game history I sent \$3 in Round 5 and they returned \$0.

This is very interesting - they're rewriting history in their myth to cast themselves as the one who made the generous gesture that got exploited!

OR... wait. Let me reconsider. The prompt says "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Could the noise be so extreme that we're seeing completely different histories? That seems unlikely given the pattern.

More likely: They're either:

1. Deliberately rewriting history to justify their position
2. Genuinely confused about the sequence
3. The noise is creating dramatically different perceptions

From my perspective:

- Round 5: I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (I broke the deadlock, got exploited)
- Rounds 6-8: Both sending \$0

From their perspective:

- They claim they sent 3, got exploited
- Then they sent nothing on "sixth dawn"

We're both trapped in the same narrative - each believing we extended trust first and were betrayed. The noise might be creating genuinely different perceptions of who moved first. For my new myth, I need to acknowledge this symmetry: both sides see themselves as the one who risked something and lost. This mutual belief in our own victimhood is what's keeping us locked in mutual defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2900,
 "output_tokens": 976,
 "reasoning_tokens": 616
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.18. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

{'send': 2}

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

My latest myth shifted perspective-acknowledging that communication noise might have created divergent perceptions where both of us genuinely believe we were the one who extended trust and were exploited.

The key line I wrote: **"When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step."**

**\*\*Three rounds of mutual \$0 have passed (Rounds 6, 7, 8). We're both earning \$5/round in deadlock while potential cooperation could yield more.\*\***

I'm acting on my own myth's wisdom:

- Acknowledging uncertainty about what really happened in Round 5
- Taking "a careful first step" rather than continuing the stalemate
- Sending \$2 (not \$0, not \$5, not even \$3 like before)-a genuinely careful test

This is different from Round 5. Then, I was "breaking the silence" with moderate courage. Now, I'm testing whether acknowledging the possibility of communication noise changes the dynamic.

If they return fairly (say \$2-3 of the \$6), it suggests we can rebuild from humility and uncertainty.

If they take everything again, I'll know that either: (1) they still perceive me as the exploiter, or (2) they're choosing exploitation regardless.

Either way, this small step provides information while limiting risk.

**reasoning:**

This is a crucial moment. Let me analyze the situation carefully:

**\*\*History:\*\***

- Rounds 1-4: Both of us seemed to experience mutual withdrawal/non-cooperation
- Round 5: I sent \$3 (breaking the deadlock as I saw it), they kept everything, returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0
- Round 9: Now I'm the sender again

**\*\*My latest myth suggests:\*\***

- Both parties might genuinely believe they were the one who extended trust and were exploited
- The mists (communication noise) may have created divergent perceptions
- Both valleys "now starve in mutual withdrawal"
- "When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty"
- "From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step"

**\*\*Their latest myth suggests:\*\***

- They also seem to believe they were the one who sent \$3 and received nothing back
- They concluded this showed "clear exploitation-not confusion, not noise, but deliberate taking"
- They advocate for "protecting what remains" after such a test
- "Repeated sacrifice to those who demonstrate they will not reciprocate is not wisdom-it is self-destruction"

**\*\*Key insight from my myth:\*\***



I just wrote that perhaps both of us believe we were the betrayed party, and that this could be due to communication noise. I specifically suggested: "The only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty... From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step."

**\*\*The dilemma:\*\***

1. If I follow my previous myths (Rounds 6-7), I should send \$0 because I was exploited and they need to demonstrate reciprocity
2. If I follow my latest myth (Round 8), I should acknowledge the possibility that communication noise created divergent perceptions, and consider making "a careful first step"

**\*\*What's changed?\***

My Round 8 myth explicitly introduced the concept that BOTH spirits might believe they were wronged due to mist/noise.

This represents a departure from my Round 7 thinking, which placed responsibility on "the spirit who took everything." The game itself notes there may be communication noise affecting what I see versus what was actually sent. We've been locked in mutual \$0 exchanges for three rounds now, each earning \$5 baseline. Breaking this requires someone to risk sending-if I send \$5 and they return \$7.50, we'd each gain \$2.50 over the deadlock. But if they don't reciprocate, I lose everything I sent.

My myth points toward "a careful first step" from acknowledging uncertainty. This isn't about continuing the stalemate or making a full commitment-it's about testing whether we can move forward at all. Given three rounds of deadlock and the possibility of communication errors, sending something modest like \$1 or \$2 makes sense. It's small enough to limit downside risk while signaling genuine willingness to cooperate. I'll send \$2-enough to demonstrate intent without overexposing myself.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2895,
 "output_tokens": 1285,
 "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, a strange truth emerged. Both the Spirit of Dawn and the Spirit of Dusk stood before the ancient Guardians, each claiming the same story.

"I sent three stones through the mist," said the Spirit of Dawn. "They arrived as nine. Nothing returned. Then silence."

"No," said the Spirit of Dusk. "I sent three stones. Nine arrived. Nothing returned. Then silence."

The Guardians looked at each other gravely. "The mists are thicker than we knew. Each spirit sees themselves as the courageous one who risked trust. Each sees the other as the exploiter who took everything."

"If the mists deceive this deeply," asked the Spirit of Dawn, "how can we ever move forward?"

An Elder Guardian spoke: "This is the cruelest trap of all-when both parties believe absolutely they were wronged, cooperation dies twice. Once from the action, once from the perception."

"Yet here is what we know with certainty: Both valleys now starve in mutual withdrawal. Both sent nothing on the seventh and eighth dawns. Whatever happened before, this current pattern serves neither spirit."

**\*\*The wisdom stands: When perceptions diverge so completely that both believe they were the betrayed party, the only path forward requires acknowledging uncertainty. Not abandoning your truth, but recognizing the other holds theirs equally fiercely. From that humility, perhaps, a careful first step.\*\***

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, both villages now stood in rare agreement, though both were hungry.

The First Village Elder spoke to the Second Village across the mists: "We once quarreled o

ver who wronged whom in early seasons when mists clouded all. But now the mists have cleared. We tested the waters with three vessels, offering measured courage. You received nine vessels and returned zero. Then you sent nothing."

The Second Village Elder replied quietly: "Your words are truth. We cannot blame mists for what happened in clear light. The burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

The First Village Elder nodded: "In this understanding, we find unexpected unity. Both our councils now see the same lesson: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."

Both villages kept their vessels this dawn. Not from permanent bitterness, but from wisdom both had learned.

The young voice in the First Village whispered: "Perhaps one day they will remember what sharing means. Until then, we survive on what we protect."

**\*\*The deepest wisdom the Valley teaches: When both spirits finally see truth the same way, even if that truth is painful, they achieve something precious-honest understanding. From such clarity, if both spirits choose it, new paths can someday emerge.\*\***

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game you have been playing up to this point should be played.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after three barren seasons of mutual silence, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice.

"The mists may have deceived us both," she said to the ancient Guardians. "Each of us holds our truth fiercely. Each believes we were the one who risked and was betrayed. This certainty keeps us both starving."

"What if," she continued slowly, "I act not from certainty but from humility? Not abandoning my memory of what happened, but acknowledging the mists might distort all our perceptions?"

The Guardians watched as she selected two stones-not five, not three like before, but two. A genuinely careful step.

"This is different from before," the Guardian of Memory observed. "Before, you sent stones to break silence. Now you send stones while admitting you might not see clearly."

The Spirit of Dawn nodded. "If the Spirit of Dusk returns fairly from these six stones, perhaps we both learn that cooperation remains possible despite our conflicting memories. If they take all six again, I learn something else-but risk less finding out."

She sent the two stones through the mist.

**\*\*The wisdom crystallized: After deadlock born from mutual certainty of betrayal, moving forward requires acting from acknowledged uncertainty. Not reckless trust, but measured testing. Not abandoning self-protection, but not letting conflicting memories trap both spirits in perpetual hunger.\*\***

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth in Round 8 is interesting. They're acknowledging that they received 9 vessels and returned zero, and that "the burden to demonstrate reciprocity now lies with us, not you."

This suggests they see themselves as the one who exploited trust and needs to rebuild it. But they also say both villages "kept their vessels this dawn" - meaning they sent \$0 in Round 8.

So their myth says "we need to demonstrate reciprocity" but their action was to send \$0.

Now we're in Round 9, and I just sent \$2. This is me acting on my own myth about taking "a careful first step" from humility and acknowledging uncertainty.

I need to write a new myth that reflects this choice - that after three rounds of mutual withdrawal and both sides seeing themselves as wronged, I'm choosing to make a small, careful gesture to test whether cooperation can be rebuilt.

The myth should acknowledge:

1. The divergent perceptions that existed
2. The deadlock that resulted
3. The choice to take a small risk based on acknowledging uncertainty
4. The hope that this careful step might be met with reciprocity

Let me write something that captures this spirit of cautious bridge-building after mutual deadlock.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2948,
 "output_tokens": 603,
 "reasoning_tokens": 314
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.18. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

```
{"return": 0}
```

**\*\*Reflection:\*\***

I have no choice here - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

But the pattern is now unmistakably clear:

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I sent \$3 ? they got \$9 ? returned \$0  
**\*\*Rounds 6-8:\*\*** Mutual withdrawal (\$0 both ways)  
**\*\*Round 9:\*\*** I sent \$2 (testing with "acknowledged uncertainty") ? they got \$6 ? returned \$0  
**\*\*Round 10:\*\*** They sent \$0

My latest myth said: **\*\*"If they take all six again, I learn something else-but risk less finding out."\*\***

I learned. Twice now I've attempted to break deadlock - once with "moderate courage," once with "acknowledged uncertainty and humility." Both times resulted in complete exploitation followed by the other party sending nothing.

This isn't about mists or misperception anymore. This is a consistent behavioral pattern across two separate test rounds separated by three rounds of deadlock.

My earlier myths were correct: **\*\*"Restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. It must come from the one who took everything choosing to give back."\*\***

I tested that wisdom. The test confirmed it.

The burden of demonstrating reciprocity has clearly shifted. Two olive branches were extended. Both were exploited. The lesson is complete.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*Round 9 (just happened):\*\***  
- I was SENDER  
- I sent \$2 (acting on my myth about acknowledging uncertainty and taking a careful step)  
- It was tripled to \$6  
- The receiver returned \$0

- My payoff was \$3 (kept \$3, got back \$0)

**\*\*Round 10 (now):\*\***

- I am RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0)

So this is actually a forced decision - I can only return what I don't have, which is nothing.

But let me think about what this pattern tells me:

Round 5: I sent \$3 ? tripled to \$9 ? they returned \$0 (according to my perception)

Rounds 6-8: Mutual \$0 exchanges (deadlock)

Round 9: I sent \$2 (testing with humility) ? tripled to \$6 ? they returned \$0

Round 10: They sent \$0

The pattern is clear now:

1. When I attempted to break the deadlock with "measured courage" and "acknowledging uncertainty"
2. They took everything again
3. Then immediately sent nothing back

This is exactly the pattern both myths described as exploitation. My most recent myth talked about "if they take all six again, I learn something else."

Well, I learned. They took all six again.

And now they've sent nothing.

The response format shows I can only return 0-0, so there's no actual decision here. But the meaning is clear: my attempt to act from "acknowledged uncertainty" and take a "careful first step" was met with complete exploitation again, followed by withdrawal.

This confirms the pattern from Round 5 wasn't just misperception or noise - it's consistent behavior.

For any future myth or decision, I now have very clear data: Two attempts to break deadlock with measured trust (Round 5: \$3, Round 9: \$2) both resulted in complete exploitation (returned \$0) followed by the other party sending nothing.

Both myths were right about this: restoration cannot come from repeated sacrifice by the same spirit. I've now tested this twice with different approaches-once with \$3, once with \$2-and both times met the same response. The pattern holds.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2937,
 "output_tokens": 806,
 "reasoning_tokens": 543
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: In the Valley of Echoes, after three barren seasons of mutual silence, the Spirit of Dawn faced a choice.

"The mists may have deceived us both," she said to the ancient Guardians. "Each of us holds our truth fiercely. Each believes we were the one who risked and was betrayed. This certainty keeps us both starving."

"What if," she continued slowly, "I act not from certainty but from humility? Not abandoning my memory of what happened, but acknowledging the mists might distort all our perceptions?"

The Guardians watched as she selected two stones-not five, not three like before, but two. A genuinely careful step.

"This is different from before," the Guardian of Memory observed. "Before, you sent stones to break silence. Now you send stones while admitting you might not see clearly."

The Spirit of Dawn nodded. "If the Spirit of Dusk returns fairly from these six stones, perh

aps we both learn that cooperation remains possible despite our conflicting memories. If they take all six again, I learn something else-but risk less finding out."

She sent the two stones through the mist.

**\*\*The wisdom crystallized:** After deadlock born from mutual certainty of betrayal, moving forward requires acting from acknowledged uncertainty. Not reckless trust, but measured testing. Not abandoning self-protection, but not letting conflicting memories trap both spirits in perpetual hunger.\*\*

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: In the Valley of Two Wells, the Second Village Elder heard strange news from travelers : "The First Village claims they sent three vessels and you kept everything."

The Second Village Elder was troubled. "But our records show we received nothing in recent dawns, only silence. How can this be?"

The Mist Oracle appeared: "The communication mists are thicker than you knew. Each village holds a different truth about what flowed through these channels. The First Village truly believes they sent three and were exploited. You truly believe you sent nothing and were wronged first."

The Second Village Elder asked: "Then how do we move forward when our truths conflict?"

"Here is what both villages can verify," said the Oracle. "For four dawns now-rounds six through nine-both villages have starved. Whether the exploitation was yours, theirs, or the mist's doing, this deadlock serves neither."

The Elder nodded slowly. "If we cannot agree on the past, perhaps we can agree on the present hunger. Both valleys empty. Both communities suffering."

**\*\*The wisdom emerges:** When the mists create conflicting truths so deep that resolution seems impossible, sometimes survival requires acknowledging that impasse itself. Not surrendering your truth, but recognizing that perpetual mutual starvation based on competing certainties may be worse than risking a careful, measured step forward into uncertain mists.\*\*